

A
BISAYAN
GRAMMAR

AND NOTES ON BISAYAN
RHETORIC & POETICS &
FILIPINO DIALECTOLOGY



N. ROMUÁLDEZ
1908

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**THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK OF BISAYAN GRAMMAR AND NOTES
ON BISAYAN RHETORIC AND POETICS AND FILIPINO DIALECTOLOGY**

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GRAMMAR AND NOTES ON BISAYAN RHETORIC AND POETICS
AND FILIPINO DIALECTOLOGY *****

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BISAYAN GRAMMAR

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NOTES ON

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AND

FILIPINO DIALECTOLOGY

BY

NORBERTO ROMUÁLDEZ, B. A.

—Provincial Fiscal of Leyte, P. I.—

—Attorney-at-Law—

—Formerly Director of "San Jose" College of Takloban—

—Professor of Latin—



*O! good my lord, no Latin:
I am not such a truant since my coming
As not to know the language I have liv'd in.*
SHAKESPEARE.

1908.

"PAG PAHAYAG" CO.—TAKLOBAN.

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and
Notes on
Bisayan Rhetoric and Poetics
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*TO THE
TO THE YOUTH OF SAMAR AND LEYTE
who are clearly demonstrating aspirations
for a brighter future thru education
this book is dedicated,
in the hope that it may give a stimulus to their work
and an incentive to appreciate what is best in their language
as well as in the hope that, at a future day,*

*some one of them may be fitted to do this work
better than here presented.*

THE AUTHOR [III]

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INTRODUCTION

The publication of a Bisayan grammar has been eagerly awaited by many. It has been desired by those who are interested simply in the study of a native dialect. It has been needed by all Americans who desire an acquaintance with the language of the people among whom they live in order that they may get into closer touch with the great mass of natives as yet unable to speak either Spanish or English. It has been requested by many natives who wish to improve their use of their mother tongue. To all such, the present volume will prove of great value.

The author is recognized throughout Samar and Leyte as one of the highest authorities on the Samareño dialect. His statements may therefore be accepted as authoritative. His treatment of prefixes and suffixes, of similar words with different meanings, and of the various forms of the verb are especially interesting and valuable.

It is hoped that Mr. Norberto Romuáldez may be able to carry out his intention of putting out a combined grammar and language book designed especially for those just beginning the study of Bisayan. Such a work in conjunction with the present grammar would immensely facilitate the acquisition of a speaking knowledge of the dialect.

W. W. MARQUARDT,

Division Superintendent of Schools. [V]

PREFATORY REMARKS

This book is not intended to be a complete grammar, but is only an elementary work containing a collection of some principles governing the formation of the words and the construction of the sentences of the Bisayan¹ dialect spoken on the islands of Samar and nearly half of Leyte, by about four hundred thousand people.

At random and at odd intervals as the author's time permitted, he arranged, more or less in a logical grammatical order, the material gathered. Bearing in mind that there has never been any previous treatise on this subject worthy the name, the whole field therefore remaining practically unexplored, it will not be surprising that the use of spare moments covering only a short period has left much of the field undeveloped. However, what has been collected in this book will be found to be of primary importance to any one desiring to gain a quick acquaintance with the dialect for immediate practical use. After a careful study of the many examples under the different rules, coupled with a continuous practice, the user will be surprised—if he is a stranger—at the ease with which he acquires an Asiatic dialect, and—if he is a Filipino—how clear and logical is one of the most spoken dialects in his Mother-land.

The author had no intention of launching this work at the present time; but it is done at the behest of his American friends who have urged him to issue what has been collected, a portion only of what is intended ultimately to be a complete treatise and grammar of Bisayan, in order that this material may be available for the use of persons [VI]taking an interest in the Islands, thereby bringing about a common means of communication, which promotes a better feeling between the people born here and the newcomer.

The exposition of the different subjects is not in the modern didactic form generally used in this class of works. This is simply due to the lack of sufficient time. Thus the grammar is divided into the usual parts: orthography, prosody, etymology, and syntax. Some of these parts have been treated to a very limited extent, because time has not admitted of the collection of sufficient material and of the opportunity to weigh the relative values and eliminate the exceptions from the rules.

An appendix has been added where two topics are treated: notes on Rhetoric and Poetics of Bisayan, and notes on Filipino Dialectology consisting in a short comparative study of this dialect in reference to Tagalog, one of its sister-dialects in the Archipelago. The first notes are designed to complete the knowledge of Bisayan after the grammar is mastered; the second are intended to show the possibility of the formation of a common Filipino language² out of the different dialects scattered thru out the Archipelago, in a similar way as the Modern High German has been formed out of the main primitive groups Frisian and Saxon. Frankish, Hessian, and Thuringian, and Alemannian and Bavarian.

We have to repeat that our work is far from being perfect, even complete, on account of lack of sufficient time. Owing to the same circumstance, many errors in printing have crept into this book, which we have tried to correct at the end under the heading *Errata*. But we sincerely admit that not all of the mistakes that may be found in this book are to be assigned to lack of time. Like any other product of human industry, this work bears marks of errors arising from the two sources pointed out by Horace

quas aut incuria fudit,
Vut humana parum cavit natura.

[VII]

Acknowledgement is hereby made for the help rendered by Messrs. W. W. Marquardt, Div. Superintendent of Schools of Leyte, P.I., Fred Shoemaker,

and H. W. Halbourg, in correcting part of the proof, and for the collaboration of Mr. Henry E. Neibert, Former American Teacher of Jaro, Leyte, P.I. whose knowledge of both tongues, English and Bisayan, added much material to the work.

Hoping that this little volume may be of interest and real help, it is offered to an indulgent public for what it is worth.

Norberto Romualdez

Takloban, Province of Leyte,
Philippine Islands.
November 8, 1908. [\[IX\]](#)

¹ We write *Bisayan*, and not *Visayan* for the reason, among others, that there is no *V* or sound of *V* in our dialect, and that there seems to be no necessity for changing in English the *B* of the original *Bisayâ* into *V*. [↑]

² A committee has been found lately in Manila for this purpose. [↑]

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ORTHOGRAPHY AND PROSODY

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LETTERS.

The Bisayan letters are twenty:¹

a, as <i>a</i> in <i>large</i>	h, as <i>h</i> in <i>hat</i>	qu, as the English <i>k</i>
b, } as in English	i, sounding <i>ee</i>	r, }
c, }	l, }	s, }
d, }	m, }	t, }
e, as <i>e</i> in <i>well</i>	n,	u, sounding <i>oo</i> as in <i>good</i>
g, as <i>g</i> in <i>good</i>	o, as <i>o</i> in <i>long</i>	y, as <i>y</i> in <i>young</i>
ng, as <i>ng</i> in <i>long</i>	p, as in English	

[2]

After knowing the respective sounds of these letters, according to the preceding table, no rule is necessary for the pronunciation of Bisayan words.

¹ According to the nature of the Bisayan dialect and according to what some Filipino philologists have written, Rizal among them, referring to the dialects in the Philippines, the letters of the Bisayan language must be the following:

a, b, d, e, g, ñ, h, i, k, l, m, n, o, p, r, s, t, u, y, w.

As it can be noticed, the letters c, f, j, ñ, q, v, x and z are omitted from the preceding list, and ñ and w are introduced. The reason for this is as follows:

c, in its sound as in *city*, can be substituted by the letter s; and, in its sound like c in *cup*, it can be substituted by k.

f is never used in Bisayan.

j, in its Spanish sound, can be substituted by h, which has an aspirate pronunciation in Bisayan in all cases. In Bisayan, there is no sound like that of the English j; however, in some places on the western and southern coasts of Leyte, the y is pronounced like the English j, as in *maayo* (pronounced mah-ah-joh) good.

The Spanish letter ñ, or a sound like it, can be written in Bisayan more properly with the combination of these two letters *ny*, as in *minyo* (pr. mean-yo) married.

q is not necessary, since the *k* can be used in all cases, where *q* is needed. The phrase *quiquilàon co* (I shall see it) can be perfectly written *kikiláon ko*.

v is never used in Bisayan.

x, in its Spanish sound, can be substituted by *ks*; and, in its English sounds, it can be substituted by *gs* or *ks*, respectively.

z, in either its English or its Spanish sound, is never used in Bisayan.

The *ḡ* is for the nasal sound that is very often used in Bisayan, like the *ng* in *song*, *longing*.

The *g* is preferable to the combination *nḡ*, which would sometimes lead to confusion; because this combination *ng* in Bisayan, is not pronounced as one letter, in many instances, but each of these letters is pronounced; as, for example, the word *buḡa* (fruit), if written *bunga*, should sound *booong-ghah*, which means *to dart* or *to be darted*.

w is needed in all cases of sounds like Spanish diphthongs; but it must be used in Bisayan always as a consonant, never as a vowel.

Notwithstanding the preceding considerations, the orthography used in this book is the old one, but simplified to a certain extent, on account of the fact that this alphabet (if it can be properly called an *alphabet*, it having no *f* or sound of *f*) is not yet used, even known, but by very few persons among the Bisayan speaking people.

It would be very desirable for the people to adopt the new orthography proposed in this note, because it is evidently more simple and proper for the particular nature of the Bisayan dialect. [2]

A study of the method of reducing the number of Bisayan vowels is also to be desired, as it seems that not more than three are needed, to wit: *a*, *e* or *i*, *o* or *u*.

The nature of the Bisayan tongue argues for such a simplicity. Dr. T.H. Pardo de Tavera, referring to the ancient Filipino alphabet, says: "The alphabet was composed of seventeen letters, three of which were vowels. A consonant standing alone was always pronounced with an *a* sound following; by the use of a dot or dash near and above the consonant stem, in much the same fashion as is used in certain systems of shorthand, instead of the sound of the *a*, the sound of the vowels *e* or *i* was produced: when the dot or dash was placed below the consonant stem the vowel sound given was equivalent to *o* or *u*." (See Census of the Philippine Islands: 1903 Volume One, page 327). ↑

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THE ACCENTS.

The orthographical accent is an important sign in Bisayan, in order to give to the words their proper pronunciation, and, consequently, their proper meaning.

Of the emission of the voice in pronouncing the Bisayan vowels, there are two ways: one is the ordinary way, like that of the English vowels, as in

baga (red-hot coal or wood),
dinhi (here),
olo (head),

and the other is by a guttural suspended emission of the voice, like

the last *a* in *bagà* (lungs),
the last *i* in *dirì* (not or no), and
the last *o* in *torò* (drop).

This guttural pronunciation is only used in the endings of words.

From the various combinations of these ways of pronouncing the vowels and the force with which they are pronounced, it follows that a vowel, no matter which one it is, has four different sounds:

As ~~1st~~ 1st ordinarily, and without any particular force.

As ~~2nd~~ 2nd ordinarily, but with force in its pronunciation.

By ~~3rd~~ 3rd guttural suspended emission of the voice, and without force.

By ~~4th~~ 4th guttural suspended emission of the voice, and with force.

The first way does not need any orthographical sign. But the last three ones require a special orthographical accent in each case.

When a vowel is pronounced as ordinarily, but with more force than others in the same word, the proper accent is the acute (´).

When a vowel is pronounced with a suspended guttural sound, but without any force, the corresponding accent is the grave (`).

And when a vowel is pronounced with a suspended guttural sound with force, its accent is the circumflex (^), which is simply the combination of the two foregoing accents, as this last represents a sound that is the combination of the two sounds, suspended guttural and with force.

Therefore, in writing the word *quita*, for example, in its three different meanings and according to its three different pronunciations, it must be as follows:

quitá (we) *quità* (see) *quitâ* (look at).

RULE. There are three different accents in Bisayan: the acute (´); the grave (`); and the angular, which we may call improperly circumflex (^).

The acute is located wherever it is needed, either at the beginning or in the middle or at the ending of the word. Examples:

úpa (reward) *upá* (rice chaff).

The grave and angular, by their nature, are only used upon words ending in a vowel, and then only upon the last vowel. Examples:

dacò (large), *dacô* (larger)

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PUNCTUATION.

The signs of punctuation in Bisayan are the same as those in English, the rules for the use of the period (.), colon (:), semicolon (;), comma (,), parenthesis (), dash (—), quotation marks (“ ”) and apostrophe (') being identical. [4]

But the rules are different for the use of the interrogation and exclamation points, and hyphen.

In Bisayan, the Spanish way is followed in using two points of interrogation and two of exclamation, the one at the beginning of the question or exclamation (¿) (¡), and the other at the ending (?) (!).

While the hyphen (-) is also used in Bisayan to connect parts of a word divided at the end of a line, and to connect two or more nouns, adjectives, or particles, so as to form them into a single compound, it has an additional use which is to separate distinctly the syllables of certain words that would have a different meaning or none at all without the said separation.

Examples:

<i>sál-ong</i> (to hook)	<i>sálong</i> (resin)
<i>súl-ay</i> (belching of an infant)	<i>súlay</i> (prop)
<i>bac-ad</i> (to unroll)	
<i>os-og</i> (to draw near from afar)	
<i>im-im</i> (lip)	
<i>sid-ap</i> (to look at)	
<i>san-o</i> (when, future)	
<i>cacan-o</i> (when, past) ¹	

NOTE.—The above separations are not of the same character as those caused by contractions or elisions, where the proper sign is not a hyphen, but an apostrophe. As,

<i>gáb'i</i>	from <i>gabii</i>	(night)
<i>cabítón'an,</i>	from <i>cabitoónan</i>	(stars)
<i>pabáy'i,</i>	from <i>pabayái</i>	(leave him or her)
<i>it'im'bugtò nğan hit'</i>	from <i>iton imo bugtò nğan</i>	(your brother or sister
<i>ac'patód,</i>	<i>hitón acon patód</i>	and my cousin).

Therefore, it would not be correct to write *gab-i*, *cabiton-an*, *pabay-i*, where the apostrophe should be employed instead of the hyphen. However, the apostrophe is used only when needed to avoid wrong pronunciation or confusion. [5] So the last of the preceding examples is written without any sign of punctuation, thus: *it im bugtò nğan hit ac patód*.

¹ In most of the towns of the island of Sámar, such separation as well as that by apostrophe is frequently disregarded, this being one of the most noticeable differences between the Sámar and Leyte dialects. [↑]

VOWELS

The Bisayan people, especially in Leyte, always have a tendency to separate the vowels in pronouncing the words, there being no Bisayan diphthong. So it is *bi-ol* (small basket) and not *biol*; *cá-on* (eat), *ti-il* (foot), *ma-opay* (good), and not *cáon*, *tiil*, *maopay*. But this refers only to spoken language, not to written.

Some words, like *uásay* (axe), *sabáo* (broth) are pronounced *ua-say*, *sa-bao*, and not *u-a-say*, *sa-ba-o*. These syllables *ua* and *ao* are not diphthongs. The *u* in the syllable *ua* and the *o* in the syllable *ao*, are not the vowels *u*, *o*, but the consonant *w*. These words should be written more properly *wásay*, *sabáw*.¹

¹ See the note on the first page of this book. This is one of the facts that urge the adoption of a more logical alphabet (?) for the Bisayan tongue. [↑]

SYLLABLES

Every vowel¹ with the consonant or consonants pronounced with it and every vowel pronounced alone form one syllable, and are written as such. This is the rule applied to the division of a word at the end of a line.

Examples:

ca-ru-ca-yá-can (conversation)

bác-dao (stand)

a-ha-cá (hemp), etc.

¹ Except *o* and *u* when used as consonants, their function then being properly that of a *w*. [↑]

CAPITALIZATION

In Bisayan, the following words should begin with capitals:

The first word of every sentence.

The proper nouns.

The names of the days of the week and the months of the year.

Titles of honor or office. [6]

All words, except prepositions, conjunctions and unimportant adjectives, in the titles of books and essays.

All names of God, and expressions referring to the Deity.

Words representing important events in history and epochs of time.

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CONTRACTIONS

There is no contraction used in Bisayan, except that in the sign *mãa* (a particle employed to express the idea of plurality).

Mãa is for *manãa* composed of *ma* (an important prefix of the Bisayan and Tagalog dialects, which bears the idea of abundance or plurality) and *nãa* (a conjunctive particle which is necessarily employed to connect the variable parts of speech).

NOTE. It would be desirable to have the following contractions adopted in Bisayan, inasmuch as they are universally recognized:

<i>i.e.</i>	for <i>id est</i> .	<i>P.S.</i>	<i>post scriptum.</i>
		”	”
<i>e.g.</i>	<i>exempli gratia.</i>	<i>N.B.</i>	<i>nota bene.</i>
	”	”	”
<i>viz.</i>	<i>videlicet.</i>	<i>a.m.</i>	<i>ante meridiem.</i>
	”	”	”
<i>etc.</i>	<i>et cetera.</i>	<i>p.m.</i>	<i>post meridiem.</i> ¹
	”	”	”
<i>P.D.</i>	<i>post data.</i>		
	”		

¹ The author believes that it is better to adopt these contractions than to invent others of Bisayan origin for the reason that they afford signs universally understood, and because every tongue has a tendency to assimilate such universal signs. ↑

ETYMOLOGY.

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PARTS OF SPEECH.

These are eight in number, in Bisayan: article, noun, pronoun, verb, adverb, preposition, conjunction, interjection. [Z]

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ARTICLES.

There are three classes:

Definite: *an* (the)

Indefinite: *in* (a)

Personal: *hi* or *si* (no equivalent in English).

The definite article, as well as the indefinite, is used in Bisayan in the same manner as its equivalent in English. The definite article, however, is sometimes used before proper nouns, and it is very often used before the demonstrative and possessive pronouns. Examples:

Nacánhi *an* batà (the boy or girl has come)

Nacánhi *in* batà (a boy or girl has come)

An Dyos¹ macagagáhum (God is omnipotent)

An iní nga bucád (this flower)

An acon calò (my hat)

The personal article is always used before the names of persons; it is also used before the personal pronouns, except the third persons. Examples.

Hi Pedro (Peter)

Hi acó (I)

Hi icao (you)

Instead of *hi*, *si* may be used.²

These articles do not change in gender. Examples: *an* amáy (the father), *an* iróy (the mother); *hi* Juan (John), *hi* María (Mary).

The definite and indefinite articles change in the plural in the following way: [8]

SINGULAR PLURAL

an	an mǵa ³
in	in mǵa

The personal article does not change, in person or number, except in the third person plural where it takes the form of the third personal pronoun third person, plural number. Examples:

<i>Hi</i> quitá	(we)
<i>Hi</i> camó	(you, in plural)
<i>Hirá</i> Pedro nǵan <i>hi</i> Juan	(Peter and John)

DECLENSION.—Articles have two cases: *nominative* and *objective*.

	SINGULAR				PLURAL	
NOMINATIVE:	an	in	hi or si	an mǵa	in mǵa	hirá or sirá
OBJECTIVE:	han or san	hin or sin	ni, can	han mǵa or san mǵa	hin mǵa or sin mǵa	nira, canda

Examples:

An batà nagbahása *han* surát ni Pedro (the boy reads Peter's letter).

Hirá Carlos nğan *hi* Juan naghátag *canda* (Charles and John gave
Tomás nğan *hi* Pedro *hin mğa* bucád flowers to Thomas and Peter).

The objective case covers all the different cases used in other languages after the nominative, that is to say, the *genitive*, *dative*, *accusative* and *ablative* cases.

RULES. 1. The Bisayan articles are used immediately before the words to which they refer.

2. The definite article may be used without expressing the object to which it refers, having, in this case, the nature of a relative pronoun. Examples:

An nagtótoon, nahabábaro (He, who studies, learns).

An mğa nagtututdò ha aton (They who teach us.)

[9]

3. The personal article is always necessary before the names of persons. It is not correct to say “Pedro nagsusurat”; *hi* is needed, and it must be: “*hi* Pedro nagsusurat” (Peter is writing).

EXCEPTIONS. 1. Between the definite article and the word to which it refers, other words may be placed, in some instances, as in this phrase:

An iní nğa *baláy* (this house), or

an maopay nğa *batà* (the good boy or girl).

The regular order in constructing the last phrase is:

an batà nğa maopay.

2. When the names of persons are in the vocative case, the personal article is not used. Thus we say:

Mariano, cadí dao (Mariano, come, please).

Pamatì, Juan (listen, John).

3. In the objective case of *hi*, *can* is used before the verb, and *ni* after the verb. Examples:

An *can* Juan guinsurát (what John wrote)

An guinsurát *ni* Juan (what John wrote)

N.B.—The indefinite article, when needed at the beginning of the sentence, is replaced by the phrase “*usá nãa*” So, if we wish to say “a boy came yesterday,” we should not say

in batà nacánhi cacolop; but

usá nãa batà nacánhi cacolóp.

This phrase *usá nãa* is not a perfect article, but it has the character of an adjective, even when used as an article. Therefore, both the indefinite *in* and the phrase *usá nãa* may be used in the same sentence. So, we can say, changing the regular order of the last sentence:

Nacánhi cacolóp *in usá nãa* bata (a boy came yesterday).

[\[Contents\]](#)

NOUNS

These are substantive and adjective. Both may be grouped [\[10\]](#) in the following classes: primitive, diminutive, figurative, verbal, compound, derivative, proper, common, positive, comparative, superlative, cardinal, ordinal, partitive, distributive and collective. Nothing particular needs be said about the primitive.

DIMINUTIVE

Examples:

PRIMITIVE	DIMINUTIVE
baláy (house)	balay baláy
saróual (trousers)	sarouá lay
carahà (frying-pan)	carahá ay
balóto (little boat)	balotó hay

As is seen, the diminutive is formed by the repetition of the primitive or by adding to the latter the affix *ay* or *hay*.

The primitive is repeated when it has not more than two syllables. As,

from

dáhon (leave),	dahondáhon,
cáhoi (tree),	cahoicáhoi.

The affix *ay* or *hay* is added when the primitive has more than two syllables; *ay* being used in cases where the noun ends with a consonant, or a vowel with a grave or angular accent; and *hay* being employed when the primitive ends with a vowel otherwise accented or non-accented or a vowel that is pronounced separately from the consonant preceding it, or is preceded by more than one consonant. As,

from

sacayán (boat),	sacayánay,
habobò (low),	habobóay,
balicô (crooked),	balicóay, ⁴ [11]
abacá (hemp),	abacáhay,
babaye (woman),	babayéhay,
banat-i (a tree so called),	banat-ihay,
malacsi (fast),	malacsihay.

But the dissyllabic primitive is not repeated when its first vowel is followed by more than one consonant, or when the last vowel has an acute accent or is pronounced separately from the consonant preceding it. In such cases the affix *ay* or *hay* is employed, the rules established for the use of these affixes being applicable to such diminutives. As,

from

támsi (bird),	tamsíhay, not tamsitamsi,
túl-an (bone),	tul-ánay, not tul-antul-an,
pulá (red color),	puláhay, not pulapula, ⁵
sagpò (plug),	sagpóay, not sagposagpò,

sab-a (a kind of banana),	sab-áhay, not sab-asab-a,
bungto (town),	<u>bungtóhay</u> not bungtobungto.

Generally, as it has been observed in the preceding examples, the adjectives follow the same rules. As,

from

matám-is (sweet),	matam-isay,
malomó (soft),	malomóhay,
halípot (short),	halipótay.

But in most of the adjectives formed with *ma* (a particle bearing the idea of abundance) and *ha*⁶ (a particle that bears the idea of place), like *maopay*, *mabusag*, *mapulá*, *hataás*, *halabà*, the prefixes *ma* or *ha* are disregarded in the formation of their diminutives, their abstract roots being the only elements taken into consideration, as if such [12] adjectives were dyssyllabic. Thus, *opay*, *busag*, *pulá*, *táas*, *lubà*, being the abstract roots of the last mentioned adjectives, their diminutives will be:

from

maópay (good),	maopay-ópay
mabuság (white),	mabusagbúsag
mapulá (red),	mapulapulá
hataás (high),	hataastáas
halabà (long),	halabalabà ⁷

There are some adjectives that have irregular diminutives. Such are the following:

DIMINUTIVE

from	REGULAR	IRREGULAR
------	---------	-----------

dacò (large), dacò	dacò	dacolaay ⁸
--------------------	------	-----------------------

gutì (small) guti	gutì	gutirurù ⁹
-------------------	------	-----------------------

FIGURATIVE

We call those nouns *figurative* that are applied to the objects which, not being of the same nature as that which is expressed by their roots, show nevertheless analogy or similarity with those represented by the corresponding primitive, in their meaning, form, use, or application.

Examples:

from

bobón (fountain), mobon**bóbon**¹⁰ (fontanel);

cabáyo (horse), *caro*cabáyo, (objects that are like a horse or cloud).

dámpog (cloud), *darod*dámpog,

When the primitive has not more than two syllables, the formation of its figurative follows the same rules as those for the dissyllabic diminutive. As,

from [13]

hadì (king), we have

*hadi*hadì (a person who, by his vanity or harshness, resembles the figure of a king).

But when the primitive has more than two syllables, or its last vowel is preceded by more than one consonant or is pronounced separately from the

consonant—preceding it, its figurative is formed by adding to the root a prefix composed of its first syllable if it begins with a consonant or of its first vowel if it begins with a vowel and the syllable *ro* (a particle that bears the idea of imitation, repetition, or collection). As,

from

sacayán	(boat),	<i>sarosacáyan</i>
ulalahípan	(centipede),	<i>uroulalahipan</i>
isdà	(fish),	<i>iroisdà</i>
can'on	(cooked rice)	<i>carocan'on</i> ¹¹

NOTE.—Many of the figurative nouns have the same forms as the collective. There are few figuratives among the adjectives; of these, those having the form of figuratives are really comparatives.¹²

VERBAL

These are formed from the verb-root transformed by particles referring to the agents or the objects of the roots.

Examples:

from

sáyau (to dance)

parasayáu (dancer),

tigsayáu (person who sometimes dances),

magsarayáu (person appointed to dance)

*sarayauán*¹³ (place designed for dancing). [14]

sarayauón (dance or musical piece to be danced)¹⁴;

from

umá (to farm)

paraúma (farmer),

tig-úma (person used to do farming),

mag-urúma (person in charge of farming),

urumáhan, contracted *urúmhan* (place designed for farming),

urumáhon, contracted *urúmhon* (ground or plant to be cultivated);

from

surat (to write), the similar verbals as above, so far as the idea of the root and the use permit, with this variant:

susurátan, not *sururátan*,

susuráton, not *sururáton*;

from

toóc (to weep), the similar verbals, so far as the root and the use permit, and this besides:

matóoc (weeper);

from

bóonǵ (to break), the similar verbals, and this:

maboroónǵ (liable or expected to be broken);

from

inóm (to drink), the similar verbals, and the following:

mainominóm (an inviting drink);

from

sosón (to correct), the similar verbals, and this:

hinóson (person fond of or bold in correcting);

[15]

from

útañ (to borrow),

hiñútañ or *hiñuñutáñ*¹⁵ (person fond of or bold in borrowing).

It may be observed that not all of the verb-roots produce the same number of verbal nouns. It depends on the particular character of every idea conveyed in the root, and mainly on the use.

From the preceding examples, it is seen that the transformative particles of the verbal nouns are various, the said particles being the prefixes *para*, *tig*, *mag*, *ma*, *hi*, the interfixes¹⁶ *r*, *ro*, *um* or the affixes *an*, *on*. These particles are very important in Bisayan as they greatly help to enrich the limited vocabulary of this tongue.

For the sake of clearness, we shall see first the affixes.

An, on.

These particles refer to the complement of the verb-root, *an* to the indirect object of the action (generally regarding the place where the act occurs), and *on* to the direct object (generally referring to the termination of the action).

An or *on* is used when the root ends with a consonant or a vowel with a grave or angular accent.

An *h* preceds them when the roots ends with a vowel otherwise accented or non-accented, or pronounced separately from the preceding consonant or consonants.

The particle *an* or *han* is simply added to the root, as,

from

catúrog (to sleep),	caturogán (sleeping place);
sinġba (to adore),	sinġbáhan (church);
taclob (to cover),	taclóban ¹⁷ (covering place); ^[16]
tan-ao (to see at a distance),	tan-aoan ¹⁸ (watching place);

or is employed either with the interfix *r* combined with the first vowel of the root or with the first consonant and vowel of the root instead, as

from

cáon (to eat)	caraonán
---------------	----------

from

tíroc (to assembly)	titiroeán (meeting place);
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or with its first vowel if the root commences with a vowel, as

from

aro (to ask)	aaroán (place designed for asking).
--------------	-------------------------------------

The particle *on* has the same use as *an*, as

caturogón,
siringbahon,

lilibácon (from *libác*, to backbite),
aaroon.

NOTE.—The affix *an* is sometimes doubled, as,

from

lohód (to kneel down), lodhanán¹⁹

from

tambò (to lock out), tamboànan, from *tambóan* (window).

Para, tig.

Para bears the idea of habit, custom or occupation. *Tig* conveys the idea of a repeated, but not frequent, act. [17]

They are simply prefixed to the root without any other complementary particle, as,

from

cánhi (to come).
paracánhi,
tigcánhi.

Ma, with on, with ro, or with r.

The particle *ma* conveys the idea of fondness, desirableness, or passive potentiality or possibility.

When, it means fondness, it is employed either by putting it at the beginning of the root without any other particle, as

from

cáon (to eat), *macáon* (glutton),

or by combining it with the affix *on* or *hon*, according to the case, as

from

catúrog (to sleep), *macaturogón* (sleepy head),

from

arába (to moan), *maarahón* (person fond of moaning).

When the prefix *ma*, bears the idea of desirableness, it is placed before the doubled root, when the root has not more than two syllables and its last vowel is preceded by not more than two consonants or is not pronounced separately from its preceding consonant or consonants, as

from

cáon, *macaoncaón* (thing inviting to be eaten)²⁰

[18]

from

oná (to commence), *maonaoná* (provocative, quarrelsome),

and in cases where the root has more than two syllables, or if not, where its last vowel is preceded by more than two consonants or is pronounced separately from the consonant or consonants preceding it, then this prefix is

employed in combination with the interfix *ro* preceded by the first consonant and vowel of the root or by the vowel only if the root begins with a vowel, as

from catúrog,	<i>macarocaturóg</i> ,
bányac, (to kick),	<i>maharobányac</i> ,
”	
síd-ap, (to look at),	<i>masirosíd-ap</i> ,
”	
arába,	<i>maaroarabá</i> ,
”	
ígham, (to grunt),	<i>mairoígham</i> ,
”	
ós-og (to draw near from afar),	<i>maoroós-og</i> .
”	

When the particle *ma* conveys the idea of passive potentiality or possibility, it is used with the interfix *r* combined with the first vowel of the root. The *r* with its complementary vowel is put after the first syllable of the root. As,

from bóong (to break),	<i>maboroóng</i> (brittle)
abót (to reach),	<i>maarábot</i> (attainable).
”	

The particle *ma* is frequently replaced by the prefix *ig* or *i* combined with the interfix *r* or its substitutes, as

from tambal (to cure),	<i>igtarámbal</i> or <i>itárambal</i> (medicine),
surat (to write),	<i>isusúrat</i> (thing to write with).
”	

Mag and the r.

The prefix *mag* bears the idea of forcible, necessary, or continuous agency. It is employed with the interfix *r* combined with and before the first vowel of the root. This combination is placed between the first and the second syllable of the root. But when there is an *r* in the root, the interfix *r* is replaced by the first consonant of the [19]said root. If the root begins with a vowel, the interfix *r* is sometimes suppressed, the said first vowel being used instead of the interfix. As,

from sódoý (to stroll about),	<i>magsotodóy</i> (one who strolls about)
bilíng̃ (to seek or	<i>magbiríling̃</i> (searcher),
„ search),	
siríng̃ (to request),	<i>magsisiríng̃</i> , (petitioner), not
„	<i>magsiríring̃</i> ,
ósoc (to set up),	<i>mag-orosóc</i> (person designed to set
„	up),
arót (to cut the hair),	<i>mag-aárot</i> (barber).
„	

The particle *mag* is frequently contracted into *ma*, in which case the root is considered as having an *r*, as

from suláy (to tempt),	<i>manunúlay</i> (tempter),
tábang̃ (to assist),	<i>mananábang̃</i> (helper).
„	

Hi

This particle conveys the idea of boldness. When the root begins with a labial consonant, except the *m*, the said consonant is transformed into *m*, as

from bása (to read),	<i>himása</i> (person bold in reading),
----------------------	---

pitíc (to leap), *himític* (person bold in leaping).

”

When the root begins with an *m*, the prefix *hi* is not commonly used but the prefix *para ma*, or *tig*, as

from múlay (to teach), *para-*, *ma-*, or *tigmulay*, not *himúlay*,
mogó (to observe), *para-*, *ma-*, or *tigmógo*, not *himógo*.

”

When the root begins with a vowel, *nĩ* is²¹ appended to the prefix; *nĩ* is also appended when the root begins with a guttural consonant, but then the said consonant is suppressed. As,

from ásoy (to refer), *hinĩásoy* (garrolous),
cáon (to eat) *hingáon* (bold in eating), [20]

”

gúbat (to invade), *hinĩúbat* (bold in invading).

”

When the root commences with the nasal consonant *nĩ*, the prefix *hi* is ordinarily replaced by the prefix *para*, *ma*, or *tig*, or the first syllable of the root is made long, as

from nĩgisi (to laugh, showing *para-*, *ma*, or (person fond of
the teeth), *tiĩngisi*, or *ĩngisi* grinning).

When the root begins with any other consonant, except *l*, *n*, *r*, the said consonant is suppressed and the letter *n* is appended to the prefix, as

from dolóng, (to struggle), *hinólong* (bold in struggling),
sosón (to correct), *hinóson* (bold in correcting),

”

Observations: 1. There are verbals formed with *ma* combined with the interfix *r* or its substitutes. This formation takes place only in the intransitive verbs commencing with the particle *ca* which then conveys the idea of passivity. As,

from caauód (to be ashamed),	macaaráuod (shameful),
cabóronǵ (to be confused),	macabobóronǵ (confusing),
”	
casína (to be angry),	macasisína (odious).
”	

2. The infinitives of the verbs, which are always preceded by the particle *pag*, are frequently employed as substantives. In such cases the particle *pag* is transformed in the plural, its *g* being then replaced by the letter *nǵ* if the root begins with a vowel or a guttural consonant, except *g*, or by the consonant *n* when the root commences with a dental consonant, or by the *m* if it begins with a labial. In the plural, the roots commencing with a consonant lose said consonant. When the root begins with a nasal or with the guttural *g*, said consonant is preserved and the *g* of *pag* is replaced by *n*. Examples:

from arò (to ask), cáon (to eat), dáop (to approach) bása (to read), nǵoyngoy (to groan), gábot (to, pull), we have:

SINGULAR		PLURAL
pag-arò	(asking)	panǵarò,
pagcáon	(eating)	panǵáon,
pagdáop	(approaching)	panáop,
pagbása	(reading)	pamása,
pagngoyngoy	(groaning)	panngóyagoy,
paggábot	(pulling)	pangábot,

3. The infinitives of roots commencing with the particle *ca* are also used as substantives, and then with or without the prefix *pag*.

from *cabido* (to be sorry), *pagcabídò, cabídò*, (sorrow).

In such cases, the affix *an* or *on* is sometimes employed, as

from *casáquit* (to be sad), *casaquítan* (sadness),
 casína (to be angry), *casinahón* (anger).
 ”

COMPOUND

The use gives the following:

from <i>solód</i> (to enter) and <i>baláy</i> (house),	<i>sólodbálay</i> , which means the person who thru his intimacy with the occupant of a house, enters in at any time;
from <i>sacá</i> (to go up) and <i>lúsad</i> (to go down),	<i>sacálúsad</i> , applied to the person who is very busy or who suffers a great misfortune and goes up and down the house repeatedly. It is also applied to boys or girls who go out the house frequently, especially without permission of their parents;
from <i>dosô</i> (to push) and <i>bótong</i> (to pull),	<i>dosô-bótong</i> , ²⁴ applied to a person who takes determinations that are contradictory;
from <i>cábcab</i> (to scratch) and <i>tocâ</i> (what a bird does when it picks up or	<i>cábcabtocâ</i> , applied to persons who have to expend for their subsistence all that they gain by their work;

bites something with its beak),

from *di*, contraction of *dirì* (not), *abotón*, from *abót* (to reach), and *calóton*, from *cálot* (to scratch), [23]

from *tábag* (help), *ha*, a preposition for the objective case, *amongãámonã* (to malign);

diabotón calóton, applied to that part of the human back, which our hands *cannot reach* to *scratch* when it itches;

tabaghaamonã-ámonã, applied to those who maliciously pretend to help a person in trouble, but injure him. Etc.

DERIVATIVE

We consider under this heading the nouns derived from other nouns. Those originated from a verb are already treated as verbals. Most of the derivatives are adjectives.

The derivatives, like the verbal, are formed with particles, prefixes, interfixes, and affixes.

The usual particles are *ca*, *ma*, *maca*, *mag*, *maqui*, *hi*, *pala*, *tag*, as prefixes; *r*, *in* as interfixes; and *an*, *on* as affixes. As,

from *pauà* (light),
 áram (wisdom),

capanà (clearness)
maáram (wise)

„

bayáu (brother in
 law),

mabaráyau (brother-in-law-to-be)

„

bidò (sorrow),

macabibidò (sorrowful)

„

isdà (fish),	<i>maquiisdà</i> (fond of fish)
„	
púsod (navel),	<i>himósod</i> (payment for attending to the navel of a new-born child)
„	
bugtò (brother or sister),	<i>magbugtò</i> (referring to two persons who are brothers or sisters) ²⁵
bisaya (bisayan),	<i>binisaya</i> (bisayan tongue)
„	
salâ (fault or guilt),	<i>saláan</i> (guilty)
„	
búuà ²⁶ (lie),	<i>buuáon</i> (<u>liar</u>).
„	

[24]

Ca bears the idea of quality, and is used alone or in combination with the affix *an*. As

from hataás (high),	<i>cahataás</i> (height),
dáot (bad),	<i>caraótan, carát'an</i> (badness).
„	
<u>pauà</u> (light),	<u>capauà</u> (clearness).
„	

It is sometimes combined with the interfix *in* and the joined affix *anon*, as

from masúgot (obedient), *camasinug'tánon* (obedience).

Ma conveys the idea of abundance and future condition. In the first case, it is added at the beginning of the primitive, which is the form of great many adjectives, as,

from ísog (courage, rage), *maísog* (courageous);

and when it means future condition, it is used with the interfix *r* combined with the first vowel of the primitive, as,

from asáua (wife), *maarasauá* (woman betrothed)

The particle *ma* is frequently combined with the interfix *in* and the affix *on* or *ánon*. In plural, the *ma* is appended with *g*. As

from túman (performance),	matinumánon (faultless) plural,
	magtinumánon
sugót (obedience),	masinug'tánon (obedient)

”

It is also used without any affix, and then the primitive is doubled as from tubâ (a wine) matubatubâ (person or thing that smells as tubâ).

Maca has the idea of potentiality, and is added to the beginning of the primitive, by doubling the first syllable of the primitive or by using the intermix *r* combined with the first vowel of the primitive. As,

from álo (shame),	<i>macaaálo</i> (shameful),
lípay (joy),	<i>macalilípay</i> (rejoicer),
”	
budlay (grievance),	<i>macaburúdlay</i> (grievous).
”	

Mag conveys the idea of mutual relationship, and also [25] of continuity in a few cases. It is simply added at the beginning of the primitive.

Relationship. Examples:

from *patód* (cousin), *magpatód* (cousins each other).

It is sometimes appended with *tala*, as from *amáy* (father), *magtalaamáy* (father and son, or father and daughter).

The derivatives formed with *mag* conveying the idea of mutual relationship, are always in plural.

Continuity. Examples:

from *ága* (morning), *Mag-ága* (the whole night until the morning);
 colóp (evening); *magcólop* (the whole day until the evening.)
 ,,

Maqui signifies the idea of fondness, and is employed without any other transformative particle, as,

from *Dyos*²⁷ (God), *maquidyos* (pious).

It is used in very few cases to form verbals, as

from *hámpanñ* (to be present during a conversation), *maquihahampanñon* (person fond of being present or taking part in a conversation).

Hi, as transformative particle of derivatives, conveys the idea of boldness, and also of consideration, or of payment. We have seen that it means boldness when joined to verbs to form verbal nouns²⁸. As to its use, it follows here the same rules as when employed with verbs. Examples:

from *quinatsilâ* (Spanish language), *hinñinatsilâ* (one who ventures to talk Spanish, knowing but little of it). [26]
 apóy (grandfather), *hinñapóy*
 ,,

púsod (navel), himósod²⁹

„

Pala means resemblance. It is combined with the affix *an*. As,

from buyo (betel nut),	<i>palabuyóan</i>	(applied to the wine of cocoanut, that resembles the taste of the betel nut)
------------------------	-------------------	--

biráu (a plant),	<i>palabirauán</i>	(applied to the fruit of cocoanut that resembles the color of <i>biráu</i>)
------------------	--------------------	--

camote (sweet potato),	<i>palacamotián</i>	(applied to the fruit of “nañca” (a tree) that resembles the color of <i>camote</i>)
------------------------	---------------------	--

gátas (milk)	<i>palagatásan</i>	(applied to the young rice or corn whose grain is yet liquid resembling the milk)
--------------	--------------------	---

Tag conveys the idea of ownership or authorship. It is simply added to the primitive. As

from baláy (house),	tagbaláy (owner of a house)
sugò (order),	tagsugò (author of an order).

„

It is sometimes used to indicate distribution, and then it is frequently combined with the prefix *ma* preceding it. As

from túig (year),	<i>tagtuig</i>	(year by year)
ádlao (day),	<i>matag-ádlao</i>	(every day).

„

These last particles are sometimes replaced by *iquina* which expresses the same idea. As

from *túig*, *adlao*, *búlan* (month), *pagcáon* (meal)

iquinatúig (every year)

iquinaadlao (every day)

iquinabulan (every month)

iquinapagcáon, (every meal)

[27]

The interfix *r*, which bears no particular meaning, is here employed under the same rules as those established for its use in the figurative and verbal nouns.

The interfix *in* expresses imitation. It is added at the beginning of the primitive if the latter commences with a vowel. Otherwise, it is placed before the first vowel of the primitive. As,

from *Súlug*³⁰ (the archipelago of Súlu),

sinulúg (a fight or dance after the Suluan fashion)

from *tuyáo* (crazy),

tinuyáo (foolishness)

from *ínsic* (chinaman),

ininsic (chinese language; ways; or habit).

An and *on* among the derivatives, signify the idea of abundance or participation, *an* frequently conveying the idea of place. Both are appended to the primitive without any other particle, and complemented with an *h*, in the same way as in the formation of verbals.³¹ Examples:

from *pálad* (fate),

*paláran*³² (fortunate),

asáua	(wife),	asauáhan	(married man),
”			
salapi	(silver,	salapian	(wealthy)
”	money),		
curi	(difficulty),	curián	(stubborn person)
”			
sumat	(information),	sumatán	(credulous)
”			
burabud	(fountain),	buraburon ³³	(place where there are many
”			fountains)
taro	(wax),	taróhon	(an object that has wax on)
”			
tubac	(ant),	tubacón	(a thing that has ants on.)
”			

[28]

These particles are sometimes employed jointly, the *an* preceding the *on*. This compound affix, *anon*, bears the idea of great abundance, or birth or residence place, and is preceeded by an *h* according to the same rules established for *an* and *on*. Examples:

from manǵgad	(wealth),	manǵgáran	(wealthy),
			manggaránon (rich).
abacá	(hemp),	abacáhan	(person that has
”			hemp), abacahànon
			(person that owns
			much hemp),
Tan-	(a town so	tan-auananon	(native or resident of
”	called),		Tanauan).
Palo	(a town so	paloánon	(native or resident of
”	called),	contracted	Palo),

		<i>palon'on</i>	
„	Tolosa (a town),	tolosahanon,	(native or resident of Tolosa),
		contracted	
		<i>tolosán'hon</i>	
„	Dagami (a town),	dagamiánon,	(native or resident of Dagami),
		contracted	
		<i>dagamin'on</i>	
„	Maasin (a town),	maasinánon,	(native or resident of Maasin),
		contracted	
		<i>maasinhon</i> ³⁴	
„	Sugbu (Cebú),	sugbuánon,	(native or resident of Cebú),
„	Samar (province so called),	samaránon,	(native or resident of Sámar),
		contracted	
		<i>samárnon</i>	
„	Manila (Manila),	manilaanon,	(native or resident of Manila).
		contracted	
		<i>manilan'on</i>	
„	America (America),	americahanon,	(<u>American</u>).
		contracted	
		<i>americanhon</i> ³⁵	

OBSERVATIONS. There are other forms of derivatives, viz: *ca cat iquina* or *quina*, *taga*, *tagum* or *tagun*, *hi*.

Ca means also company, as from *tupad* (to be side by side) *catúpad* (the person side by side). [29]

Cat means season, as from “áni” (harvest), “cat-aní” (harvest time).

Iquina or *quina* expresses nature, as from “táuo” (man), “buhi” (alive), “iquinatáuo” (property peculiar to men), “quinabuhi” (life).

Taga, means origin or residence, possession, or measure, as from “Leyte” (Island so called), “súndanġ” (bolo), “íroc” (armpits), we have: “taga Leyte” (from Leyte), “tagasúndang” (one who bears a bolo), “tagairoc” (up to the armpits). When this particle *taga* means measure, it is sometimes replaced by *pa*, as from “háuac” (belly), “paháuác” (up to the belly).

Tagum expresses the idea of power, virtue, or peculiarity. When the primitive commences with *n*, the *m* of *tagum* is suppressed. When the primitive begins with a consonant not labial, the said *m* is replaced by *n*. It is sometimes combined with the affix *an*, As: from “matá” (eye) “baba” (mouth), “lipong” (confusion), we have “tagumatá” (peculiar disease of the eye), “tagumbabáan” (person whose words have a peculiar power or virtue), “tagunlipónġan” (one who has the power to make himself invisible).

Hi is also combined with the interfix *r* and the affix *an*, as from “polós” (profit), “himorólsan” (profitable). Among verbs *ha* is used instead of *hi*, as from “cáon” (to eat), “hacaraón” (eatable).

NOTE.—The past participles take sometimes the affix *an*, as

from cauil (fish-hook),	quinauilán (fish caught with “cauil”)
bitánà (a kind of fishing net),	binitanáan (fish caught with “bitanà”).

There are other transformative particles not so important as those already mentioned, and which the use will show to the student.

PROPER AND COMMON

Like in other tongues there is in Bisayan a distinction between proper and common nouns. *Tacloban*, *Catbalaógan*, [30] *Ilongġ-ilongġ* (Iloilo), *Espanya* (Spain), *Pedro* (Peter), *Guillermo* (William), etc., are proper nouns; *bucad* (flower), *bató* (stone), *áyam* (dog), etc., are common.

The Bisayan language has also familiar names for persons. As

of Pedro,	Pédonḡ, Endonḡ, Edónḡ, Edós, Pedó, etc;
Juan,	Uáuanḡ, Uauay, Uáuà, Uuán, Uuâ, etc;
”	
Vicente,	Tentenḡ, Titínḡ, Sente, Setée, etc;
”	
Rafael,	Pápenḡ, Paénḡ, Paél, Pápè, etc;
”	
Margarito,	Titonḡ, Itonḡ, Titoy, Itoy, etc.;
”	
Francisco,	Quicoy, Incoy, Quicò, etc;
”	
Juana,	Uánday, Uáday, etc.;
”	
Antonio,	Tónyo, Todóc, etc.;
”	
Alejandro,	Andonḡ, Andoy, etc.;
”	
Isabel,	Sabel, etc.;
”	
Gregorío,	Goyónḡ, etc.;
”	
Saturnino,	Satúr, etc.;
”	
Claudia,	Calán, etc.
”	

Among the names of places, there are a few formed by the preposition *can* (which means possession or property), and the particles *ca* (which denotes abundance), and *guin* (which conveys the idea of past passive action), as

Cansámqui (a place, which probably belonged formerly to one named *Samqui*)

Can-orquin (place probably owned formerly by one called *Orquin*)

Canramos,³⁶ transformed Carrámos (place probably owned or possessed in former times by one named *Ramos*) [31]

Cabuyúan (place where formerly there was much “buyu” (betelnut))

Cabalían (place where the strong current of the sea breaks the oars (balì))

Guintiguían (place in the “San Juanico strait,” where the strong current of the sea tests the rowers (tiguì))

Guintúlyan (a place in Basáy, Samar, where probably many fishes were caught (tulúy) with nets.)

Etc.

NOTE.—The names of persons among the Bisayan people are all Christian at the present time. Many of the surnames are Spanish, many others being of Bisayan origin as Lágbas, Pócroc, Macasáit, Cabaobao, Balasbas, Yagomyom, etc.

To indicate relationship, as the English *papa*, *mamma*, and respect, confidence, or tenderness, there are a number of Bisayan nouns, which show by themselves the relation between the speaker or writer and the person to whom the noun is applied. Examples:

for *papa*, tátay or tatáy, tátanğ or tatánğ, itáy, or itánğ;
mamma, nánay or nanáy, nánanğ or nanánğ, ináy, or inánğ.
 ,,

There are others applied to grandfathers and grandmothers, and also to those persons who act or are considered as fathers or mothers. Examples:

Mano, manóng, mamo, mamoy, babay, dudoy, dudù inco, tutoy, yuyu, iyô (applied to elder brothers, uncles or elder male relatives of any

degree, even to persons not related to but respected by the speaker or writer).

Mana³⁷ manang, manáy, mama, mamay. manding, duday, duda, insi tutay, yuya, tuta (applied to elder sisters, aunts or elder female relatives of any [32]degree, even to women not related to, but respected by the speaker or writer).

Tío, or tí, tia or tí (applied as á form of politeness and respect, respectively to men or women not related to or unknown by the speaker or writer).

Idoy, íntoy, budóy, busóy, and idáy, inday, udáy, idíng, iyíng, bididay, nonay, neneng, (applied with tenderness to boys or girls respectively).

NOTE.—The word *cuán* (so and so), not meaning anything by itself, is applied to persons or things whose names the speaker or writer does not know, or venture, or wish to express. As the phrase “so and so”, it helps a great deal in a conversation, and is used also instead of the verbs and other parts of speech.

The words *inín* (contracted of *iní nga*) and *adâ* (I guess, perhaps) are also used in the conversation, as auxiliary particles, they being then equivalent to the English *why*.

Examples:

Question.—“¿Guinsorat mo na an balos?” (Have you already written the answer?)

Answer.—“Oo guincoan co na gad” (Yes I already have).

Q.—¿Háin an basahón? (Where is the book?)

A.—Inin ... aadto ada ha ac solód (why ... I guess it is in my room)

Q.—Mapiráu, ¿ano in bubuhaton co? (I am sleepy, what shall I do?)

A.—Ada ... catúrog (Why ... to sleep).

POSITIVE, COMPARATIVE, AND SUPERLATIVE.

As in other languages, there are three degrees for adjectives, also used for substantives in Bisayan. These degrees are *positive*, *comparative* and *superlative*.

Nothing particular needs be observed about the positive degree, except what is mentioned in the foregoing paragraphs: [33]

The comparatives are formed exactly in the same way as the figuratives³⁸, the number of syllables being disregarded, as if all has more than two syllables.

from hataás (high),	<i>harohataás</i> (higher),
hobóg (intoxicated),	<i>horohobóg</i> (more intoxicated),
”	
táuo (man),	<i>tarotauó</i> (more of a man).
”	

In the formation of adjectives prefixed with *ma*, this particle is preferably disregarded, as if such particle did not exist, as

from maópay (good),	<i>maorooopáy</i> (better)
magbuság (white),	<i>maboroboság</i> (whiter), etc.
”	

There is another form of comparative consisting in the use of the combined particles *labi* (more) and *ca*, as

<i>labí ca maopay</i> (better),
<i>labí ca mabusag</i> (whiter).

This last form is sometimes used for superlatives.

The superlatives are of three classes:

Those which do not admit any comparison, and which we call absolute or supreme superlatives, as

guimaopáyi (the best of all);

those which are not so absolute, and which we call ordinary superlative, as,

capín ca maópay
maopay nga capín
maopay hin sogónḡ³⁹ } (very good);

and those which convey the idea of excess, and which we call excessive superlatives, as [34]

uraúra⁴⁰ ca maópay
maópay nḡa uraúra } (to good).

As is seen from the preceding examples, the supreme superlative is formed by adding to the beginning of the primitive the prefix *gui* and by appending to said primitive the affix *i*. The first syllable of the primitive may be doubled as use permits. As,

from hataás (high, tall),	guihataási, or guihahataasi	(the highest)
táuo (man),	guitáu'i	(a true and perfect man).

The first form is also adopted for the substantives to show the highest degree of identity as in this phrase:

An guiaamáyi mo gud an natauág ha imo
(It is your very father who calls you).

The ordinary superlative is formed with the particles *capin ca* or *labí ca* placed before the primitive, or with the particles *caópay*, *nãa capin*, or *hin sogonẽ* put after the primitive. As,

from mabido	(sorry)
capín ca mabidò	
labí ca mabidò	
mabidò caopay	} (very sorry)
mabidò nãa capín	
mabidò hin sogónẽ	

Some of the adjectives formed with particle *ma*, have another form for ordinary superlative, in doubling their root and disregarding the prefix *ma*, as from “masiróm” (dark), “masiromsiróm”⁴¹ (very dark).

The excessive superlative is formed with the particle [35] *uraúra ca* placed before the primitive, or the particle *nãa uraúra* located after the root. As,

from maasín	(salty)
uraúra ca maasín	} (excessively salty)
maasín nãa uraúra	

The idea of the excessive superlative is also expressed sometimes with the particles “lapás ca” (excessively), or with the phrase “dirí sonô hin ca” or “dirí socól hin ca” (out of measure), placed before the primitive, as

lapás ca maasín
 dirí sonô hin ca maasín
 dirí socól hin ca maasín.

NOTE.—The particles “labi” and “capin” take sometimes the affix *an*, as

from mahúsay	(orderly, beautiful),
--------------	-----------------------

labínan ca mahúsay (very beautiful);
from masáquit (painful),
masáquit nãa capínan (very painful).

CARDINAL, ORDINAL, PARTITIVE, AND DISTRIBUTIVE.

The cardinal adjectives are the following:

usá, contracted <i>us</i> ,	(one)
duhá	(two)
tuló	(three)
upát	(four)
limá	(five)
unóm	(six)
pitó	(seven)
ualó	(eight)
siyám	(nine)
napulò ⁴²	(ten) [36]
napulo cag ⁴³ usá	(eleven).
caruhaán ⁴⁴	(twenty)
catloán	(thirty)
cap'atán	(forty)
calim'an	(fifty)
caúnman	(sixty)
capitoán	(seventy)
caualoán	(eighty)
casiyamán	(ninety)
usá ca gatós	(one hundred)

duhá ca gatós	(two hundred)
usá ca yocót	(one thousand)
usá ca ríbo ⁴⁵	(ten thousand)
usá cagatós ca ribo (one million), etc.	

As it is noticed above, the cardinals are formed by the preposition “cag” (and), the prefix “ca” (which means collection) and the affix “an”, added to the primitives “usá, duhá, tuló, upáo, lima, unóm, pitó, ualó, siyám, napulo, gatós, yocót, ribo”, the phonetical reasons being taken in consideration. Thus we say:

caruhaán, not caduhaán,
 catloan, not catuloán,
 cap’atán not caupatán,
 calim’an not calimahán,
 caúnman, not caunoman.

The word “usa” is frequently contracted, especially in familiar language, by the supression of the last vowel. Thus:

us ca gatos	} instead of “usá” ca etc.
us ca yocót	
us ca ribo	

[37]

In reading the numbers, the English way is followed, the particles “uga may” being sometimes employed especially in cases of large amounts. Thus, to read this number

987654321,

we would say:

“Casiyamán cag ualó cayocót, pitó cagatós caúnman cag limá caribo, nãa may upát ca yocót, tuló ca gatós caruhaán cag usá.”

NOTE—In Bisayan, there is no word corresponding to the English *zero* (0). However, its figure is used in Bisayan. It is suggested that the word “lunǵág” (empty), or “uaráy” (nothing) be adopted as corresponding to the word “zero” which is derived from modern Latin *zephiram* from Arabic *cafrun*, *cifrun* or *sefer* (empty).

The ordinals are formed by employing the particles “ica” (which bears the idea of order), placed before the cardinal. As

ica usá,
ica napulò
ica calim’an
ica upat ca gatós
ica siyam ca yucót
icá pito ca ribo.

The ordinal of *usa* has also simple forms, as *siyahan*, *siyapá*, and frequently admits the particle *icag* instead of *ica*, as *icag usá*.

The partitives have exactly the same form, as the ordinals, except in that the ordinals *cag usa*, *siyahan* and *siyapá* are never used as partitives; and that there is the form *tunǵâ* and its variants *catunǵâ*, *tunǵâ* or *catunǵâ hin* or *nãa* (half), employed instead of *icaduhà*.

The phrase *ca bahín* (part) is frequently used in the partitives to avoid confusion. Thus [38]

an icaupát ca bahín (the fourth part)

The particle *ica* is sometimes contracted into *caas* “catunǵa” (half), “cauróg” (most).

The distributives are formed by adding to the cardinals the particle *tag* (which conveys the idea of distribution). As

tag dúha (two, each)
tag caualóan (eighty, each)
tag yúcot (thousand, each)

When the distributive bears the meaning of portion, the particle *iquina* is combined with *tag*. As

iquina tag duha (each two), etc.

COLLECTIVE

The collective nouns are formed by adding at the beginning of the primitive the prefix *ca* (which bears the idea of collection or reunion) and the affix *an*. As,

from bata (boy or girl), cabatáan (reunion of boys or girls)
táuo (person), catauóhan (reunion of persons).
duhá (two), caruhaán (twenty).

These forms are very frequently used to make the plural of the nouns, as of the singular *batá* we make the plural.

mga batà or cabataan.

NOTE—The particle *ca* is also employed to express abstract ideas, as

from buság (white color), mabuság (white), camabuság (whiteness)

The particle *pag* is sometimes added at the beginning of the particle, as

pagcamabuság (whiteness).

The collectives take also the form of the figuratives with or without the particles *ca* and *an*, as the use may permit, as [39]

caborobongtóhan,
borobóngto.

NOTE.—There is another class of nouns which may be called depreciative. They are limited in number. The following belong to such class:

for batà (child),

nagbobóto (a being born thru an explosion)

lumátud (person of big abdomen)

lugtuc,⁴⁶

motatô⁴⁷

motó, from botó (report of a gun, explosion);

for anác (son or daughter)

nahólbót (past participle of “hólbót” to pull out of a hole);

for baba (mouth)

nasárag (of “sárag” to put something in the mouth);

for camót (hand)

camrauón (from “cámram”, what an eagle does with its fingers);

for tiil (foot)

sincádol⁴⁸ etc.

There are despectives derived from their primitives, as,

for húbya (lazy), “húbsac”⁴⁹

The variations to which the Bisayan names are subject, are: gender, number, and cases. [40]

Gender.

The gender is scarcely regarded. We have however for few nouns the natural and grammatical genders.

Examples of natural gender:

MASCULINE	<u>FEMININE</u>
laláqui (male person)	babaye (woman)
lalaquí (male not person)	babayé (female not person)
amay (father)	iróy (mother)
bána (husband)	asáua (wife)
bata (uncle)	dadâ (aunt)
baylo (brother in law)	hipág (sister in law), etc.

Examples of gramatical gender:

MASCULINE	FEMININE
dudoy ⁵⁰	duday
tutoy	tutay

MASCULINE FEMININE

idoy	iday
intoy	inday
mano	mana
manoy	manáy
manong	manang ⁵¹
tío	tía ⁵² , etc.

Number

The plural is determined by the particle *mga* or by those for collectives as formerly seen⁵³, or by the interfix *g* among the adjectives. Examples:

of táuo (man) “mğa táuo,” or “catauóhan” (men),
of dacò (large), dagcò (large, plural). [41]
of matam-is (sweet), magtam-is (sweet, plural),
of hatáas (high), hagtáas (high, plural).

When the noun is preceded by numeral adjectives, the singular keeps its form, as

usá ca táuo (one man), napulò ca tauo (ten men),
usá nğa baláy (one house), calim’an nğa baláy (fifty houses).

Some adjectives do not admit the interfix *g*, for euphonical reason, as

of hubyà (lazy), mğa hubya, not húbgyà, etc.

Case.

There is no inflection for Bisayan nouns to distinguish their different cases, as in Greek and Latin. The cases are determined by the prepositions and by variable parts of speech preceding the noun.

IMPORTANT OBSERVATION.

There are great many Bisayan nouns composed of the same letters, but which have different meanings according to the accent they bear. Of these are the following:

anáy	(she-hog),	ánay	(before)
apó	(grandson or grand-daughter),	ápò	(a thing fully introduced)
áyao	(distributive possession),	ayáo	(no, imperative)
bábà	(mouth),	babá	(to carry a thing on the back)
babáye	(woman),	babayé	(female not person)
baga	(red-hot coal or wood),	bága	(lung), bagá (like)
bálay	(turn),	baláy	(house)
bálod	(a kind of dove),	balód	(wave)
bálos	(return),	balós	(revenge)
bánus	(abundant, thick),	banús	(to scrub)
báranǵ	(an amulet),	baráng	(knot) [42]
bayáo	(brother-in-law),	báyao	(to lift up)
bucád	(flower),	búcad	(to dig up)
búhat	(work),	buhát	(to raise)
buhi	(alive),	buhi	(losse)
buláo	(yellow),	búlao	(to provoke a stranger)
búrong ⁵⁴	(fog),	buróng	(to throw)

busà	(reprimand),	búsà	(therefore)
cóbal	(thread),	cobál	(corn, callosity)
comót	(sunked),	cómot	(quick)
dósol	(pain of the stomach),	dosól	(despective form of “cáon”, to eat)
hóron	(to pass the night),	horón	(farm)
igo,	(just),	igô	(to be hit)
lága	(flame),	lagà	(cooked)
láya	(a net for fishing),	layà	(to wither), layâ (withered)
laláqui	(man),	lalaquí	(male, not person)
látos	(reaching, overtaking),	latós	(to whip)
lúya	(weakness),	luyà	(lime), luyâ (restlessness), luy-a (ginger)
muláy	(play),	múlay	(to teach)
obós	(low),	óbos	(to exhaust)
usá or usâ	(one),	úsa	(to marvel)
úpa	(reward),	upá	(rice chaff)
pátag	(plane),	patág	(a kind of basket)
píli	(a tree so called),	pilì	(to select)
pálad	(palm),	palád	(a fish)
pusò	(flower of banana),	pusô	(rice especially cooked)
pusâ	(pounded),	pusà	(to wash the feet)
púto	(a dainty so called),	pútò	(partition), putó (last son or daughter)
sábot	(agreement),	sabót	(filament or to <u>understand</u>)
sácay,	(<u>passenger</u> or companion on a boat),	sacáy	(to embark)
sócot	(frequent),	socót	(to collect) [43]

súso	(teat),	susò	(thickset), susô (a mollusk so called)
tíao	(joke),	tiáo	(maniac)
tíma	(finished),	timá	(uneven)
túba	(a plant so called),	tubâ	(wine from cocoanut or nipa)
tubó	(sugar-cane),	túbò	(to grow), etc.

Transposition of accents.

The accent of a word frequently changes its place upon its transformation.

In the diminutives formed by repetition of the root or by the affix *ay*, the acute accent is always placed upon the penult. As

from baláy,	balaybálay
saróual,	sarouálay
„	
balóto,	balotóhay.
„	

The grave accent of the root is preserved; and its angular accent becomes grave, which is preserved in its repetition. As

from dacò,	dacòdácò
bohô (hole),	bohòbóhò (little hole).
„	

When the primitive has the acute accent on its penult, said accent is transferred to the last syllable of the original primitive, the repeated primitive following the preceding rules. As.

from dáhon,	dahóndáhon
cáhoý,	cahoýcáhoý
”	
halípot,	halipótay
”	
maópáy,	maopay-ópay
”	
hataás,	hataastáas
”	

In the figuratives, the same rules are followed; and when the interfix *ro* is employed, the primitive generally loses its acute accent which is placed upon the penult of the figurative. As

from sacayán,	sarosacáyan.
---------------	--------------

[44]

In the verbal nouns, it is a general rule that when the verb root has its acute accent on its penult, its verbals have said accent trasplaced to their last syllables, and *viceversa*, as

from sarát, (to write),	from bása (to read)
parasúrat	parabasá
tigsúrat	tigbasá
magsusúrat	magbarasá
susurátan	barasahán
susuráton	barasahón
masúrat	mabasá
isusúrat,	ibarasá;

except when the transformative particle is *ma* meaning desirableness, in which case the acute accent is always on the last syllable; and also in case of the particle *hi*, where the accent is always put on the penult. As

masuratsurát,
himása.

In case where the penult, of the verb root is necessarily long, as when its vowel is followed by more than one consonant, and when the last syllable of the root is pronounced independently from the consonant or consonants preceding it, then the original acute accent of the root is preserved on the penult of the verbal. As

from cánhi (to come),	dól-ong (to bear, to accompany)
paracánhi	paradól-ong
tigcánhi	tigdól-ong
cumaránhi	domoról-ong
caranhían	dorol-óngan
caranhíon	dorol-óngon
macanhíon	madol-óngon
icaránhi	idoról-ong
hanğaránhi	hinonól-ong

In the derivatives, when the accent is on the penult of the primitive, it is also placed on the penult of the [45] derivative; and when the accent is on the last syllable of the primitive, it is also put on the last syllable of the derivative, as

from áram,	maáram
bayáu,	mabaráyau
púsod,	himósod
búua,	buuáon

tubác, tubacón.

It must be noted that we refer to the *acute* accent. It sometimes happens that the last syllable of the primitive has angular accent, in which case such accent is discomposed, the grave being kept and the acute being transposed to the penult of the derivative, as

from salâ, saláan,

where the *a* of the penult really bears two accents, angular and grave, the angular not being employed for the reason that is it not necessary, as the last two *aa* are pronounced separately⁵⁵, and because it is not proper, as the angular accent is only used at the endings of the words.⁵⁶

In the derivatives formed with *taga*, or *tag*, or *maqui* the accent of the root is not changed. As

from bódo,	(salted fish),	tagabódo
baláy	(house),	tagbaláy
calámay	(dark sugar)	maquicalámay

The comparatives formed with, the interfix *ro*, have always the accent on the last syllable no matter where it was in the primitive. As

from halábà (long),	harohalabâ
uguis (white),	urouguís.

The superlatives formed with the prefix *gui* and the affix *i* always have the accent on the penult, without regarding where it was in the primitive. As [46]

from halárum (deep),	guihahalarúmi
matahúm (beautiful),	guimamatahúmi

The collectives follow the way in which their primitives are accented, so, if their, primitives have the accent on the penult, they have it on the penult, and when the primitives have the accent on the last syllable they also have it on their last syllables. As

from bátà (child),	<u>cabatáan</u>
baláy (house),	cabalayán.

It must be observed also that there are nouns which, thru phonetical variations, have more than one forms. Of such words are the following:

báchò, bíchò	(groaning)
bándoc, búndac	(kick)
<u>guipic</u> , guipác	(broken)
guisî, guşî, quisî, cusî	(sagged)
Panalaron, Palanaron, Planaron	(one of the suburbs of the town of Tacloban), ⁵⁷
piló, lopí	(fold)
quíróg, coróg	(trembling)
quirógpos, corógpos	(surtout)
sitsit, sutsut	(whistle)
taclap, taplac	(blanket), etc.

There are also words composed of the same letters but sounding differently and having different meanings thereby, on account of the separation with which some of their syllables are pronounced. As

bágo	(a tree),	bag-o	(new)
lauay	(<u>saliva</u>),	lau-ay	(repugnance)
tagóc	(<u>resin</u>),	tág-oc	(<u>inarticulate voice</u>). [47]

bágang (an insect),	bág-ang (grinder)
bútol (bulky),	bút-ol (throat)
bulánon (moony),	bul'ánon (from Bohol), etc.

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PRONOUNS

There are four classes: personal, demonstrative, possessive, and relative.

PERSONAL.

They are the following:

SINGULAR		PLURAL
Acó	(I)	Quitá, camí (we) ⁵⁸
Icáo, ca, ⁵⁹	(thou, you)	Camó (you)
Hiyá, or siyá ⁶⁰	(he or she)	Hirá, or sirá (they)

Declension

The cases are four; nominative, genitive, objective, and vocative.

First person.—Singular.

Nominative. Acó (I)

—

Genitive.— Nácon,⁶¹ ácon, (of, by me)
co

Objective.— Ha ácon, dácon⁶² (to, for, in, at, on, upon, over, under, etc.
me)

Plural.

Nominative,— Camí—quitá.⁶³ (we)^[48]

Genitive.— Nímon, ámon—aaton, aton, ta (of, by us)

Objective.— Ha ámon, dámon—ha áton, dáton (to, for, etc. us)

Second person.—Singular.

Nominative.— Icao, ca (thou, you)

Genitive.— Nimo, imo, mo (of, by thee, or you)

Objective.— Ha imo, dimo (to, for, etc. thee, or you)

Vocative.— Icao (thou, or you)

Plural.

Nominative.— Camó (you)

Genitive.— Niyo, iyo (of, by you)

Objective.— Ha iyo, díyo (to, for, etc. you)

Vocative.— Camó (you)

Third person—Singular.

Nominative.—	Hiyá	(he, or she)
Genitive.—	Niya, iya	(of, by him, or her)
Objective.—	Ha iya, díya	(to, for, etc. him or her)
Vocative—	Hiyá	(He, or she).

Plural.

Nominative—	Hirá	(They)
Genitive—	Nira, ira	(of, by them)
Objective—	Ha ira, dira	(to, for etc., them)
Vocative—	Hirá	(they).

DEMONSTRATIVE.

They have the same forms both for the singular and plural, as follows:

adí (this, these, nearer to the speaker than to the listener)

ini (this, these)

itó (that, those, nearer to the speaker than to the listener, corresponding to the Spanish “ese, esa, eso, esos, esas”)[49]

adto (that, those, far from both the speaker and the listener, and corresponding to the Spanish “aquel, aquella, aquellos, aquellas”).

When used before the nouns, they have the particle *nga* after them; said particle being frequently contracted with the pronoun. As

adí *nga*, contracted adín,
iní *nga*, contracted inín,
itó *nga*, contracted itón,
ádto *nga*, contracted ádton.

The form *itón* sometimes takes again the particle *nga*. So it is said *itón nga batâ* (that boy or girl).

Adí, adto in some places have their variants *yadi*, *yadto*.

In plural, the particle *mga* is placed after the preceding combinations;

They have two cases: subjective and objective.

Declension.

Adí.—Singular

Subjective— Adí, adí *nga*, adín (this)

Objective— Hadí, hadí *nga*, hadín, or hadin *mga* (of, etc. this)

Plural.

Subjective— Adí, adi *nga mga*, adín *mga* (these)

Objective— Hadí, hadi *nga mga*, hadín, or hadin *mga* (of, etc., these).

Iní.—Singular

Subjective— Iní, iní nã, inín (this)

Objective— Hiní, hiní nã, hinín (of, etc., this)

Plural.

Subjective— Iní, ini nã mĩa, inín mĩa (these)

Objective,— Hiní, hini nã mĩa, hinin mĩa (of, etc., these).

[50]

Itó.—Singular.

Subjective.— Itó, itó nã, itón, itón nã (that)

Objective— Hitó, hitó nã, hitón, hitón, nã (of, etc. that)

Plural.

Subjective.— Itó, itó nã mĩa, itón mĩa, itón nã mĩa (those)

Objective.— Hitó, hitó nã mĩa, hitón mĩa, hitón nã mĩa (of, etc., those)

Adto.—Singular.

Subjective.— Adto, adto nãa, adton (that)

Objective.— Hadto, hadto nãa, hadton (of, etc., that)

Plural.

Subjective.— Adto, adto nãa mĩa, adton mĩa (those)

Objective.— Hadto, hadto nãa mĩa, hadton mĩa (of, etc., those)

The forms *adton* and *hadton* are frequently used instead of *itón*, *hitón* when the object referred to is very close to the listener. *Itón* is sometimes replaced by the forms *hadto* and *haton*. Examples:

mopáy *adtón* hiní (that one is better than this)

condi darodacô iní *hadton* (but this is larger than that)

say co *hatón* (I prefer that one).

POSSESSIVE.

They are the following:

SINGULAR		PLURAL	
acon, co (my, mine)		aton, ta, amon (our, ours)	
imo, mo (thy, thine, your, yours)	iyo		(your, yours)
iya (his or her)		ira	(their)

The forms *co*, *mo*, *ta* are used only after the nouns. [51]

The same distinction exists between *aton* and *amon*, as between *quitá* and *camí*.⁶⁴

They have also two cases: subjective, and objective.

Declension.

Acon.—Singular.

Subjective.— Acon, co (my, mine)

Objective.— Ha acon, han acon (of, etc., my)

Plural.

Subjective.— Aton, ta, amon (our, ours)

Objective.— Ha aton, han aton, ha amon, han amon (of, etc., our)

Imo.—Singular.

Subjective.— Imo, mo (thy, thine, your, yours)

Objective.— Ha imo, han imo (of, etc., your, thy)

Plural.

Subjective.— Iyo (your, yours)

Objective.— Ha iyo, han iyo (of, etc., your)

Iya—Singular.

Subjective—Iya (his, her, hers)

Objective.— Ha iya, han iya (of, etc., his, her)

Plural.

Subjective.— Ira (their)

Objective.— Ha ira, han ira (of, etc., their)

These plurals refer to the subjects possessing. The plural referring to the objects possessed, is formed in each case by using the particle *mãa*, as

Acon mãa cabogtóan (my brothers or sisters)

Iyo mãa láuas (your bodies)

Ira mãa cabalayán (their houses)

[52]

RELATIVE

They are as follows:

Nãa (that, which)

anó (what)

bisan anó (whatever)

hín'o or sin'o⁶⁵ (who)

bisan hin'o or bisan sin'o	(whoever)
háin	(which)
bisan háin	(whichever)

These pronouns, except *hin'o* and *bisan hin'o* have no inflection for cases.

Nãa.

This relative always refers to the subject of the verb. It never relates to the complement. So the sentence:

“the house *that* Peter builds is big”,

cannot be translated literally into Bisayan. It is expressed by passive voice. Thus:

“an baláy *nãa* guintitindog ni Pedro, dacô”;

literally “the house that is being built by Peter is big”, And this:

“the book which you gave me yesterday”

is translated:

“an basahón *nãa* ihinátog mo ha acon cacolóp”;

literally “the book which was given by you to me yesterday”

This pronoun is indispensable when a substantive is qualified by an adjective, as

maópay <i>nãa</i> táuo	(good man,)	not maúpay táuo,
bucad <i>nãa</i> mahamót	(fragrant <u>flower</u>)	not bucád mahamot ⁶⁶

It differs from the conjunction *nãa* (that) in that the [53]pronoun always refers to a noun, never to a verb.

NOTE.—This particle *nãa* expresses in some instances the idea of “saying,” “question,” “answer,” etc., as when we say:

Nãa ni Pedro: “tãgui acó hin salapí.” Dáyon batón ni Juan, *nãa* niya: “uaray co salapí.”

Peter said: “give me money.” John immediately replied by saying: “I have no money.”

Pacanhía hi Guillermo. *Nãa* natón⁶⁷ “guinquiquína hanãlan ca didto.”

Make Guillermo come. Tell him: “you are needed there.”

When applied to the third person it is frequently combined with the particle *laónã* as:

Násiringã hi Pedro, *nãalaónã*: “magtotoón aco.”

Peter said: “I shall study”.

This special idea conveyed by the word *nãa* seems to show in other instances in the Bisayan tongue, as when it is said depreciatively:

¡Ca damò hin im *nãanã*!

How many things you ask or talk!

where the doubled *nãa* means request or talking.

Anó.

This pronoun has the same use as the English *what*, except when the latter is used as an objective relative, in which case the said English pronoun is translated by the article *an*. As when it is said:

“*What* you need is patience, not science,” which is translated:

An guinquinahanġlan mo an pag-ġlob, dirġ hibaró. [54]

Bisan anó.

Bisan ano means “anything” or “whatever.” Examples:

Whatever you do I’ll know it.

Bisan ano in buháton mo, hisasabotán co.

Give me anything eatable.

Tágui aco hin *bisan anó* nġa hacaraón.

It is frequently replaced by *ano lâ*, or *anoano lâ*. Ex.:

Anything you may desire, I’ll give you.

Ano lâ nġa caruyágon mo, ihahatag co ha imo.

You wish to see everything.

Anoano lâ buót mo hiquit’an.

When it is preceded by an article, it means “which,” as

Which horse do you like?

¿*An anó* nġa cabayo in buót mo?

Hin'o

This relative is only used in the interrogative phrases. It is not employed as the English “who” when this relative serves as “that”. So this phrase

“that person *who* talks is my brother” is translated: “itón tauo *nãa* nagyayácan, acon bugto,” not “itón tauo *hin'o* nagyayácan, etc.”

It has two cases: subjective and objective.

Declension

	SINGULAR		PLURAL
Subjective	Hin'o	(who)	Hirá hin'o (who)
—			
Objective—	Canáy, can canáy	(of, etc. whom whose)	Canda canáy (of, etc., whom, whose)

Bisan hin'o

Bisan hin'o means “whoever” or “anyone”. Example: [55]

Whoever is there, let him come.

Bisan hin'o in adâ, pacanhía.

Anyone knows him.

Bisan hin'o náquilála ha iya.

It also has two cases: subjective and objective.

Declension.

	SINGULAR		PLURAL	
Subjective.	Bisan	(whoever)	Bisan hirá	(whoever)
—	hin’o		hin’o	
Objective.—	Bisan	(of, etc.,	Bisan canda	(of etc.,
	canáy	whomever)	canáy	whoever)

Hain.

Hain means “which.” Examples:

Which of these hats is yours?

¿Háin hiní nãa mĩa calò in imo?

Similarly to “ano,” the pronoun “háin” is only used in the interrogative forms, never as *nãa* (that). So the phrase

“the book which you saw”

is translated

“an basahón *nãa* imo quinità”

(literally: the book that was seen by you), and not

“an basahon *háin* icao quinmità.”
.....

Bisan háin.

It is equivalent to the English “whichever,” Examples:

Whichever of those books satisfies me.

Didâ hitó nãa mga basahón *bisan háin* maopay co.

NOTE.—These relatives *hain* and *bisan háin* must not be confounded with the adverbs of the same form, *háin* (where) and *bisan háin* (wherever). The former refer only to nouns, the latter to verbs. [56]

CONTRACTIONS.

The pronouns are frequently contracted as follows:

acó, ácon,	to <i>ac</i>
nácon	<i>nac</i>
”	”
dácon	<i>dac</i>
”	”
camí	<i>cam</i>
”	”
quitá	<i>quit</i>
”	”
námon	<i>nam</i>
”	”
ámon	<i>am</i>
”	”
náton	<i>nat</i>
”	”
áton	<i>at</i>
”	”

dámon *dam*

”

dáton *dat*

”

icáo *ic*

”

nímo *nim*

”

imo *im*

”

dimo *dim*

”

camó *cam*

”

adi *ad*

”

iní *in*

”

itó *it*

”

adín *ad*

”

itón *it*

”

hadí *had*

”

hadín *had*

”

hiní *hin*

”

hinín *hin*

”

hitó	<i>hit</i>
	”
hitón	<i>hit</i>
	”
hatón	<i>hat</i>
	”
ácon	<i>ac</i>
	”
áton	<i>at</i>
	”
ámon	<i>am</i>
	”
imo	<i>ini</i>
	”
bisan anó	<i>bis ano</i>
	”
bisan háin	<i>bis hain</i>
	”

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VERBS

The verbs may be grouped in the following classes:

As to their conjugation: active, passive, negative, interrogative, suppletory, impersonal, defective.

As to their inflections: primitive, and progressive.

The ACTIVE verb represents the subject as acting, as:

acó násugò (I order).

The PASSIVE verb represents the subject as being acted upon, as:

acó sinúsugò (I am ordered).

The NEGATIVE verb involves a negation, as:

ayáo catúrog (do not sleep).

The INTERROGATIVE verb involves a question, as:

¿diín ca cadto? (where did you go?)

The SUPPLETORY verb supplies the lack of all auxiliary and a few other verbs as from *ini* (this), we have:

íiní acó (I am here), to express the verb “to be,” in Bisayan.

The IMPERSONAL verb has not a definite subject, as:

náurán (it rains).

The DEFECTIVE verb lacks one or more of its principal parts as,

iyá (receive it).

The PRIMITIVE verb is used in its original and simplest form as:

acó násurát (I write).

The PROGRESSIVE verb denotes continuance of the action, as:

acó nagusurát (I am writing). [58]

CONJUGATION

VOICES

They are active and passive. The passive voice has three classes: direct, indirect, and instrumental.

The direct passive is where the subject is the direct object in active voice, as:

suratá an acon n̄garan (write my name; literally: let my name be written by you).

The indirect passive is where the subject is an indirect object of the verb in its active voice, as:

suratí an imo amáy (write to your father; literally: let a letter be written by you to your father),

The instrumental passive is where the subject is the instrument or real object of the action, as:

igsurát iní nãa pluma (write with this pen; literally: let this pen be used by you in writing.)

MOODS AND TENSES

There are four moods: infinitive, indicative, imperative, and subjunctive,

The infinitive has two tenses: present, and gerund; three in passive voice: present, gerund, and past participle.

The indicative has three. The ordinary forms have present, past and future. The irregular forms have present, imperfect past, and past.

The imperative and subjunctive, have each one tense: present.

INFINITIVE: The present is frequently used as a noun, as:

an pagcáon (the meal).

The gerund is frequently used in compound sentences for past tenses, as:

[59]

han pag-abot co (when I arrived: literally: upon my arriving).

The past participle is employed as an adjective as:

hinigugma co nãa iróy. (my dear mother; literally: mother loved by me).

NOTE.—There are in Bisayan forms resembling and equivalent in many instances to the Latin infinitive future ending in *rus*, in active, and in *dus*, in passive, as *amaturus* and *amandus*. Such Bisayan forms are those formed by the particle *um* combined with the interfix *r* or its substitutes (See page [20](#)), as:

cumaráon (one who is to eat)

caraonón (a thing to be eaten).

INDICATIVE. Ordinary forms. The present corresponds to the same tense, in English, and also to the Spanish and Latin imperfect past. As:

nácaon acó (I eat)

nácaon acó han pag-abot mo (I was eating when you arrived)

The past tense represents the English present perfect, and past, indicative mood. As:

nagsurat acó (I have written, I wrote)

The future corresponds to the English future tense, as:

másurat acó (I shall write)

Suppletory forms. The present represents the English present and future tenses, indicative. As:

He is here: hiyá háhani.

He will be here tomorrow: hiyá hahaní buás.

The imperfect past and past tense corresponds to the same tense of the Latin and Spanish languages: as

didinhi⁶⁸ hi Juan han pag-abót co (John was here, when I arrived) [60]

IMPERATIVE AND SUBJUNCTIVE. The single tense (present) of each of these moods corresponds to the same tense in English, as:

cadto búas (go there to-morrow)

cun cumadto ca buas, tauága acó (If you go there tomorrow, call me).

OBSERVATIONS. 1. The English past perfect, indicative, is supplied in Bisayan by the present tense, indicative, of the potential form which we shall see later.⁶⁹ As:

han imo pag-abót nacacatima na acó (when you arrived, I had already finished).

2. The English future perfect tense is supplied in Bisayan by the future tense, indicative, of the potential form. As

umabút ca nğani macacatima na aco (when you arrive, I shall have finished).

3. The Latin and Spanish imperfect past tense, subjunctive mood, is supplied in Bisayan by the present, subjunctive, and future indicative. As

Cun gumican acó niyán, diri co hiya igquiquita buás (If I should go today, I would not meet him to-morrow).

4. The Latin and Spanish perfect past tense, subjunctive, is supplied in Bisayan by the past tense, indicative.

5. The Latin and Spanish plusquamperfect past tense, subjunctive, is supplied in Bisayan by the past and future (potential) tenses, indicative, respectively. As

Cun nagdágmit acó, hinaabután co cunta hiyá (If I had hastened, I should have reached him).

6. The Latin and Spanish imperfect future tense, subjunctive, is supplied in Bisayan by the present subjunctive.

7. And the perfect future tense, subjunctive, of said languages, is supplied in Bisayan by the present, indicative, potential form. [61]

NUMBER AND PERSON.

There are two numbers: singular and plural.

There are three persons: first, second, and third. Except in the imperative, the inflections of the verbs generally do not change, in each tense. However, the progressive and suppletory forms frequently undergo some changes in plural, as

acó nagsusurát (I am writing),

camí nanunurát (we are writing)

INFLECTIONS.

The inflections are determined by particles, which are shown in the following tables:

(In the tables below, the dash represents the root; the sign (d) means that the first syllable of the root is doubled; *s* and *p* mean singular and plural, respectively).

TABLE 1

Primitive active

Infinitive

Present, and gerund: PAG—, *s*; PANG—, PAM—, PAN—, *p*

Indicative

Present: NA—

Past: INM—, or —INM—

Future: MA—

Imperative

(the root unaltered)

Subjunctive

UM—, or —UM—

OBSERVATIONS:

Infinitive. The present and gerund are formed by the prefix *pag*, and the root. In the plural, the *g* of *pag* undergoes the following changes:

When the root begins with a vowel *o*: with the consonant *c*, the *pag* is changed into *pang* the *c* then being suppressed. Examples:

from “arò” (to ask), pag-arò, pl. panãaro.
“catúrog” (to sleep), pagcatúrog, pl. panãatúrog.

If the root commences with a labial consonant, except *m*, *pag* is transformed into *pam*, and then the labial consonant disappears. Examples:

from “báyad” (to pay), pagbáyad, pl. pamáyad.
“pilì” (to select), pagpilì, pl. pamilì.

When the root begins with *m*, *pag* is transformed into *pan*, the *m* of the root remaining in it. Example:

from “múlay” (to teach), pagmúlay, pl. panmúlay.

If the root commences with any other consonant, *pag* is replaced by *pan*, the said consonant being then suppressed except when it is a *g* or *h*.
Examples.

from “hapon” (to perch), paghápon, pl. panhápon,
“gúbat” (to invade), paggúbat, pl. pangúbat,
,,
“búao” (to visit), pagdúao, pl. panúno,
,,
“tubò” (to grow), pagtubò, pl. panubò,
,,

“surát” (to write), pagsurát, pl. panurát.

”

Indicative.—Present. The transformative particle of this tense is the prefix *na*, which must always be pronounced long, in order not to confound it with the short *na* of the passive potential form, as it will be seen later.⁷⁰ As

(long *na*) nápilì acó (I select)

(short *na*) napílì acó (I was selected).

Past.—This tense is determined by the interfix *inm* placed [63] between the first consonant and the first vowel of the root.

When the root commences with a vowel, this particle is simply prefixed to the root. As,

from “surát” (to write), “abót” (to arrive) acó sinmurát⁷¹ (I write), inmabót hirá (they arrived)

NOTE.—The *m* of *imn* is frequently suppressed. As,

from “múlay” (to teach), abót (to arrive)

minúlay, inábot.

”

Future.—The particle determining this tense is the prefix *ma* which must be always pronounced long, so as not to confound it with the short *ma* used among the verbal and derivative nouns. As,

(long *ma*) hiyá macáon (he or she will eat)

(short *ma*) hiyá macaón (he or she is a glutton)

(long) máboronẽ (there will be fog)

(short) mabóronẽ (confuse)

Imperative.—It is simply the root without any transformative particle.

NOTE.—There is a form consisting in doubling the first syllable of the root. But this form is used only in the preceptive language, as when we say: “tauágon ca nḡanì, bábatón” (whenever you are called, always answer).

Subjunctive.—The single tense of this mood is determined by the interfix *um* which is placed between the first consonant and the first vowel of the root. If the root begins with a vowel, the interfix is added to the beginning as from “arò” (to ask), “umarò,” from “cáon” (to eat) cumáon.

Example:

Root: surát.

Infinitive

Present, and gerund { singular: pagsurát } (to write, writing)
 { plural: panurát }

[64]

Indicative

PRESENT

SINGULAR

acó }
icaó } násurat { I,
hiyá } { they, you } write,
 { he, she } etc.

PLURAL

camí quitá }
camó } násurat { we
hirá } { you } write
 { they }

PAST

acó, etc. inmurát (I, etc. wrote) camí, etc. sinmurát (we, etc. wrote)

FUTURE

acó, etc. másurat (I shall, etc. write) camí, etc. másurat (we shall, etc. write)

Imperative

surát icao	(write)	sumurát ⁷² camí, hirá	(let us, them write)
sumurát ⁷² hiya	(let him or her write)	surát quitá, camó	(let us, you write)

Subjunctive

acó, etc. sumurát (I may, etc. write) camí, etc. sumurát (we may, etc. write)

TABLE 2.

Progressive active

Infinitive.

(the same as that of the primitive active)

Indicative

Present: NAG(d)—, s; NANG(d)—, NA(d)—, or NAN(d)—, p.

Past: NAG—, s; NANG—, NA—, or NAN—, p.

Future: MAG(d)—, s; MANG(d)—, MA(d)—, or MAN(d)—, p.

Imperative.

PAG—, s; PANG—, PA—, or PAN—, p.

Subjunctive

MAG—, s; MANG—, MA—, or MAN—, p.

[65]

OBSERVATIONS.

Infinitive. Its forms are exactly the same as those of the primitive active.

Indicative. Present. Its singular is determined by doubling the first syllable⁷³ of the root, prefixed by *nag*.

Its plural is formed according to the first letter of the root. When the root commences with a vowel, or with the consonant *c* as

arò (to ask)

cáon (to eat)

the formation takes the following process: *nã* is added to the beginning of the root, *c* being suppressed, as

nãaro, nãáon;

the first syllable is doubled,⁷³ as

nãanãaro, nãanãáon,

to which the particle *na* is prefixed, as

nanãanãarò, nanãanãáon,

which is the final form.

When the root commences with a labial consonant, as

báyad (to pay)

múlay, (to teach)

pili (to select),

the formation of the plural is as follows: the first consonant of the root is replaced by *m*, or not altered if it is an *m*, as

máyad, múlay, mili;

then the first syllable is doubled,⁷³ as [66]

mamáyad, mumúlay, mimilí;

and the prefix *nan* is employed, as

nanmamáyad, nanmumúlay, nanmimili,

the final form.

The last *n* of *nan* is frequently suppressed, as

namamáyad
namimili.

When the root begins with a dental consonant as

dapò (to approach)
tábon (to cover)
surát (to write)

the formation of the plural consists in replacing the first consonant by *n*, as

napó, nabon, nurat,

whose first syllable is doubled⁷⁴, as

nanapo, nanabon, nunurat,

to which the particle *na* is prefixed as

nanánapó, nanánabon, nanúnurat,

the final form.

If the root commences with any other consonant, the plural is formed by doubling the first syllable of the root, and by prefixing the particle *nan* to the root so transformed. Examples:

from hugas (to wash),	nanhuhugas.
lohód (to kneel down),	nanlolohod.
rabot (to pull),	nanrarabot.

Past. The singular is formed by adding to the root the prefix *nag*. [67]

The plural is formed exactly as the plural present, except in that the first syllable of the root transformed is not doubled.

Future.—The formation of this tense is the same, both in singular and plural, as that of the present, except in that the prefixes used here are *mag*, *ma*, *man*, *mang*, instead of *nag*, *na*, *nan*, *nang*.

Imperative.—In singular, the prefixes *pag* and *mag* are employed. In plural, the prefixes, *pa*, *pan*, *pang*, *ma*, *man*, *mang*, are used in the same way and cases as the prefixes *na*, *nan*, *nang*, in the present indicative.

Subjunctive.—It is formed in the same way as the future indicative, except in that the first syllable of the root is not doubled here.

Root: surát (write)

Infinitive

Present, and gerund { singular: pagurát } (to be writing, being writing)
 plural: panurat }

Indicative

PRESENT			
SINGULAR		PLURAL	
acó, etc., nagsusurát	(I am, etc. writing)	camí, etc. nanunurát	(we are, etc. writing)
PAST			
acó, etc. nagsurát	(I was, etc. writing)	camí etc. nanurát	(we were, etc. writing)
FUTURE			
acó, etc. magsusurát	(I shall, etc. be writing)	camí, etc., manunurát	(we shall, etc. be writing)
<i>Imperative</i>			
pagsurát icao	(be writing)	panurát quita, camó	(let us, you be writing)
magsurát hiya	(let him or her be writing)	manurát camí, hirá	(let us, them be writing)
<i>Subjunctive</i>			
acó etc. magsurát	(I may, etc. be writing)	camí, etc. manurát	(we may, etc. be writing)

[68]

TABLE 3

Primitive direct passive

Infinitive

Present, and gerund: PAG—A, S; PANG—A, PAM—A, PAN—A, *p*

Past participle: IN—, or —IN—

Indicative

Present: IN(d)—, or —IN(d)—

Past: IN—, or —IN—.

Future:	(d)—ON.
	Imperative
—A.	
	Subjunctive
—ON.	

Infinitive. The present and gerund are determined in singular by the prefix *pag* and the affix *á*. *Pag* is used as in the active voice. The affix *a* is accented (if the last syllable of the root is accented) and simply appended to the root prefixed by *pag*. This affix is sometimes *ha*. The use of *a* or *ha* follows the same rules established for the use of the affixes *an* and *han* (See page 15 of this book).

In plural the prefixes *pang*, *pam*, *pan*, are employed in combination with the affix *a*. The said prefixes are used in same way as their similar in the primitive active. (See page 62 of this book).

The past participle is formed by the interfix *in* placed between the first consonant and the first vowel of the root. If this begins with a vowel the *in* is prefixed to the root. As

from “cáon” (to eat), quináon (eaten)
 “inóm” (to drink), ininóm (drunk)
 ,,

[69]

Indicative.—Present. This tense is formed by doubling the first syllable of the root and by then placing in it (after doubling the said first syllable) the interfix *in*, in a similar way as in the past participle. (See the preceding observution). As,

from cáon, quinacáon

inóm, iníinóm⁷⁵

”

Past.—The formation of this tense is exactly the same as that of the past participle seen above.

Future.—This tense is formed by doubling the first syllable of the root and appending to it the affix *on*. As

from “caón,” cácaónon

“inóm,” iinomón, contracted iinmon.

”

Imperative.—The single form of this mode, consists in the root appended by the affix “á.” It must be observed that this affix “á” in the imperative bears the idea that the order or command is always directed to the second person or first plural, If such order or command is directed to some other person, not to the second, or first (quitá) plural then the subjunctive is used. As

higugmaá an Dyos (love God; lit.: let God be loved by you)

higugmaá ta an catadúnġan (let us love justice; lit.: let justice be loved by us).

higugmaón nira an igcasitáuo (let them love the fellow-man: lit.: let the fellowman be loved by them).

The last form is also frequently used for the second person, singular and plural, and for the first person, plural. As

higugmaón mo an Dyos (love God)

higugmaón niyo, etc.

higugmaón námon, etc.

higugmaón ta, etc.

Subjunctive. The single form of this mode consists in [70]the root appended by the affix *on*, as it is seen in the preceding examples.

Example:

Root: surát

Infinitive

Present, and gerund { singular: pagsuratá } (to be written, being written).
plural: panuratá

Past participle: sinurát (written)

Indicative

PRESENT

SINGULAR		PLURAL	
acó, etc.	(I am, etc. written)	camí, etc.	(we are, etc.
sinúsurat		sinúsurat	written)

PAST

acó, etc. sinurát	(I was, etc. written)	camí, etc. sinurát	(we were, etc written)
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FUTURE

acó, etc.	(I shall, etc. be	camí, etc.	(we shall, etc be
susuratón	written)	susuratón	written)

Imperative

suratá acó, icáo, hiyá, camí, quitá, camó, hirá (let me, thee, you, him, her, us, you them be written by you)

Subjunctive

acó, etc. suratón	(I may, etc. written)	camú, etc. suratón	(we may, etc. be written)
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TABLE 4.

Progressive direct passive.

Infinitive.

Present, and gerund: PAG—A, S; PANG—A, PAM—A, PAN—A, *p*.

Past participle: GUIN—, S; PINA—, PINAN—, *p*.

Indicative

Present: GUIN(d)—, S; PIN(d)—, PINAN(d)—, *p*.^[71]

Past: GUIN—, S; PINA—, PINAN—, *p*.

Future: PAG(d)—ON, S; PA(d)—ON, PAN(d)—ON, *p*.

Imperative

PAG—A, S; PA—A, PAN—A, *p*.

Subjunctive

PAG—ON, S; PA—ON, PAN—ON, *p*.

OBSERVATIONS.

Infinitive. Present and gerund. The singular is formed by the root prefixed by *pag* and affixed by *a*. In plural the prefixes *pa*, *pan*, or *pang* are employed in the same cases as those mentioned for the use of *nang nam*, and *na* of the present tense, indicative, of the progressive form, active voice.⁷⁶

The past participle is formed by the prefix *guin* added to the root.

Indicative. Present. In singular the first syllable is doubled,⁷⁷ and the prefix *guin* is employed.

In plural the prefix *pina* is used and the root is transformed exactly in the same way as the plural, present tense, indicative; of the progressive form active voice.⁷⁸

Past. The same as the present, except in that the first syllable of the root transformed is not doubled.

Future. Its singular is formed by the prefix *pag*, added to the root whose first syllable is doubled,⁷⁹ and by the affix *on*.

Its plural is formed by the prefix *pa*, *pang* or *pam* and the root transformed in the same way as in the use of *na nang* or *nam* and as the transformation of the root in the plural, present tense, indicative of the progressive form, active voice.⁸⁰ [72]

Imperative. It consists in the root prefixed by *pag* and affixed by *a*. We reproduce here the observation made on the imperative, primitive form, direct passive.⁸¹

Subjunctive. Its singular is formed by the root prefixed by *pag* and affixed by *on*. Its plural consists in the use of *pa pang* or *pam* in the same way as in the plural, present tense indicative, progressive form, active voice,⁸² and of the affix *on*.

Example:

Root: *surát*

Infinitive

Present, and gerund { singular: *pagsurátá*
plural: *panuratá* } (to be written, being written)

Past participle: *guiusurát* s.; *pinanunurát* p. (written).

Indicative

PRESENT

SINGULAR		PLURAL	
acó, etc.	(I am, etc. being	camí, etc.	(we are, etc. being
guinsusurát	written)	pinanunurát	written)

PAST

acó, etc.	(I was, etc. being	camí etc.	(we were, etc.
guinsurát	written)	pinanurát	being written)

FUTURE

acó, etc.	(I shall be, etc.	camí, etc.	(we shall be, etc.
pagsusuratón	being written)	panunuratón	being written)

Imperative

Pagsuratá acó, icao, hiya, camí, hira (let me, you, him or her, us, you, them be being written).

Subjunctive

acó, etc.	(I may be, etc.	camí, etc.	(we may be, etc.
pagsuratón	being written)	panuratón	being written)

[73]

TABLE 5

Primitive indirect passive

Infinitive.

Present, and gerund: PAG—I, S; PA—I, PAN—I, PANG—I, *p*.

Past participle: —IN—AN, or IN—AN

Indicative.

Present:	IN(d)—AN, or —IN(d)—AN
Past:	—IN—AN, or IN—AN
Future:	(d)—AN
	Imperative.
	—I
	Subjunctive.
	—AN

OBSERVATION:

Infinitive. Present and gerund. This form consists in the root transformed by the affix *i*, and by the prefix *pag* in singular, and *pang*, *pan*, or *pa* in plural, according to the rules above established for the use of these prefixes.⁸³

Past participle,—This form consists in the root transformed by the interfix *in* and the affix *an*. The use of the interfix *in* follows the same rules as those hereinbefore established for the said interfix.⁸⁴

Indicative.—Present. This tense is determined by doubling the first syllable of the root, and then (after the said first syllable being doubled) by placing the interfix *in* between the first consonant and the first vowel of the root. If the root begins with a vowel, the interfix *in* is prefixed to the root whose first syllable has been already doubled. [74]

Past.—This tense has the same form as the past participle.

Future.—The form of this tense consists in doubling the first syllable of the root and by appending to it the affix *an*.

Imperative. Its form consists in the root appended by the affix *i*.

The same observation is made here, as that on the imperative of the primitive direct passive.⁸⁵

Subjunctive. It's form is the root appended by the affix *an*.

Example:

Root: surát

Infinitive

Present, and gerund { singular: pagsuratí } (to be addressed with a letter, being
plural: panuratí } addressed with a letter)⁸⁶

Past participle: sinuratán (addressed with a letter)

Indicative

PRESENT

	SINGULAR		PLURAL
acó, etc.	(I am, etc. addressed	camí, etc.	(we are, etc.
sinusuratán	with a letter)	sinusuratán	addressed with a
			letter)

PAST

acó, etc.	(I was, etc.	camí, etc.	(we are, etc.
sinuratán	addressed with a	sinuratán	addressed with a
	letter)		letter)

FUTURE

acó, etc.	(I shall be, etc.	camí, etc.	(we shall be, etc.
susuratán	addressed with a	susuratán	addressed with a
	letter)		letter)

Imperative

uratí acó, icáo, hiyá, camí, quita, camó, hirá (let me, thee, you, him, her, us, you, them be addressed with a letter)

Subjunctive

acó, etc.	(I may be, etc.	camí, etc.	(we may be, etc.
suratán	addressed with a letter)	suratán	addressed with a letter)

[75]

TABLE 6.

Progressive indirect passive

Infinitive

Present and gerund:	PAG—I, <u>S</u> ; PAN—I, PAN—I, PANG—I, <i>p</i> .
Past participle:	GUIN—AN.

Indicative

Present:	GUIN(d)—AN, <i>s</i> ; PINA(d)—AN, PINAN(d)—AN, PINANG(d)—AN, <i>p</i> .
Past:	GUIN—AN, <i>s</i> ; PINA—AN, PINAN—AN, PINANG—AN, <i>p</i> .
Future:	PAG(d)—AN, <i>s</i> ; PA(d)—AN, PAN(d)—AN, PANG(d)—AN, <i>p</i> .

Imperative

PAG—I, S; PA—I, PAN—I, PANG—I, *p*.

Subjunctive

PAG—AN, S; PA—AN, PAN—AN, PANG—AN, *p*.

OBSERVATIONS.

Infinitive.—Present, and gerund. Their single form is the same as their corresponding primitive form indirect passive.

Past participle. It is distinguished by the prefix *guin*.

Indicative.—Present, singular. The first syllable of the root is doubled⁸⁷ and the affix *guin* added. Its plural is formed as its corresponding in the progressive direct passive, except in that here the affix *an* is added.⁸⁸

Past.—The forms of this tense are the same as those of their corresponding form in the progressive direct passive, except in that here the affix *an* is added.⁸⁹ [76]

Future.—The same as that of the progressive direct passive, except in that the affix *an* is used here instead of *on*.

Imperative.—The same as that of the progressive direct passive, except in that the affix *i* is used here instead of *a*.

Subjunctive—Also the same as that of the progressive direct passive, except in that the affix *an* is here used instead of *on*.

Example:

Root: surát

Infinitive

Present, and gerund { singular: pagsuratí
plural: panuratí }

Past participle: guinsurát

Indicative

PRESENT

SINGULAR

PLURAL

acó, etc. guinsusuratán camí, etc. pinanunuratán

PAST

acó, etc. guinsuratán camí, etc. pinanunuratán

FUTURE

acó, etc. pagsusuratán camí, etc. panunuratán

Imperative

pagsuratí acó, icáo, hiyá, camí, quitá, camó, hirá

Subjunctive

acó, etc. pagsuratán camí, etc. panuratán

TABLE 7

Primitive instrumental passive.

Infinitive.

Present, and gerund: PAG—AN, S; PA—AN, PAN—AN, PANG—AN, *p*.

Past participle: I—IN—, IIN—[77]

Indicative

Present: I—IN(d)—, IIN(d)—

Past: I—IN—, IIN—

Future: I(d)—

Imperative

I—

—AN

Subjunctive

I—

OBSERVATIONS:

Infinitive, Present, and gerund. The same observation is made as that on the same tenses of the primitive, active, with the addition that here the affix *an* is appended to the root.

Past participle. It is formed by the prefix *i* and the interfix *in*. If the root commences with a vowel, the prefix and the interfix are joined, as

from “arò” (to ask), iinarò.

Indicative.—Present, past. They are the same as the present and past tenses indicative of the primitive direct passive, with the addition of the prefix *i*.

Future.—It is formed by doubling the first syllable of the root and by using the prefix *i*. As

isusurát, iaaro.

Imperative.—The first form consists in prefixing to the root the particle *i*. The second form consists in affixing to the root the particle *an*.

Subjunctive. It consists in prefixing to the root the particle *i*.

NOTE.—The instrumental passive is also employed to express substitution; as when we say in English: [78]

Read this word for me: ibása acó hiní nãa polongẽ (literally: let me be substituted by you in reading this word).

Example:

Root: surát

Infinitive

Present and gerund { singular: pagsuratán } (to be used in writing, being used
 plural: panuratán } in writing)

Past participle: isinurát: used in writing

Indicative

PRESENT

	SINGULAR		PLURAL
acó, etc.	(I am, etc. used in	camí, etc.	(we are, etc. <u>used in</u>
isinusurát	writing)	isinusurát	writing)

PAST

acó, etc.	(I was, etc. used in	camí, etc.	(we are, etc. used in
isinurát	writing)	isinurát	writing)

FUTURE

acó, etc.	(I shall etc. be, used	camí, etc.	(we shall etc. be, used
isusurát	in writing)	isusurát	in writing)

Imperative

isurát or suratán acó, icao, hiya, camí, quitá, camó hira (let me, thee, you, him, her, us, you, them be used in writing).

Subjunctive

acó, etc.	(I may etc. be, <u>used in</u>	camí, etc.	(we may etc. be, used in
isurát	writing)	isurát	writing)

TABLE 8.

Passive Progressive Instrumental

Infinitive

Present and gerund: PAG—AN, S; PA—AN, PAN—AN, PANG—AN, *p*.

Past participle: IGUIN—

Indicative

Present: IGUIN(d)—, S; IPINA(d)—, IPINAN(d)—, IPINANG(d)—, *p*.

[79]

Past: IGUIN—, S; IPINA—, IPINAN—, IPINANG—, *p*.

Future: IG(d)—, S; IPA(d)—, IPAN(d)—, IPANG(d)—, *p*.

Imperative

PAG—AN, S; PA—AN, PAN—AN, PANG—AN, *p*.

IG—, S; IPA—, IPAN—, IPANG—, *p*.

Subjunctive

IG—, S; IPA—, IPAN—, IPANG—, *p*.

OBSERVATIONS:

The observations made on the conjugation of the progressive direct passive are applied to the above conjugation except in that the present, and gerund take the affix *an*, and that the past participle, the present, and past indicative, and the subjunctive, plural, take the prefix *i*, and in that the imperative has the affix *an*, and the subjunctive singular the affix *on*, and the future, imperative, and subjunctive have a *g* after the prefix *i*.

Example:

Root: surat

Infinitive

Present, and gerund { singular: pagsuratán
plural: panuratán

Past participle: iguinsurát.

Indicative

PRESENT

SINGULAR

PLURAL

acó, etc. iguinsusurát. camí, etc. ipinanunurát

PAST

acó, etc. iguinsurát camí, etc. ipinanurát

FUTURE

acó, etc. igsusurát camí, etc. ipanunurat

[80]

Imperative

Pagsaratán or igsarát acó, icáo, hiyá. Panoratán or ipaanrát camí, quitá, camó, hirá.

Subjunctive

acó, etc. igsurát. camí, etc. ipaaaurát.

NEGATIVE FORMS

These forms consist in employing the adverbs “diri” before the inflections of the infinitive, present and future indicative, and subjunctive; “uaráy” before the past indicative, and “ayáo” before the imperative.

As to the inflections of the root, they are the same as those of the corresponding; affirmative except the past indicative, which always takes

the inflections of the imperative.

Example:

Negative Primitive Active.

Root: surát

Indicative.

Present, and gerund { singular: diri pagsurát } (not to write, not writing)
plural: diri panurat

Indicative

PRESENT

SINGULAR

PLURAL

diri acó, etc.	(I do not, etc.	diri camí, etc.	(we do not, etc.
násurát	write)	násurát	write)

PAST

uaráy acó, etc.	(I did not, etc.	uaráy camí, etc.	(we did not, etc.
surát	write)	surát	write)

FUTURE

diri acó, etc.	(I shall not, etc.	diri camí, etc.	(we shall not, etc.
másarát	write)	másurat	write)

Imperative

ayáo surát icáo, quitá, camó (let you, us not write)

diri sumurát hiyá, camí, hirá (let him, us, them not write) [81]

Subjunctive

diri acó, etc.	(I may not, etc.	diri camí, etc.	(we may, etc. not
sumurát	write)	sumurát	write)

NOTE.—The past consists sometimes, among the primitive forms, in the root having the first syllable doubled; and among the progressive forms, it consists in the prefix *pag* and the root whose first syllable is doubled. In plural, the *pag* undergoes the same changes as in the active conjugation.

Examples:

uaráy acó susurát (I did not write)
uaráy acó pagsusurát (I did not write)

Negative Progressive Active.

Root: surát

Infinitive

Present, and gerund	{	singular: diri	} (not to be writing, not being writing)
		pagsurát	
		plural: diri panurát	

Indicative

PRESENT

SINGULAR		PLURAL	
diri acó, etc.	(I am, etc. not writing)	diri camí, etc.	(we are, etc. not writing)
nagsusurát		nanunurát	

PAST

uaráy acó etc.	(I was etc. not writing)	uaráy camí etc.	(we were etc. not writing)
pagsurát		panurát	

FUTURE

diri acó etc. magsusurát	(I shall etc. not be writing)	diri camí, etc. manunurát	(we shall not, etc. be writing)
-----------------------------	----------------------------------	------------------------------	------------------------------------

Imperative

ayao icao pagsurát	(do not be writing)	ayao quitá, camo panurát	(let us, you, not be writing)
diri hiya magsurát	(let him not be writing)	diri camí, hirá manurát	(let us, them not be writing)

Subjunctive

diri acó, etc. magsurát	(I may, etc. not be writing)	diri camí, etc. manurát	(we may, etc. not be writing)
----------------------------	---------------------------------	----------------------------	----------------------------------

[82]

INTERROGATIVE FORMS

They are determined by the phrases “cay anó” (why), and by “diín”, “háín” (where), and by “san-o”, “cacan-o” (when, past and future respectively).

Cay ano

The interrogative conjugation by this phrase simply consists in the regular conjugation of the verb, placing before every inflection the said phrase followed by the particle *nãa*. As

- ¿cay anó nãa nasurat ca? (why do you write?)
 ¿cay anó nãa sinmurát hiya? (why did he or she write?)

¿cay anó ñga macadto quita? (what shall we go there for?) etc.

Diin, hain.

The interrogative primitive formed; by these adverbs, has only two inflections: one which consists in the original root, and which is the past tense indicative; and the other which consists on the same root, its first syllable being doubled; this last form is for the present and future tenses, indicative. These three tenses are the only tenses that this conjugation has. The adverb “diín” is for the present and past tenses. The adverb “háin” is for the future. Thus:

Present: ¿diin acó susurat? (where do I write?)

Past: ¿diin ca surát? (where did you write?)

Future: ¿háin camí susurát? (where shall we write?)

The interrogative progressive only differs from the preceding one in that the particle *pag* precedes all of the inflections. In plural this *pag* becomes *pa*, *pan*, or *pang*, according to the same rules laid on the progressive active form.⁹⁰ Thus:

¿diín ca pagsusurát? (where are you writing?)

¿háin camó panunurát? (where will you be writing?)

[83]

In passive voices, these same forms are followed except in that the root takes the affix *a* in the direct passive and the affix *i* in the indirect passive, and the prefix *i* for the primitive form, or the prefix *ig* for the progressive form, in the instrumental passive. Thus:

¿diín suratá?

¿diín suratí?, etc.

NOTE.—Instead of the prefix *ig* or *i*, in the instrumental passive, the affix *an* is frequently employed. As

¿diín susuratán? for ¿diín isusurat? etc.

Cacan-o san-o

“Cacan-o” is placed before the past indicative; “san-o” is used before the future, indicative. They are the only two tenses of this kind of conjugation. As to the inflections in the primitive form, the past is simply the root, and the future is the root, whose first two letters are doubled. As

¿cacan-o camo surat? (when did you write?)

¿san-o ca cácanhi? (when will you come?)

In the progressive form the root takes the prefixes *pag* for the singular and *pa*, *pan*, *pang* in plural.

In the passive, the affix *a* is used in the direct passive; the affix *i*, in the indirect passive; and the prefix *i* or *ig* in the instrumental. These prefixes are frequently replaced by the affix *an*. Examples:

¿cacan-o surata?

¿Ban-o susuratí? etc

IMPORTANT OBSERVATION. The verb referred to by any adverb of time takes the same form, as to the indicative, as the adverbs *cacan-o* and *san-o*. As

buás acó cacanhi

(tomorrow I shall come)

canina han ága acó pagsurát (this morning I have written)⁹¹

[84]

SUPPLEMENTARY VERBS

Irregular conjugation

The suppletory verbs in Bisayan are those formed by the pronouns “iní”, “adí”, “itó”, “itón”, “adtó”, “adtón”; to supply the English “to be”, and those formed by the adverbs “dinhi”, “didi”, “dida”, “dídton”, “díthon”, “dídto”, to supply the same verb “to be” and also the verbs “to come”, and “to go.” Of these verbs we call pronominal those derived from pronouns, and adverbial those derived from adverbs.

PRONOMINAL FORM.

This is a defective form, as it has only one inflection which consists in doubling the first vowel it being for the present tense, indicative mood. Ex.:

iini acó	(I am here)
aadí camí	(we are here)
iito hiya	(he or she is there)
iiton hira	(they are there)
aadto ca	(you are there)
aadton camo	(you are there)

NOTE. In some places of Leyte, as Dulag, these forms are not used but instead of them, the pronouns are doubled as: iniini, adiadi, itoito, etc.

In using these forms it is preferable to have the pronouns follow them.

ADVERBIAL FORM.

This conjugation is common to the adverbs *dínhi*, *didí*, *didto*, *dithon*, *didto*.

Root: *dinhi* (here)

Infinitive

Present, and gerund { singular: *pagdinhi* } (to be here, being here)
 plural: *paninhi* }

[85]

Indicative

PRESENT, AND FUTURE

SINGULAR

PLURAL

<i>acó</i> , etc. <i>aanhi</i> or	(I am, etc. shall	<i>camí</i> , etc. <i>aanhi</i> or	(we are, etc. shall
<i>hahaní</i>	be, etc. here)	<i>hahani</i>	be, etc. here)

Imperfect past, and past.

<i>acó</i> , etc. <i>didinhi</i>	(I was, etc. here)	<i>camí</i> etc. <i>didinhi</i>	(we were, etc.
or <i>nacanhí</i>		or <i>nacanhí</i>	here)

Imperative

dinhi icao, etc. (be here, etc).

Subjunctive

<i>acó</i> , etc. <i>maanhi</i> or	(I may etc. be	<i>camí</i> , etc. <i>maanhi</i> or	(we may, etc. be
<i>mahani</i>	here)	<i>mahani</i>	here)

OBSERVATIONS.

Infinitive.—Present and gerund. Here the particles *pag* and *pan* are employed in the same way as among the primitive active voice⁹². As

SINGULAR PLURAL

pagdinhí	paninhí
pagdidí	panidí
pagdidâ	panidâ
pagdidton	panidton
pagdithon	panithon
pagdidto	panidto.

Indicative.—Present and future. It is formed by replacing the first two letters of the root with the prefix *a* doubled. As

from dinhi	aanhi,
didí	aadí
”	
didâ	aadâ
”	
didton	aadton
”	
dithon	aathon
”	
didto	aadto
”	

NOTE.—The form *hahani* is the transformation of *aanhi*, where the *h* is doubled and transposed by placing each *h* before each *a*. The other pronouns have not such a form.

Imperfect past and past. Their single form consists in doubling the first two letters of the root, as

from *dinhi* *dídinhí*
 didí *dídídí*
 ”
 didâ *didídâ*
 ”
 didton *dídídton*
 ”
 dithon *dídíthon*
 ”
 didto *dídídto*⁹³
 ”

Imperative.—It simply consists in the root.

Subjunctive.—It has two forms. The first consists in prefixing to the root the particle *ma*; the second form consists in replacing the first two letters of the root with the prefix *maa*. As

from *dinhi*, *madínhi*, *maánhi*
 didí. *madídí,* *maadí*
 ”
 didâ, *madídâ* *maadâ*
 ”
 didton, *madidton,* *mandton*
 ”

dithon, madithon, maathon
”
didto, madidto, maadto.
”

NOTE—The form *mahani* is a transformation of *maanhi* like *hahani* of *aanhi*.

The verbs that supply the English “to come” and “to go” are conjugated as ordinarily. But they have a basis for conjugation, derived from the original root, and which we call *conjugational root*. So from the original roots

dinhi, didí, didá, didton, dithon, didto,

we have the corresponding conjugational roots:

cánhi, cadi, cadá, cadton, cathon, cádto. [87]

The form followed in this conjugation is that of a primitive. Thus from the root “canhi”, we have:

Infinitive, present and present participle: pagcanhi (to come, coming)

NOTE.—But the plural of this tense is irregular. It is

pagpacánhi (to come, coming, plural).

Indicative present: acó, etc., nácanhi.

past: acó, etc., quinmánhi.

”

future: acó, etc., mácanhi.

”

Imperative: cánhi, etc.

Subjunctive: acó, etc. cumánhi.

NOTE. The past, indicative, and the present, subjunctive, have the irregular forms, *nacanhí* and *macanhí* respectively, which must not be confounded with the present and future, indicative, as the accent of the former in past and subjunctive is on the penult and not on the first syllable as in the present and future indicative.

Observation.

We have seen that when the verb “to be” refers to a place it is frequently expressed in Bisayan either, by the pronominal form or by the adverbial form.

But when the verb “to be” is equivalent to the Spanish “estar”, i.e., when it represents state, situation, or contingent condition, it is then expressed by the particles *pag*, *nag*, *ma*, *na* added to the words which are predicate of “to be” in English. As

I shall be sorry: *magamabidò acó*.

In cases where the verb “to be” needs to be represented by an independent word, the expressions “amo”, “asya”, “asáy”, “say” (which express identity, rather than a mere essence, substance or existence) are frequently employed. As [88]

	Hi Pedro ámo an tag-iya hiní nãa baláy	
Peter is the owner of this house	{	hi Pedro asya an tag-iya, etc.
		hi Pedro asáy tag-iya, etc.
		hi Pedro say tag-iya, etc.

In other cases, the verb “to be” is not translated into Bisayan. As

God is omnipotent: an Dyos macagagáhum.

IMPERSONAL VERBS

The impersonal verbs follow the two forms: primitive, and progressive.

Owing to the fact that the Bisayan tongue has indirect and instrumental passive, all of the verbs, no matter to what class they belong, have passive voice. So the intransitive verbs of other languages have passive voice in Bisayan, The same thing happens to the impersonal verbs. They have indirect and instrumental passives which are complete in their conjugation.

Thus, in passive, there is no impersonal verb in Bisayan. The forms of conjugation of this kind of verbs are the same as those of the regular verbs.

Examples:

nagdadalogdog (it thunders)

nagiinuran (it rains persistently)

inuuranán hirá (the rain falls on them; literally: they are rained)

etc.

DEFECTIVE VERBS

The following belong to such class: *may* (to have) which has only, one form.

á (no, I do not wish)

iyá (receive it)

ohò (look at it)

May is also used as impersonal and then it means “there, is, there was, etc.”; conó (he or she says or said; they say or said;—it is said, it was said) [89]

ambót (I do not know)

The English “to have” is also expressed in Bisayan by the root *may-ada*, whose irregular conjugation as follows:

Infinitive

Present, and gerund: pagcaada or pagcamay-ada (to have)

PRESENT

SINGULAR

acó, etc. may ada or
nagcacaada. (I etc.
have)

PLURAL

camí, etc. may ada or
nangagcacaada (we, etc.
have)

PAST

acó, etc. nagcaada (I, etc. had) camí, etc. nangagcaada (we, etc.
had)

FUTURE

acó etc. magcacadá (I shall, etc. camí, etc. mangacacaada (we shall,
have) etc. have)

Imperative

pacaadá

Subjunctive

magcaadá

NOTE 1. The strict meaning of the form *may-ada* is “to acquire”, rather than “to have”, for which the defective *may* is used.

2. The impersonal and defective *may* is very frequently joined to verbs in passive voice, it keeping its impersonal character. As

May naquita co nga bucad (I saw a flower; literally: There is a flower seen by me),

its regular order being:

may bucad nga naquíta co.

May tinagan co hin salapi (I gave money to someone; literally: there is some one given by me with money);—where the words “tauo nga” are tacit, the regular form being:

May tauo nga tinagan co hin salapi.

OTHER CLASSES OF VERBS

There are other kinds of verbs whose distinguishing character consists in their conjugational roots. They are always [90] derived from the ordinary verbs, but bear different meaning, although conjugated as ordinarily.

The conjugational roots in active voice are different from those in passive.

From the original root SURAT we have the following classes:

ACTIVE VOICE

Conjugational root Indicative Present		Classes
sinurat	nagsisinurat	CONTINUATIVE
casurat	nacacasurát	ABSOLUTE POTENTIAL
cagsurat	nacacagsurát	RELATIVE POTENTIAL
isusúrat	náisusurat	ABSOLUTE APTATIVE
ipagsusúrat	náipagsusurat	RELATIVE APTATIVE
pagpasurát	nápasurát	ABSOLUTE PERMISSIVE
papagsúrat	napapagsurát	RELATIVE PERMISSIVE
papágsurat	pinasusurát	ABSOLUTE IMPERATIVE
papagsurát	pinapagsurát	RELATIVE IMPERATIVE
susúrat	nasusúrat	IMPREMEDITATIVE
suratsúrat	nasuratsúrat	ABSOLUTE DIMINUTIVE
suratsurát	nágsusuratsúrat	RELATIVE DIMINUTIVE
suratsurát	násuratsurát	ABSOLUTE REPETITIVE
suratsurát	nagsusuratsurát	RELATIVE REPETITIVE
pasuratsúrat	nagpapasuratsurat	RECIPROCATIVE
From the original root “hadì,” we have		
pacahádi	napacaháhì	IMITATIVE
From the original root “buság,” we have		
pagticabusag	náticabusag	ABSOLUTE GRADUAL
pagticabusag	nagtiticabusag	RELATIVE GRADUAL
From the original root “sayáo,” we have		
sayáo	nagsasayáo	FIGURATIVE

As it may be observed above, one original root may give a great number of different classes of verbs, as the nature of the root and use may permit. The subdivision [91] *absolute* and *relative* of these classes corresponds exactly to the primitive and progressive forms already explained.

The continuative is distinguished, in its conjugational root, by the interfix *in* and it expresses persistence of the action. As

nagtitinóoc an batà (the child is crying persistently)

The potential is determined, in its conjugational roots, by the prefix *paca* or *pacag* (absolute and relative) and it means ability on the part of the subject to execute the action expressed by the original root. As

dirì hiyá nacacasurát, cay dirí (he cannot write, because does not
maaram know how to)

dirì hiyá nacacagsurát, cay damò (he cannot write, because he is busy)
in buhat

The optative has, in its conjugational root the prefix *i* or *ipag* (absolute and relative), and it represents the idea of desire. The absolute means a desire about to be executed; the relative signifies a mere intention; As

náilalacat na hiyá han ac pag- (he was about to depart when I met
abotá him)

naipagsusurat acó ha imo (I was intending to write you)

When the absolute optative bears the particle *ca*, it expresses then proximate passivity, as

naicahorológ an bunãa (the fruit is about to fall)

The permissive is distinguished in its conjugational root by the prefix *pagpa* or *papag* (absolute and relative) and it means leave or abandonment. As

diri hiya napaútang (he does not lend any money; literally: he does not
hin salapí permit any money to be lent)

When the original root of this form is a substantive referring to a place, then the idea of “going” or “coming” is represented. As

mapa Manila camí (we shall go to Manila)

napahorón hi Juan (John went to the farm)

[92]

The imperative, which means order or command, is determined by the prefix *papag* and the interfix *in*. As

pinacacadto ca (you are ordered to go there)

pinapagtoón camo (you are commanded to study)

The impremeditative is determined by the repetition of the first syllable of the original root, and expresses a sudden and inconsiderate action. As

náyayácan ca lá (you talk inconsiderately)

The formation of the diminutive class follows that of a diminutive noun.⁹⁴
As

nagtatanomtanom cami hin camote (we are cultivating a little camote)

The repetitive has the same formation as the diminutive.

The repetitive has the same formation as the diminutive, except in that the accent is always on the last syllable of the repetitive. It follows the formation of the figurative nouns,⁹⁴ when the root has more than two syllable, or when the last syllable is preceded by more than one consonant or is pronounced separately from the preceding consonant. The repetitive expresses a repeated action. As

magtatanomtanóm acó hin abacá (I shall cultivate hemp again)

macarocánhi acó buás (I shall come again to-morrow)

The reciprocate is formed exactly as the diminutive, except in that the reciprocate uses the prefix *pa*. It means a mutual action. As

nagpapasuratsurat camí (we are writing to each other)

It is also formed by the prefixes *pag* and *ig*, and the affix *an*. As “pagquítaan (to meet), iguinquiquita iguinhihisugat”. It has a passive character.

The imitative is formed by the prefix *paca*, the same as the absolute potential, but here the root is always a noun, the object of the imitation. As

[93]

hiyá napacamaáram (he pretends to be learned)

hiyá napacacatsilà (he affects to be a Spaniard)

The gradual is determined by the prefix *pagtica*, and means an action by degrees. As

nagtiticapasò inin adlao (the day is becoming hotter)

nagtiticalamrag an bulan (the moon is becoming brighter)

The figurative verb has the same form as its original, except in the accent which is always on the last syllable. As

nagsasayáo hiyá tunğud han (he jumps as if he was dancing, on account of
caol-ol the pain he feels)

DIRECT PASSIVE

CONTINUATIVE VERB

Conjugational root: *sinúrat*

- Infinitive: present and gerund: *pagsinurata s; pagpinanuráta p.*
Indicative: Present: *guinsisinúrat s; guinpipinanúrat p.*
Past: *guinsinúrat s; guinpinanurat p.*
Future: *pagsisinuraton s; pagpipinanuraton p.*
Imperative: *pagsinuráta s; pagpinanuráta p.*
Subjunctive: *pagsinuraton s; pagpinanuraton p.*

ABSOLUTE POTENTIAL

Conjugational root: *hisurát*

- Infinitive: *paghisurát s; panhisurát p.*
Indicative: Present: *nahasusurát*
Past: *nahasurát*
Future: *mahasusurát*
Imperative: (no imperative)
Subjunctive: *mahasurát.*

RELATIVE POTENTIAL

Conjugational root: *hisurát*

- Infinitive: *paghisurát s; panhisurát p.*^[94]

Indicative: Present: nahapapagsurát s; nanhihisurát *p*.
Past: nahapagsurát s; nanhisurát *p*.
Future: mahapapagsurát s; manhihisurát *p*.
Imperative: (no imperative)
Subjunctive: mahapagsurát s; manhisurát *p*.

ABSOLUTE OPTATIVE

Conjugational root: isusurat

Infinitive: pag-isusurata s; pag-ipanunurata *p*.
Indicative: Present: guin-iisusurat
Past: guin-isusurat.
Future: pag-iisusuraton.
Imperative: pagisusurata
Subjunctive: pag-isusuráton.

RELATIVE OPTATIVE

Conjugational root: isusúrat

Infinitive: pag-ipagsusurata s; pag-ipanunuráta *p*.
Indicative: Present: guin-iipagsusurat, s; guin-iipanunurat.
Past: guin-ipagsusurat s; guin-ipanunurat.
Future: pag-iipagsusuráton s; pag-iipanunuraton.
Imperative: pag-ipagsusurata
Subjunctive: pag-ipagsusuraton.

(The permissive verbs have no passive)

ABSOLUTE IMPERATIVE

Infinitive: papagsuratán s; papanuratán *p*.

Indicative: Present: ipinasusurat.

Past: ipinasurat.

Future: ipasusurat.

Imperative: ipasurát.

Subjunctive: ipasurát.

RELATIVE IMPERATIVE

Conjugational root: pasurát

Infinitive: papagsuratán, s; papanuratán, *p*.^[95]

Indicative: Present: ipinápagsurát, s; ipinápanurát, *p*.

Past: ipinapagsurát, s; ipinapanurát, *p*.

Future: ipápagsurát, s; ipápanurát, *p*.

Imperative: ipapagsurát, s; ipapanurát, *p*.

Subjunctive: ipapagsurát, s; ipapanurát, *p*.

IMPREMEDITATIVE

Conjugational root: susuráta

Infinitive: pagsusuráta, s; panunuráta, p.
Indicative: Present: sinususurat.
Past: sinusurát.
Future: sususuráton.
Imperative: susuráta.
Subjunctive: susuráton.

ABSOLUTE DIMINUTIVE

Conjugational root: sinuratsúrat

Infinitive: pagsuratsuráta, s; panuratsuráta, p.
Indicative: Present: sinusuratsúrat,
Past: sinuratsúrat.
Future: susuratsuraton.
Imperative: suratsurata.
Subjunctive: suratsuráton.

RELATIVE DIMINUTIVE

Conjugational root: guinsuratsúrat

Infinitive: pagsuratsuratá, s; panuratsúrata, p.
Indicative: Present: guinsusuratsurat, s; pinanunuratsurat, p.
Past: guinsuratsurat, s; pinanuratsurat, p.
Future: pagsusuratsuraton, s; panunuratsuratón, p.
Imperative: pagsuratsuráta, s; panuratsuráta, p.

Subjunctive: pasuratsuraton, *s*; panusatsuráton, *p*

* * *

(The repetitive have the same form as the diminutive)

* * *

(The reciprocate have no passive)

* * *

(The imitative, gradual and figurative have no passive) [96]

INDIRECT PASSIVE

The indirect passive is similar to the ordinary progressive indirect passive (see page 76), except in that in the continuative form the interfix *in* is used.

The potential have no indirect passive.

The optative have their indirect passive as that of the ordinary form (see page 73 *et seq.*), as to the affixes.

The imperative have no indirect passive.

The impremeditative has its indirect passive the same as that of the primitive indirect passive (see page 74) as to the affixes.

The indirect passive of the diminutive is the same as that of the ordinary, primitive (See page 78 *et seq.*) as to the affixes.

INSTRUMENTAL PASSIVE.

The instrumental passive of the continuative impremeditative and diminutive verbs is similar to that of the progressive (page 79 and 80) as to the prefixes.

The other verbs above mentioned have not instrumental passive.

NOTE. There are other classes of verbs formed by other particles and combinations; but their conjugation will be of no difficulty if the different forms hereinbefore given are thoroughly mastered.

DEPRECATIVE VERBS

There are verbs used in a depreciative tone. Examples.

for cáon (to eat) ásoc, lámon, etc.

lacát (to walk) laág

”

yacán (to talk) yaquimbot, etc.

”

These verbs are conjugated as ordinarily. [97]

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ADVERBS

The adverbs are of the following classes:

ADVERBS OF PLACE

DIIN (where),—BISAN DIIN (wherever, anywhere),—DIDI (here, nearer to the speaker than to the listener),—DINHÍ (here),—DIDÂ (there, nearer to the listener than to the speaker),—DIDTO (there),—HARANI (near),—HARAYÒ (far).

ADVERBS OF TIME

CACAN-O (when, past),—SAN-O (when, future),—BISAN CACAN-O (whenever, past),—BISANSAN-O (whenever, future),—NIYÁN (now),—CANINA (before, short time ago, in the same day),—CAGAB'I (last night),—CACOLÓP (yesterday),—CASANGAB'I (the night before last),—CASANGCOLOP (the day before yesterday),—CASANGYADTO (the day previous to the day before yesterday),—ANAY (before, anciently),—UNINA (after, in the same day),—BUAS (to-morrow),—ISANGBUÁS (the day after to-morrow),—ISANGYÁDTO (the day following the day after to-morrow),—CANONAY (always),—DAYÓ-DAY (persistently),—LAYON

(soon),—DÁYON (immediately),—HADTO (then, before),—NĜANÌ, CUN (when, whenever),—NAMAN (again),—LIUAT (again),—PA (yet),—NA (already),—AGSOB (frequently),—DANAY (sometimes),—NGÁHAO (then).

ADVERBS OF DEGREE

CAPIN, LABIS, LAPÁS (more),—ORÓG (most),—URAÚRA (excessively),—TUMAN (a little scarcely).

ADVERBS OF MANNER

AMO, ASYA (so, thus),—ONAN-O (how),—MAN (also),—COLAÓNG, COLASÓT, COLANTOY (for example, for instance).

ADVERBS OF DOUBT

ADÂ, MAHAMOC, MASAGNI, MAHARANI, CADUÁS TINĜALI, BANĜIN, SABALI (probably, perhaps),—BAGÁ (as).

ADVERBS OF AFFIRMATION

OO (yes),—MANGUD (indeed),—CAIYA, UGA, CAY UGÂ, GUI-HÁPON (of course).

ADVERBS OF NEGATION

DIRI (no),—UARRAY (no, past),—AYAO (no, future).

ADVERBS OF CAUSE

CAY (because),—TUNǦÚD (because). [98]

OBSERVATIONS 1. Many adjectives and phrases are employed as adverbs, as

igbao (above)
niyán nǣa adlao (to-day)
damò (much)
etc.

2. Some of the adverbs are frequently contracted, as those composed of “bisan” which is contracted into “bis.” Examples:

bisan diín contracted bis diín
guihapon guiháp.

”

3. The adverbs have diminutive, comparative and superlative. As

from harani, haraníay, haroharani, guihaharani; etc.

[\[Contents\]](#)

PREPOSITIONS

HA (to, from, over, under),—TIPA (against, towards),—TUNĜUD (for),—PATI, UPOD (with),—GAUÁS (without),—CAN (of, to),—TICANG, GUICAN (from, since),—TUBTUB (up to, till, until),—TALIUAN (after),—LÁBUT (except).

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CONJUNCTIONS

The conjunctions are of the following classes:

COPULATIVE

UG, NĠAN (and),—MAN (also),—NĠA (that).

DISJUNCTIVE

O, CUN, ⁹⁵BA (or).

ADVERSATIVE

CUNDÌ (but),—SABALI, UGARING (but, though), CUN, NGANÌ (if),—BISAN (even, though),—BACAY (as),—CUNTÀ (which bears the idea of past or future desire: it may frequently be translated in English with the phrase: “if possible”). ^[99]

CONDITIONAL

CUN NĠANÌ, ABI,⁹⁶ UGARING (if).

CAUSAL

CAY, TUNGUD, BACAY, SANGUIT, CAY (inasmuch, because).

FINAL

BASI (in order to),—BANGIN (lest).

CONTINUATIVE

TACAY (then),—BUSA (therefore),—TARA (then).

INTERJECTIONS

ADMIRATION: ¡a!, ¡ay!, ¡báá!, ¡abaá!, ¡baadao!, ¡abaadao! ¡pastilan!, ¡pauican!, ¡pauísac!, ¡palipac!, ¡palísac!, ¡pauiday!, ¡aguimpauican!, ¡aguimpastilan!, ¡aguimpauisac!, ¡aguimpali, pac!, ¡aguimpalisac!, ¡aguimpauiday!, ¡pascalan!, ¡bongansiso!, !odoy!, ¡alágad!, ¡alagad dao!, ¡an ac pa!, ¡ito ngahao!, etc.

PAIN AND SORROW: ¡ay!, ¡ayhay!, ¡aguí!, ¡aroy!, ¡óhoy!, ¡pastilan!, etc.

ATTENTION: ¡óho!, ¡ohondá!, ¡tabí!, ¡oy!, ¡acay! ¡hacay!, ¡solibangco!, etc.

INSISTENCE: ¡gad!, ¡daó!, ¡uga!, ¡lugá!, ¡ugaring!, ¡lugaring!, ¡caiyá!, ¡pudó!, ¡haromámay!, etc.

REPROBATION: ¡diri!, ¡uaráy!, ¡ayao!, ¡hulát!, ¡bodó!, ¡buró!, etc.

SURPRISE: ¡ay!, ¡an!, ¡alágad!, ¡ús!, ¡balitao!, ¡bayá!, etc.⁹⁷

PITY: ¡cairó!, ¡in tauo!, ¡pastilán!, ¡odóg!, ¡baadao!, ¡aguí!, etc.

DESIRE: ¡cunta!, ¡upayda!, ¡unta!, ¡mangad pa!, ¡ihinaotpa!, ¡tubangan pa la!, etc.

JOY: ¡ay!, ¡ahay!, ¡upayda!, ¡salamat!, ¡ta!, etc.

AVERSION: ¡á!, ¡aguí!, ¡ambot!, ¡sabá!, etc.

INVITATION: ¡cadí!, ¡taná!, ¡halá!, etc. [100]

SELF-CORRECTION: ¡au!, ¡ay!, ¡sapayán!

SUSPENSION: cuan.... inín.... ¡hulat!, ¡niyan!, etc.

DESPAIR: ¡sahó!, etc.

GRATITUDE: ¡salamat!, ¡Dyos mag báyad!, ¡Dyos mag sugá!, etc.

-
- ¹ We do not write “*Dios*”, because it would be pronounced *Di-os*.—See “Vowels”, *supra*. [↑]
- ² The use of *s* instead of the *h*, in these articles, depends upon the place where Bisayan is spoken. In the towns of Burawen, Dúlag and Abúyog, of the island of Leyte, and in some places in Sámar, the *h* is never used, but the *s* instead for these articles. Generally, it is considered more solemn to use the *s* instead of the *h*, in speeches, letters and poetry. But many times it is considered as a ridiculous affectation, in places where the *h* is used.
- It will be noted that, in some instances, the Bisayan people show a tendency to change the aspirate sound of the *h*, or soft sound of the Spanish *j*, into *s*. So in olden times, the name *Juan* was pronounced *Suan*; *Jueves* was pronounced *Suebes*; and from the Spanish *jugar*, they made the Bisayan word *sugal*, which is still in use. [↑]
- ³ See “Contractions”, *supra*. As it is seen, the *m* is for *ma*. This contraction shows exactly the way in which the Bisayan original letters were used. It is simply the ancient way of writing preserved after the adoption of the Spanish letters. [↑]
- ⁴ This diminutive as well as the preceding does not need to be accented with grave and angular accent, as originally, first, because such accents are only used at the ending of the words (see the rule, page 3), and second, because the suspended guttural sound of the last vowel of its primitive is in some way preserved by means of the separation with which the vowels *oa* are pronounced (see “Vowel”, page 5) [↑]
- ⁵ But if the primitive is *mapulá*, the diminutive will be *mapulapula*, as will be noted later. [↑]
- ⁶ In some places in Leyte and Samar, this particle is *hi*, not *ha*, where it is said *hibobò*, *hilipot*, *hilabà*, *hitáas*. But, in my opinion, it is simply a result of confounding the particle *ma* which is more proper for adjectives as it bears the idea of abundance, with the personal article *hi* with which it is thus intended to personify the abstract ideas of *bobò*, *lipat*, *labà*, *táas*. [↑]
- ⁷ It has also the regular form “*halabáay*”. [↑]
- ⁸ This is a metathesis of “*dacoalay*”, by the transposition of the liquid consonant *l*; and this *l* in “*dacoalay*” has been substituted, for phonetical reason, for the *y* of “*dacoayay*”, which is the diminutive of “*dacoay*” not used. [↑]
- ⁹ It seems that this diminutive is the contraction of “*gutiay nya durò*”; it is not strictly a diminutive, it is a superlative. [↑]
- ¹⁰ Transformed from *bobonbòbon*. [↑]
- ¹¹ We do not write *can-on*, because it is a contraction of *caran'on*, which is also contracted from *caraonón*. [↑]

- 12 See “Comparative” and “Collective”, *infra*. ↑
- 13 The last *u* is not a vowel properly; it should be the consonant *w*. See notes on pages 1 and 5 of this book. ↑
- 14 It also means anxiety for dancing. So from *isóg* (to enrage), it is said: “*daco it ac isogón*” (contracted from *irisogón*), my rage is great. ↑
- 15 The second syllable of the combined prefix is sometimes doubled to make the sentence more emphatic. ↑
- 16 *Interfix* is there used to designate the particle placed within a word. ↑
- 17 Such is the name of the present capital of the province of Leyte. According to a tradition, this name originated from the fact that before the town was formed, a point of the eastern coast of its present site was known as a place where fishes were taken from the sea by a bamboo instrument, like a cover called *taclob*. ↑
- 18 It is the name of one of the most important towns in Leyte, located on the eastern coast of said island. Also according to a tradition, in the southwestern part of the present site of that town, before the town was built, there was a large tall tree, from whose prominent branches the people used to watch (*tan-ao*) the Moros from Sulu, when invading the coasts of Leyte.—The last *o* of this *tan-ao* is properly the consonant *w*. ↑
- 19 From *lolodhanan* from *lolohodanan*, where the *ó* is suppressed, and the *h* and *d*, transposed, for phonetical reasons. ↑
- 20 As when we say: “*macaoncaón iní nãa bayábas*” (this guava is inviting). The idea of fondness sometimes takes the same form, as “*macaoncaón ini nãa sorogóon*” (this servant is fond of eating surreptitiously). This form is also used for impersonal verbs, as will be seen later, as: “*macaoncaón na*” (I have appetite already). ↑
- 21 I say “*is*”, because this combination *nã* is properly one letter in Bisayan, which should be called *nãa*, as anciently. ↑
- 22 This is also a verbal of *sapód* (to gather). ↑
- 23 The particle *hi* sometimes with the verbs and especially among the derivative nouns conveys the idea of “payment for”, as when from the verbs *budlay* (to tire one’s self), *salacáy*, (to embark), and the nouns *apóy* (grandfather or grandmother), *púsod* (navel), it is said: *himudlay* (any thing given as in payment of any work);—*hinálacay* (payment for passage);—*hingapóy* (a present given to a grandfather or grandmother upon the the marriage of his or her grand daughter under the consideration of the former’s being the grandfather or grandmother of the latter);—*himósod* (present given to the midwife for cutting and attending to the navel of a new-born child). ↑
- 24 We use a hyphen in this word on account of the angular accent of the last *o* of the first verb. ↑
- 25 When the brothers or sisters referred to are more than two, then the interfix *r* is used, as *magburugtò*. ↑
- 26 The second *u* must be the consonant *w*. ↑

- ²⁷ This is the modern way of pronouncing this word. The old way consisted in making two syllables out of this word, and according to that pronunciation, it is written *Diyos* (pronounced Di-yos), not *Dyos*. ↑
- ²⁸ See “*Hi*”, under the heading “Verbal” *supra*. ↑
- ²⁹ See note 2 on page 20. ↑
- ³⁰ So we say *dolúo-ha-Sulúg*, which means a medicinal plant (*duláo*) from (*ha*) Sulu (*Sulúg*). ↑
- ³¹ See “*an, on*” under the heading of “Verbal”, page 15 *supra*. ↑
- ³² From *paladan*, the *d* having been solved into *r*. ↑
- ³³ It is believed that the name of one of the towns of Leyte, called by the Spaniards “Burauen” and, by the natives, “Burauón”, has been originated from *burabáron* (Contracted and made *Burauón*), on account of the fact that there are many fountains in that place. There is no reason why the native name “Burauón” used by the natives until the present time should not be employed for all uses, the *u* of said word being replaced by the *w*, if the letters proposed in the note of the first page of this book are adopted. ↑
- ³⁴ This word does not follow the rule. For phonetical reasons, in its formation an *h* is used and it is made *maasinhanon* contracted *maasinhon* instead of *maasinánon* which is the regular form. ↑
- ³⁵ The natives, especially the low people pronounce *Mericá* instead of *America*; *mericano* instead of the Spanish “*americano*” for *American*. ↑
- ³⁶ The name *Calyarâ* (native name of the town of Carigara, Leyte) has been probably originated from *Cangara* (placed of one called *Garâ*). A similar explanation might be given for the formation of the names *Calbigà* and *Calbáyog* (towns of Sámar).
- Besides the particle *can* the pronoun *hira* was probably used for similar cases. We think that the word *Hiraite* (Bisayan name of the word *Leyte*, applied to a town of the island of the same name) is formed by the said pronoun *hirá* and *Ite*. probably the name of the ancient owners of that place. ↑
- ³⁷ *Mano* and *mana* are probably a corruption of the Spanish “*hermano*,” “*hermana*.” ↑
- ³⁸ See page 12 *et seq.* of this book. ↑
- ³⁹ The word *capin sogóng*, *uraura*, in some localities are replaced by the Spanish word *duro* (hard). So they say “*duro ca maopay*”, *maópay nãa duro*, or *maopay hin duro* (very good). It is proper to adopt foreign words when there are not words corresponding in Bisayan, but we do not see why the pure Bisayan words should be forgotten when they are expressive, pure and original. The preposition *cundí* (but) is suffering the same fate, by the introduction of the Spanish *pero*. ↑
- ⁴⁰ Instead of *uraura*, the word *masiado*, a corruption of the Spanish *demasiado*, is much in use. Read the preceeding note. ↑
- ⁴¹ It must be noted that the accent in the superlative is on the last syllable, *masiromstróm*, while in the diminutive (which has exactly the same form, except the accent) the accent is upon the penult, *masiromsírom*. The meaning is different in the phrases *masiromsírom pa*, and *masiromsiróm pa*; the first means “it is a dark yet”; the second “it is very dark yet”. ↑

- ⁴² The Bisayan cardinal show that the original system of Bisayan people in counting was the decimal. So *napulo* is a compound word from *na* (made) and *pulò* (pile, island). *Napulo* means “one pile made”, wherefrom the decimal system clearly shows. ↑
- ⁴³ This word *cag* (and) is used in the island of Panay, but not in Sámar or Leyte where *ngan*, *ug* are employed for the said conjunction.
- In the southern part of Leyte it is said: *napala ug osá*. ↑
- ⁴⁴ A collective noun formed by the prefix *ca* and the primitive *duha* whose *d* is transformed into *r*, and by the affix *an*. It means the reunion of two piles. ↑
- ⁴⁵ There seems to be no doubt that this word *ribo* has the same origin as the Tagalog “libo”; but each one has a different meaning: while the Bisayan *libo* means *ten thousand*, the Tagalog *libo* means only *one thousand*. To express *ten thousand*, the Tagalogs have the word *lacsá*. ↑
- ⁴⁶ This word may have been derived from *lagtuc* which means the swelling of a thing due to dampness, humidity, or water. ↑
- ⁴⁷ An onomatopoetic word bearing the idea of littleness. ↑
- ⁴⁸ An onomatopoetic word meaning a thing that makes noise (caradul). ↑
- ⁴⁹ As it will be seen later there are despective verbs, as; of *lacat* (to walk) *laag*; of *yacán* (to talk), *yaquimbot*. ↑
- ⁵⁰ See page 31 of this book. ↑
- ⁵¹ These nouns are originated, in our opinion, from Spanish. See the note on page 31. *supra*. ↑
- ⁵² We also believe that these nouns are Spanish. ↑
- ⁵³ See “Collective,” *supra*. ↑
- ⁵⁴ This is the origin of “Borongán” a town on the eastern coast of the island of Samar, on account of the fact that during certain epoch of the year, that place is more or less covered with fog. ↑
- ⁵⁵ See “Vowels”, page 5 of this book. ↑
- ⁵⁶ See “Rule”, page 3 of this book. ↑
- ⁵⁷ However, the correct and proper form is the first, *Panalaron*, a verbal derived from *panalad* a plural infinitive of the verb *pagsálad* which means “to sound”. The said suburb of Tacloban, it is believed took this name from the fact that, anciently, the people used *to sound* (*panálad*) in such place which was then covered by the sea. ↑
- ⁵⁸ *Quita* means “we”, the listener included; *camí* means “we”, the listener excluded. ↑
- ⁵⁹ Only used after the verb. ↑
- ⁶⁰ *Hiyá* and *siyá* are the same. See the note 2 on page 7 of this book. The same may be said about *hirá* and *sirá*. ↑
- ⁶¹ Contracted from *ni* (of) and *ácon* (mine). ↑
- ⁶² Contracted from *da* and *ácon*. This particle *da* is used in some places as equivalent to the preposition *ha* or the contraction *han*. So in Carigata, Leyte, they say *dahani* (at old times),

instead of *hanhaní* used in Tacloban and other towns of Leyte. The forms *damon*, *daton*, *dimo*, *diyo*, *diya*, *dira* have the same explanation. ↑

⁶³ *Quita* is frequently used for “acó”, as when we say *tagui quitá hin salapî*, (give me money), instead of *tagui aco hin salapî*. ↑

⁶⁴ See “Personal pronouns” page 47. ↑

⁶⁵ See the note 2 on page 7. We use apostrophe and not hyphen, because *hin’o*, *sin’o* are contracted from *hi ano* and *si ano*. ↑

⁶⁶ However in this form in which the substantive precedes the adjective the suppression of *nãa* is permissible in poetry. ↑

⁶⁷ This is another irregularity of the pronoun *quita*. Here it is equivalent to *nimo*; but this last form is inadmissible in such phrase, *naton* being the special pronoun for the same. ↑

⁶⁸ In Dulag and other places of Leyte, this word is pronounced *didínhi*. ↑

⁶⁹ See “Other classes of verbs”, *infra*. ↑

⁷⁰ See “Potential Form”, *infra*. ↑

⁷¹ In Basay, Sámar the *m* is frequently suppressed, the first vowel becoming long on account of said suppression. So they say there: *sínurat*, *ínabot*. ↑

⁷² This form is taken from the subjunctive, as in the Spanish language. ↑ [a](#) [b](#)

⁷³ In the towns of Dúlag, Burauen, and Abúyog, of the island of Leyte, these forms are always contracted, the first syllable of the verb so formed becoming long on account of the said contraction. Thus it is said in the mentioned places: *nágsurat* instead of *nagsúsurat*. ↑ [a](#) [b](#) [c](#)

⁷⁴ See the note on page 65. ↑

⁷⁵ See the note on page 63. ↑

⁷⁶ See page 65 *et seq.* ↑

⁷⁷ It is not doubled some places, See note on page 65. ↑

⁷⁸ See page 64 *et seq.* ↑

⁷⁹ It is not doubled some localities. See note on page 65. ↑

⁸⁰ See page 61. ↑

⁸¹ See page 65. ↑

⁸² See page 68. ↑

⁸³ See page 62 *et seq.* ↑

⁸⁴ See page 68. ↑

⁸⁵ See page 69. ↑

⁸⁶ The translation made in those conjugations is literal. We try to express in English the exact idea contained in these forms. ↑

- ⁸⁷ See note on page 65. ↑
- ⁸⁸ See page 70 *et seq.* ↑
- ⁸⁹ See page 71. ↑
- ⁹⁰ Page 61 of this book. ↑
- ⁹¹ The future of this form is the same as in the regular Tagalog form, where it is said *susulat aco* (I shall write), *bucas aco susulat* (tomorrow I shall write). ↑
- ⁹² See page 61. ↑
- ⁹³ In Dúlag and other places of Leyte, the accent is transposed to the penult. So it is said: *dididâ*, etc. ↑
- ⁹⁴ See the page 10. ↑ [a](#) [b](#)
- ⁹⁵ This conjunction is seldom used, at present, for the disjunctive *or*. The English *or* and the Spanish *o* are difficult to translate into Bisayan with *cun*. For this reason the Spanish *o* is frequently employed in Bisayan, as well as in Tagalog for the English *or*. ↑
- ⁹⁶ It also conveys the idea of “Saying”, as in the example: nasiring an catsila, ngalaong: “págame”, *abi tapa*: “bayari acó”. ↑
- ⁹⁷ There is another, viz: *susmaryosep* or *susmarosèp* the corrupted Spanish “Jesús, María y José”. ↑

SYNTAX

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SUBJECTIVE RELATION

The subject of a verb may be either a noun or its equivalent, namely a pronoun, a verb in the infinitive mood, or an entire phrase. As

AN DYOS macagagáhum	(God is omnipotent)
ACÓ nagsusurát	(I write)
AN PAGUAON maopay	(The meal is good; <u>literally: the eating is good</u>)
AN GUINQUIQUINAUANGLAN TA ámo an pag-orosa	(what we need is union).

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PREDICATIVE RELATION

The verb agree with its subject in person and number. As

panurát quitá (let us write)

magsurát hiyá (let him or her write)

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ATTRIBUTIVE RELATION

The nouns and their equivalents may be modified by substantives, adjectives, demonstrative pronouns, possessive pronouns, and participles. Except in cases of possessive pronouns, relative *nã* is placed between the noun or its equivalents, and the modifying word. As

batá <i>nã</i> sorogóon	(the young servant; <u>literally</u> : the boy servant)
an sangcay <i>nã</i> macpay	(the good friend)
iní <i>nã</i> baláy	(this house)
an acon amáy	(my father)
hinigugma nga iróy	(loved mother)

[101]

NOTE.—When the pronoun “adton” and its inflections are equivalent to “deceased”, “late”, the particle *nã* is not employed. As

adton Pedro (the late Peter)

The article also modifies the noun and its equivalents, in that it limits them. The articles always precede the word or words to which they refer. As is seen before (page 9) the personal article is always employed before the proper nouns, except in the vocative case. As

an lanãit (the heaven, or the sky)
hi Eudong (Peter)

The definite article is sometimes used before proper nouns, and frequently before the demonstrative and possessive pronouns. The indefinite article is

sometimes employed before the possessive pronouns. The personal article is sometimes used before the personal pronouns, except the third person. As

an Dyos	(God)
an iní nãa batà	(this boy)
an amon búngto	(our town)
macanhi in acon sangcay	(a friend of mine will come)
hi camó nãan hi acó	(you and I)

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COMPLEMENTARY RELATION

The object of the verb is always in the objective case determined by the corresponding article, or by a preposition. As

hi Pedro nagbabasa *han* (Peter reads the letter)
surat

hirá nanġatúrog *ha* sacayán (they sleep on the boat)

hi Tomás naruruyag *hin* (Thomas wishes to come; literally: Thomas
pagcanhi wishes a coming)

mácadto acó *ha* Abúyog (I shall go to Abuyog).

The object of the verb *to be* is in the nominative case. As

an imo bahín, amo iní (your part is this)

an táuo mamarátyon (the man is mortal)

ADVERBIAL RELATION

The adverbs and the adverbial phrases modify a verb, an adjective, or another adverb. As

“dánay” acó cumádto (I go there sometimes)
nabasa nǵani acó, nábasa “man” hiyá (If I read, he reads also).

The adverbs are generally placed next to the word that they modify, some before the said word as “agsob” (frequently), “dánay” (sometimes), “masócot” (often), “macatalagsa” (seldom), etc., and other after the said word as “pa” (yet), “na” (already), “man” (also), “gud” (precisely), etc., and some before or after the said word as “lugúd” (on the contrary), etc.

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REPRESENTATIVE RELATION

The important Bisayan word that expresses representative relations is the relative pronoun *nga*, which is invariable.

an batá nga tinmauag ha acon (the boy who called me)

an cabatáan nãa tinmawag ha acon (the boys who called me)

As to cases, we have seen (page 52) that this relative *nga* never refers to the object of the verb. The sentences in the English and other languages, where the corresponding relative pronoun relates to the object of the verb and where consequently the said relative is in the objective case, are expressed in Bisayan in passive voice which is the most used in this tongue.¹ Thus, if we wish to say

the boy whom I called

we should say

an bata nãa tinauag co

which literally is: the boy who was called by me.

The personal, demonstrative and possessive pronouns agree in person and number with their antecedents or the word [103] or words that they represent. There is no agreement in gender because the pronouns have no gender.

¹ The fact that there are three classes of passive voice in Bisayan show the great importance of the said voice in this tongue. Thus if we wish to say "I love you", it is more expressive to say: *hinihigugma co icao* (literally: you are loved by me) than to say: *nahigugma aco ha imo*. [†]

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CONNECTIVE RELATIONS

The prepositions join the nouns, their equivalents, or the pronouns to some other word. They place in the objective case the word that depends on them.

The most important preposition in, Bisayan is *ha*, which is equivalent to nearly all of the prepositions of other languages. Examples:

He saw me—	hiyá quinmitá <i>ha</i> acon
He wrote to me—	hiyá nagsurát <i>ha</i> acon
I come to Tacloban—	nacanhí acó <i>ha</i> Tacloban
I come from Palo—	ticang acó <i>ha</i> Palô
I pass by your house—	linmabáy acó <i>ha</i> iyo baláy
He is in the room—	aadto niyá <i>ha</i> solód
etc.	

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ABSOLUTE AND INDEPENDENT CONSTRUCTIONS

Absolute and independent constructions take place in Bisayan with vocatives, and interjections.

Vocatives, as

Pedro, n̄ga niya, cadí dao (Peter, he said, come, please)

Interjection, as

Pastilan, caloóyi gad acó (oh!, have pity of me)

Some independent phrases are connected with the rest of the thought by the adverb *man*, as

naabot camí, natutunod	(when we arrived, the sun set; <u>literally:</u> we
man an adlao	arrived, the sun also set).

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SYNTAX OF VERBS

THE INFINITIVE. The present has the construction of the noun, as

an pag-arám hin maopay ámo an catungdánan (to learn well is the duty of
han batà a boy).

The gerund expresses the idea of past when preceded by the particle *han*, contraction of the preposition *ha* and the article *an*, as [104]

han pagsírang han adlao, nagmamata (when the sun raised, I was already
na acó awake).

The past participle has the construction of an adjective, as

binilangò ñga táuo (prisoner; literally: an imprisoned man)

INDICATIVE. Besides its ordinary use, its present is frequently employed with the particle *cuntà*, to express the idea of an interrupted or intended action. As

cun uaráy ca cánhi, nalacát cunta (If you had not come, I would have
acó gone)

SUBJUNCTIVE. It being used in a subordinate propositions, it is always constructed with the conjunctions *ñga* (thato), *cun*, *ñganì* (if), *cuntà* (if possible).

Ñga and *cun* always precede the verb; *ñganì* and *cunta* when used for the subjunctive, is always placed after the verb. As

caruyag co nãa (I wish you to come to-morrow; literally: I wish that
cumanhi ca buas you may come to-morrow).¹

cun lumabay hi Juan, (If John passes by, call him)
tanága.

lumabáy nãanì hi Juan
taúaga.

lumabáy cuntà hi Juan (God grant that John passes).

NOTE.—The subjunctive form is frequently constructed with the modal adverbs and adjectives and then such combinations have the construction of an adjective. As

táuo nãa maopay sumurat (a good writer: literally; a man who writes
well)

macosóg sumáog nãa (a strong dragger carabao)
carabao

etc.

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ARRANGEMENT OF WORDS

The adjectives and verbs are always preferably employed, whenever possible, at the beginning of a phrase, clause, or sentence.

Examples:

maópay nãa táuo (good man)

nagsusurat acó (I write)
etc.

-
- ¹ In Bisayan, there is no construction similar to that of the English tongue, consisting in putting the subject in the objective case, and its verb in the infinitive: which is an exact Latin syntax, as

he wishes me to come

Ille vult me venire

Such sentence is expressed in Bisayan with the aid of the conjunction *nãa*, the subject in nominative case, and the verb in subjunctive mood, thus

caruyag niya *nãa* acó camáñhi. [↑]

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VIOLATIONS OF GOOD USE

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BARBARISMS

The most frequent violation of good use of the Bisayan tongue is the *Barbarism*.

It is committed by using foreign words, and foreign constructions.

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FOREIGN WORDS

Many foreign words have been and are being introduced in the Bisayan conversations and writings. Must of such words are being adopted, not because they are necessary, but simply thru affectation and love of innovation, thus attempting against the purity of Bisayan. Some of the words introduced however are necessary as they have no corresponding word in Bisayan. [\[106\]](#)

FOREIGN WORDS UNNECESSARILY USED IN BISAYAN

Spanish words

Abierto, abre (open)	for Binucsan, inucáb, bucás ucáb.
Adorno (adornment)	Dayan, rayandayan
	”
Agua (used to mean perfume)	Talamhot
	”
Aguanta (wait suffer)	Ílob, hulát
	”
Alisto (from <i>listo</i>)	Andam
	”
Amigo (friend)	Sángcay
	”
Apique (close)	Sóoc
	”
Apura, apurado (hurry)	Dagmit, cadagmitan
	”
Atrever, atrevido (bold)	Paggahúm, gamhánan
	”
Aver (for “give me”)	Icadí
	”
Aver pa (God grant)	Mangad pa
	”
Bajado, Bajar (low)	Habobó, obós
	”
Bancó (bench)	Pongcóan, lincoran, pápag
	”
Bando (edict)	Pahamatngon
	”
Batido (for “experienced”)	Lasgud, hiara
	”
Bote (for boat)	Sacayan
	”

Cada usá (each one)	Tágsa
	”
Calabozo (jail)	Bilangóan
	”
Calculo (calculus)	Igoigo
	”
Calle (street)	Dalan
	”
Campana (bell)	Linganay
	”
Canta (sing)	Laygay, laylay
	”
Cantodes (from “cantores”)	Paralaygay
	”
Carcel (jail)	Bi1angóan
	”
Cargo (for “debt”)	Útang
	”
Carne (flesh <u>meat</u>)	Unód
	”
Capaz (able)	Sadang, angay, tacús
	”
Castigo (punishment)	Siroc
	”
Cocina (kitchen)	Lotoán
	”
Coger	Pagdacóp pacasacób
	”
Colá (from “colar”)	Bacá
	”
Color (color)	Tina, samay, culay ^[107]
	”

Comósta (from “como está” how are you)	Matíónan-o ca
Común (common)	” Casahirác
Convida (invite)	” Áabiabi, sabi
Contra (against)	” Tipa, patoe, caauay
Cortina (curtain)	” Biráy
Cuarta (money)	” Salapí
Cuarto (room)	” Solód
Cuerdas (strings)	” Dolós
Cuello (collar)	” Balióg
Cuenta (account)	” Iháp, ísip
De balde (unusefully)	” Cáuaug
De buenas (fortunate)	” Paláran
Decir (for “ask”)	” Siring hingyap
Defecto (defect)	” Casaquihán, carát’an
De malas (unfortunate)	” Uaráy palad
Derecho (right)	” Tádong, dáyon, catadunġan
	”

Descanso (rest)	Pahúuay
	”
Despedida (farewell)	Panamilit
	”
Dibujo (drawing)	Badlis, Baguis
	”
Diferencia (difference)	Guincalainan, guicaíbban
	”
Dilatar (for delay)	Pag-uláng, pagpahalawig
	”
Disgusto (unlikeness)	Cangalas
	”
Dispensa (excuse)	Pasaylo, paguará
	”
Diversion (amusement)	Caliáuan, liáoliáo
	”
Dulce (sweet candy)	Matam’is
	”
Empezar (to commence)	Pagticáng
	”
Entra (for “to make love”)	Pangasáua
	”
Entremés (joke)	Tíao
	”
Escuela (school)	Liborán
	”
Espejo (glass)	Salamíng
	”
Esquina (corner)	Casóngnan
	”
Estampa (image)	Ladáuan
	”

Fino (fine)	Gamay, pilí
	”
Firme (for always)	Agsub, ónob
	”
Fuerza (strength)	Cusóg
	”
Fuerte (strong)	Macusóg, mabácod
	”
Fusil (gun)	Lutbang ^[108]
	”
Ganancia (gain)	Polós, tubo
	”
Gracia (grace, favor)	Parábul
	”
Gratis (used for “payment”)	Himúdlay
	”
Gusto (wish)	Caruyag
	”
Hasta (until)	Tubtub, ngadá
	”
Hechura (shape)	Daguay
	”
Interes (interest)	Guinsisiring, guinlalánat
	”
Jardin (garden)	Tanáman
	”
La mesa (table)	Dulang
	”
Latigo (whip)	Latós
	”
Lavá (from “lavar”, to wash)	Búnac
	”

Lavandero, a (launderer, laundress)	Magburunác
	”
Licencia, pag (to take leave)	Sárit, panamilit
	”
Limós (from “limosna”, alms)	Calóoy, hatag
	”
Limpio (clean)	Mahínis
	”
Lóa (praise)	Dáyao
	”
Lugar (for “near” or “almost”)	Dapit, ma
	”
Macetas (flower-pot)	Tinanóm, taranman
	”
Maestro (teacher)	Magtorótdo
	”
Manteca (butter)	Pinahagas
	”
Mantel (tablecloth)	Basnig ha dulang
	”
Mantilla (mantilla)	Taóng
	”
Masiado (from “demasiado”, too)	Uraura
	”
Masque (from “por más que”, although)	Bisan
	”
Medio (half)	Catunga, bagá
	”
Mismo (self-same)	Ngábao, gud
	”
Muchacho (for servant)	Surogóon
	”

Número (number)	Iháp
O bien (or)	” O cun, ó, lugúd
Oración (prayer)	” Pangadye, paugamuyo
Orden (order)	” Sugo
Pabyon (from “pabellón”)	” Biráy
Paciencia (patience)	” Pag-ilub
Pago (for “debt”)	” Utang ^[109]
Palati (from “palatico”, from “práctico”)	” Mag-oróna
Paño (cloth)	” Panapton, pudóng
Pañolito (handkerchief)	” Modongpódong
Para (for, halt)	” Basi, ngada, hulat, ocóy, ,, toróoc
Parecer (opinion)	Sagbang
Parejo (equal)	” Sáma, sandag
Paseada (from “paseo”)	” Lacatlácat
Peligro (danger)	” Cataragman
Pensar (for talent)	” Talíno
	”

Perdona (from “perdonar”)	Pasaylo
	”
Pero (but)	Cundi
	”
Pertina (for “pretina”, waistband)	Háuac
	”
Pierde (from “perder” to <u>lose</u>)	Lupig, nara
	”
Pintar (to paint)	Dum-it, díhog
	”
Pintura (paint)	Idirihóg
	”
Plato (plate)	Pingan
	”
Platito (a little dish)	Lampay
	”
Pliegues (plaits)	Lopi
	”
Pobre (poor)	Cablas
	”
Polvo (powder)	Bócboc
	”
Posta (from “apuesta” <u>bet</u>)	Butáng
	”
Precio (price)	Pulít
	”
Preparar (to prepare)	Pag-andam, pagtíma
	”
Preso (<u>prisoner</u>)	Binilangá.
	”
Probar (to <u>taste</u>)	Tilao, sari
	”

Propecto (from “perfecto,” perfect)	Guinóod
	”
Prueba (proof, evidence)	Paacamatóod
	”
Principal (chief, capital)	Labáo, pohonan
	”
Provecho (profit)	Polós
	”
Puerta (door)	Ganghaán
	”
Pulido (neat)	Hag-id, mahamis
	”
Puro (pure)	Putli, lonlon, sandag, sáhid
	”
Queja (complaint)	Sumbong
	”
Querido (dear)	Hinigugma, pinalanga
	”
Que ver (for “to do”)	Láhot ^[110]
	”
Quinolá (from colar)	Bináchan
	”
Rabenque (from “rebenque”, whipe)	Latob, latos
	”
Recibi (from “recibir”)	Carauat
	”
Reclamo (claim)	Paglánat
	”
Redondo (round)	Lipóron, malídong
	”
Regalo (present)	Higugma, hatag, bucad
	”

Regular (regular)	Igó, socol
	”
Relo, rels (from “reloj” watch, clock)	Orasán ¹
	”
Remo (oar)	Gaód
	”
Renuncio (from “renunciar”, to renounce)	Pagdiri, pagdiuara
	”
Reventa (from “reventar” to explode)	Pagbotó
	”
Rico (rich)	Mangáran
	”
Rugal (from “lugar”, spot)	Caraan, tuna, umá
	”
Saco (sack)	Sopót
	”
Sadá (from “cierra”, close)	Locób
	”
Sala (hall)	Ruáng
	”
Saya (skirt)	Tampí, Talapí
	”
Seguro (for “probably”)	Mahámoe, angay la
	”
Señor (Sir, Mister)	Guinoo
	”
Sirve (from “servir” to serve)	Pagmangno pag-ágad
	”
Suerte (for “talk”)	Himangrao
	”
Sustento (maintenance)	Pagbubi, iburuhi, cabuhian
	”

Tabla (board)	Bugha
Tachar (for “contempt”)	Yúbit, támay
Taza (cup)	Yahóng
Tiempo (time)	Adlao, túig
Tienda (merchandise, store)	Baligya, baligyáan
Tieso (stiff)	Dángag, tadóng
Tocar (to play)	Pagtonóg
Tocador (for glass)	Salamíng
Tonto (fool)	Lórong, palinqui, pádlas
Trabajo (work)	Buhat ^[111]
Tranea (cross-bar)	Síol, Balabág
Tumba (to tumble)	Púcan
Vacio (empty)	Lungág
Ventana (window)	Tambóan
Verde (green)	Saguindáhon
Vicio (vice)	Casaquihán

Virtud (for “power”)

Gahúm

”

Zurce (for “zurcir” to darn)

Pagtábing,

”

And many others.

CHINESE² WORDS

Bochang (for sow)

for Cablas

Búisit (unfortunate)

Uaray pálad

”

Camsya (for “thank”)

Salámat

”

Gonggong (foolish)

Uaray salabótan

”

Lamloc (dear, fat)

Matamboc

”

Laotuy (old)

Lagás, gurang

”

Syâ (for eat)

Cáon

”

Sinqui (new)

Bag-o

”

Tampuâ (excess, present)

Táuad, labis

”

Uchang (rich)

Mangáran

”

Uísit (fortunate)

Paláran.

”

and some others.

ENGLISH WORDS

Haló (halloo)	for Ohó
Miting (“meeting”)	Catirócan
	”
Háyc (“hike”)	Paglacát, sódoy
	”
Moning (for “money”)	Salapí
	”
Sausau (chow-chow)	Pagcáon, caraonón
	”

And others.

NOTE.—At present, among the students it is frequent to hear “¿háin an ac *dyografi* (geography), an ac *arismític* (arithmetic)?” “¿aada ca ha *fif* (fifth) *greyc* (grade)?” “maaram na acó *mag espeling* (spelling)”—Why do they not talk in English? [112]

OBSERVATION. There are some Tagalog words and constructions used in Bisayan; but we do not consider their use as a barbarism, because Tagalog and Bisayan are both dialects of a common tongue, and because such use may help the formation of a possible Filipino language.

FOREIGN CONSTRUCTIONS

Among others, the following is a barbarism in the construction:

“maaroopay iní QUE hitón”, (this is better than that). The use of the QUE

(which is Spanish meaning “than”) is entirely Spanish and is not necessary in Bisayan, as the mentioned sentence is expressed simply and with the same strength and more purity and correctness: “maooropáy iní hitón”.

FOREIGN WORDS NECESSARILY ADOPTED IN BISAYAN

But there are many words now in use in Bisayan the adoption of which enriches rather than destroys the language. We refer to those words that have been necessarily imported from other languages to express ideas not represented by any word, or whose corresponding words are lost in Bisayan.

We do not consider their use as a barbarism, as it is not considered us such in English, Spanish, French and other European languages the adoption of Greek and Latin words. We not only do not criticize such adoption in the Filipino dialects but rather desire and encourage it, because it will undoubtedly enable our dialects to be used in all kinds of scientific and artistic expressions.

Among the foreign words already adopted, the following may be counted:

DYOS (from the Spanish DIOS). It is true that we have the Tagalog BATHALA which refers to the omnipotency, and the Bisayan LAÓN which refers to the eternity. But in view of the fact that the word DYOS derived from the Latin *Deus*, from the Greek *Zeus* which means *Divinite, Supreme Being*, has been so much used in Bisayan, and it represent another phase of the attributes of God, we think that the said [113]word DYOS ought to be adopted in Bisayan, adapting its form to the inflections of our dialect.

ORAS (from the Spanish HORA “hour”).—We have to adopt this word, as there is no corresponding expression known in Bisayan. By its adoption we

have a way to avoid the use of RELOJ, with the derivative ORASAN already used.

BAPOR (from the Spanish “vapor” steamboat). It has no corresponding in Bisayan. We have SACAYÁN (boat), but it does not include the idea of the “steam.”

PAPEL (from the Spanish “papel”).—It has no corresponding in Bisayan.

The Spanish names of the days of the week, and of the months of the year, which must be written in Bisayan form, as: LUNES, MARTES, MYERKOLES, HWEBES, BYERNES, SABADO, DOMINGO, ENERO, PEBRERO, MARSO, ABRIL, MAYO, JUNYO, HULYO, AGOSTO, SEPTYEMBRE, OKTUBRE, NOBYEMBRE, DISYEMBRE.

ARORÚ (from the English “arrow-root”). A plant. And many others. [115]

¹ See “Foreign words necessarily adopted in Bisayan”, *infra*. ↑

² We do not refer to those Chinese words imported to Philippines with Chinese objects. Such words are to be kept necessarily in Bisayan, because their equivalent vernacular expressions, either are lost, or never existed. ↑

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APPENDIX

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NOTES ON BISAYAN RHETORIC AND POETICS

FIGURES OF SPEECH

Simile. This figure is one of the most used in Bisayan, even in ordinary conversations.

Examples:

1. Bagá an násirong nǵa dila.

Applied to a person or thing intended to be kept out of the rain, but which becomes wet, like the tongue (dila) which is always wet in the mouth.

2. Canogon pa dao la—san imo catindog
maópay si báyhon—maráot an bántog
igpapananglit co—bayábas nǵa hinóg,
maópay an panit—olóron an onód

(A popular song,)

Where the resemblance is between “maopay si bayhon” and “maopay an panit”, and also between “maráot an bantog” and “olóron an onód”.

Metaphor. It is also used, especially in poetry.

Example:

1. Cáhoy ca n̄ga linauáan
sa búquid nanauantáuan
cun canan Dyos ca pagbut-an
matopóng sa ulasiman.

(A popular song)

Applied to one who is in a high position in life, like “cahoy n̄ga linauáan”, the “lauáan” tree being one of the tallest trees.

Allegory. It is also found in Bisayan.

Example:

Ugá n̄ga cáhoy si láuas,
patáy na, layâ si dáhon [118]
nanaringsing sin casáquit
namún̄ga sin camatáyon

(A popular song)

Here the life or body (láuas) is called a dry tree (ugá n̄ga cáhoy), already dead (patáy na), whose leaves are withered (laya si dahon), and which sprouted sorrow (nanaringsing sin casáquit), and gave as fruit, the death (namún̄ga sin camatáyon).

Personification. One of the most frequent cases of personification in Bisayan is that consisting in applying to things and objects the personal article *si*.

Example:

Nagtitinan̄gis *si* tucmo

cay tiarábut an bagyo.

(A popular song)

Where the turtle-dove, (tucmo) is personified by *si*. The expression would lose much of its charm if the article *an* is employed instead of *si*.

Antithesis. We have this figure in Bisayan.

Example:

Canógon pa dao la—san imo catindog
maópay si bayhon—maráot an bantog, etc.

Where “maopay” (good) and “maraot” (bad), “bayhon” (face) and “bántog” (fame) are contrasted.

Epigram. This figure, in its modern meaning, is used in Bisayan.

Example:

Gumhúlat pa an naghínay.
an nagdagmit, uaráy.

Which literally means: he who went slow was awaited for; he who hastened was not waited for. Its point is equivalent to that of the English “slow, but sure.” “Guinhulat” (was awaited for) “uaráy” (was not), “naghínay” (went slow) and “nagdágmit” (hastened) are contrasted. [119]

Metonymy. It is also found in Bisayan.

Example:

An patay palanğit, an buhi pacauít.

Literally: let the dead go to heaven; let the living go to the “cauít” (a bamboo where the tubâ wine is ordinarily placed). The figure consists in this word “cauít,” container, for “tuba wine,” the thing contained.

Synecdoche.

Example:

Pag árog hin damò nga bugás cay damo camí nãa babà.

Literally it means: “Prepare much rice because we are many mouths.” Here the *mouths* (baba) a part, is used for *person*, the whole.

Apostrophe. We have it also in Bisayan.

Example:

Ohoy mĩa langit—mga cahatas’an.
tabanģi, buligui—adin may pinas’an
an iní nga pãlad—con diri mabãui
nouontan dao adã—sinin quinabuhi

(A popular song)

Literally: Heavens, altitudes, protect, help this who suffers something; if this fate is not averted, it will undoubtedly affect the life.

Exclamation.

Example:

¡Pastilán bidíday,—bididay ca man la
nãa nacacalucmay—sinin hunahuna! ...
¡ayáo pag saquita!—¡ayáo pagbidóa,
cay mag titinangis—canugon san luha! ...

(A popular song)

Interrogation.

Example:

Mğa langit, mğa langit;
¿háin dao dapit an sáquit? ...

[120]

sa calibutan uaráy man:
sabali sa panomdoman.

(A popular song)

Hyperbole. It is frequent in Bisayan.

Examples:

Maca¹ánas hin buquid. (Man able to level a mountain)
Maca²agpo bin bahá. (Man able to suspend a flood)

2. Cun totóo, intoy—nğa imo tinguha
pag biling la anay—sílot nğa may bóa.

(A popular song)

Literally: If your love is true, look for a “silot” (a young fruit of cocoanut) which has “bua” (the bulb of the old cocoanut fruit when it is old enough to be used as a seed).

Climax

Example:

i
nanaringsing sin masáquit,
namúnga sin camatáyon.

Irony.

Example:

¡Camaopay mo! uaray ca gud pag tuman han imo pólongẽ.

Literally: How good are you! you did not keep your word.

Asyndeton.

Example:

Ohoy mǵa langĩt—mǵa cahatas'an
tabanǵi, buligui, inín may pinas'an, etc.

(A popular song)

Repetition. [121]

Examples:

1. *Dirì co cay* yubit—*diri co cay* dáyao
pamahonpáhon mo—baga may parayao; etc.

(A popular song)

2. Pastilán, *bididay*—*bididay* ca man la
nǵa nacacalúcmay—sinín hunahuña, etc.

(A popular song)

Concatenation.

Example:

*Pastilán ca curi—cacuri capinan
capin ca mabide—san bido sa dughan,
dughan co pagílob—ilob calauasan,
láuas co naponò—pono casaquitan.*

(A popular song).

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PROSE

Of the three universal important forms in prose, *i.e.*, description, narration, and exposition nothing in general needs be observed.

LETTERS

At present, one of the forms most generally employed in Bisayan prose is that belonging to the class of narration, the letter.

Nothing special needs be observed about letters, at present times, apart from their external forms and the tendency to innovation prominently shown in them, more than anywhere else, by frequent barbarisms.

As to the external forms of the Bisayan letters, it is to be observed that a routinary introduction is almost universally followed. We refer to the ordinary introduction consisting in the following ideas and order: “This

letter has [122]no other purpose” 2) “but to ask how you are” 3) “because as to me” 4) “I am in a good health”.

And after such an invariable introduction, the writer goes on in a paragraph apart; “And I shall add that”, etc.

Example:

Uaráy lán nã tuyó hiní nã acon surat cúndi an damo nã mĩa panğomósta co ha imo,
cay cun acó in ipaquiána, calooy sa Dyos maópay.

Nğan isonouod co liuát, etc.

This is the introduction generally adopted. We do not hesitate to state that more than fifty per cent of the letters written in our Bisayan commence with these or equivalent ideas and in the same order.

As to the barbarisms, they are employed thruout the entire letter.

On the heading it is usually written:

Tacloban, á 2 de Octubre de 1908.

instead of:

Tacloban, ica 2 han Octubre han 1908.

On the introduction it ordinarily appears

Sr. D

or

Sra. D.a

Mi estimado amigo:

or

Muy estimada Señora:

The body of the letter is usually as follows:

Uaray lain n̄ga *objeto* hini n̄ga acon surat, *sino* an damo n̄ga m̄ga *pangomosta* ha iyo ngatanán, cay cun camí in iyo ipaquiána, calooy sa Dyos, uray ano man n̄ga *novedad*.

[123]

Y de consiguiente, tatay, isusunod co liuat; cun uray mo *inconveniente*, *gusto* co cunta comadá pag *vacacion*; *pero como guinadvertir* mo man aco han nacadi ca n̄ga mag *procurar* acó hin pag *obtener* anay han *titulo*, *por eso* amo iní n̄ga dirí aco na *atrever* pag guican *mientras* dirí paca aco macacarauát han imo *contestation* n̄ga pag hatag hin *permiso*, bisan cun *sobra y basta* gud an acon m̄ga *deseos* pag *visita* ha iyo. etc.

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POETIC FORMS

Of the three main classes of poetry, epic, lyric and dramatic, the lyric is the only one preserved in Bisayan in the form of popular songs. The dramatic form is found at present mainly in the translations of Tagalog and Spanish dramas, usually employed as plays on the Patron's days in the towns.

VERSIFICATION

Rhythm and *rhyme* are observed in Bisayan poems.

The rhyme is not so perfect as that of the Spanish verses. Consonant words or with similar sounding endings are employed in Bisayan.

Kinds of meter. There are two kinds of meter most used in Bisayan poetry: verses of six syllables, verses of eight syllables, and verses of twelve syllables divided in two fragments of six syllables each.

Examples:

Verses of six syllables:

¿Háin ca na, punay?...
cadí na panambo,
tambo madalíay,
liaua si casbo;
basi humalayhay

[124]

inín saquit, bido
nga asay tiónay
san casingcasing co.

Verses of eight syllables:

Acó iní sugadsugad
san bánua nga tarotánglad,
bisan cun diín italad
mabubuhi cun may palad,

Verses of twelve syllables:

Togon co sa imo,—mahal nga inógay
di ca gud padará—san damo nga sangcay;
an paglacát nime—gabay magmahinay,
nga diri hatócso,—lumiscad san látay.

Note.—The verses of twelve syllables are really verses of six, the odd verses not being rhymed.

Combinations. As seen in the preceding examples the combinations are the following:

The verses of six syllables are grouped in four verses, the even verses being rhymed.

The verses of eight syllables are grouped also in four verses all rhymed.

The verses of twelve syllables are also grouped in four rhymed verses.

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COLLECTION OF SOME BISAYAN SONGS

NOTE—In transcribing the following songs, we shall use, the orthography proposed in the note of the first page of this book using only three vowels: *a, i, o*.

MORAL POETRY

Si nanay, si tatay di ko babayuán
kay damò ñga dogô an akon naotağ
kun pag-ilsipon an siyam ka botan.
ğa pag-inókoy ko sa kan nanay riyán.

Togon ko sa imo, mahal ġa inógay:

di ka god padará san damò ģa sangkay;
an paglakat nímó gabáy mag mahinay,
ģa dirí katokao, lomiskad san látay.

[125]

Kamakaroroyag sa matá pagkit'on
sinin mag-asawa ģa waray sin limbog,
kon daw naabot na ira kamatayon
náboká an lanģit bási nira sadlon.

Ayaw gani kahihilig
ayaw karirikandikan,
kay di man bagyo an toig,
di man kikilá an bolan.

PHILOSOPHIC POETRY

Mģa bitoón sa laģit
may mapawà, may maģitģit,
con sa tawo igpanaģlit,
may malípay, may masákit.

Kahoy ka ģa linawaán
sa bokid nanawantawan,
kon kanan Dyos ka pagbot'an
matopóģ sa olasiman.

Di ko ginkakasorok'an
an salapí, an bolawan;
say ko ginkikinahaģlan

maopay ġa ginawian.

Sogad gud akó san gamót
ġa nailarom sa kotkot,
kon kanan Dyos pagboót
malábaw akó san ódlot

Diri ba ako pagsiriġ.
indayon, paghanġnariġ,
kay baġin kitá kapadġan,
harayó an borogkátan.

Guin holát pá an naghinay;
an nag dagmit, waráy.

Waráy hiní balos báyad
bas'la an boót longáyad

LOVE POETRY

An bató bantilis náibas, nákilot
sa toró san tóbig sa darodagínót:
;kasiġkasiġ pa ba an diri homómok.
sa gógma san tawo kon sa tarinónót.

Di ba sadto ánay imo akó siġsiġ
sa walá ġa kamót, todló tamoyiġkiġ;
baman itó niyán di ka na násiplat,
;anó an solá ko sa imo nabóhat?

An sakít sa domdom og sa honahona,
makori iliġkod, makori íhigda:

¿ihagád sa lánġit? ¿itamod sa tona?...
¡A baá Dyos ko, máonan'o dao la!...

Pastilán kakori, ka kori kapinan
kapin kamabido san bido sa dóghan;
doghan ko pag-ilob, ilob kasawásan,
láwas ko ġa ponó pone kasakitan.

Pastilán, bididay, bididay ka man la
ga nakakalokmay sinín honahona:
ayáo pag sakita, ayao pag bidóa,
kay mag titinangis kanógon san loha.

Pastilán ka kori, ka kor iġakapin
san may pag kasákit sinin kasiġkasiġ:
igpapanaġlit ko sa osá ga boriġ
bisan parigóson may gihapon bilin.

Háin ka na ponay,
kadi na panambo,
tambo madaliay.
liawá si kas'bo.
basi homanáyhay
inin sakit bido
ġa asáy tiónay
sa kasigkasig ko.

Abá Tiġtiġ abá Tiġtiġ.
ioli an akon siġsiġ.
opayda kon logariġon,
kondi kanan taklobauon.

Akon iglilibaglibaġ
inin kasákit sa doghan

baman ha banig ig mataḡ
sakit ga magtitilógaḡ.

Kadto na, kadto na, kadto na soranga
kadto na pag biliḡ sin ibá ḡa gogma
ayaw gad pag hiḡyap sin sogad sa akon
asáy tiḡohán maópay ga láyhon

[126]

Kon boot ka manḡasáwa
inín barás pag pisia,
di ka ḡani makapisi
pag toraw na la ganoli.

Kon daw ha kasiriḡanon
tobig ka ḡa irinómon
diri sa dáhon pahonbon,
pahónbon sa doghan nakon

Kon bagá kahoy si lawas
patay na, laya si dahon
nanariḡsiḡ sin kasákit
namóḡa sin kamatáyon

Kap'atán ka tuig an akon paghiḡyap
pag-imasisiriḡ sa imo, binórak.

Han nákadto ka ha pantaw
akon ka gintitinan-aw
harápít ako matónaw
sa dako ḡa pag kahidlaw

Anó iní ḡa nádoróy

kamasakit, kamakapoy,
an lawas sogád sin káhoy
ğaginhaharoharópoy

Bohi pa an bató ģa pinamonakan
didto la katikağ an karokayakan

Pastilán ka kori san pag-iğirikan
natağis si inday ģa binabayáan,
gabáy daw la habsan inín kalalawdan
ğa diri tomólin inín pagsarakyan

Han nakadto ka ha lawdon
akon ka gintinan-awon
hapit kó ikaw karawton
ha barás diri patonbon.

Kon nag-iimót ka san imo kamathom
san pag kamabaysay san imo pamayhon,
bisan la an todló, an bohók, panapton
kon asay somirağ, maopay na nakon,

Hiará ako magnawá
magsakaysakay sa bará
og didto ako hidagsa
sa kam ģawan ģa tuna

Katlóan ka tuig ģa akon kahidlaw
sogád ka sin tobig nakon ikaóhaw

Kon бага ako si taro
tonáw na sa pag kaálo;
maopay si alimağo
kay may pag kalonolóno

Mga lagit, mga lagit,
¿háin daw dapít an sakit?....
sa kalibótan waráy man
sabáli sa panomdoman

Sin pag kamamiğaw sinín kakorolpon
waráy god nabantad bis osá ãa dahon
bis an mña tamsi sáhid mabidó an
¿say pa ba an tawo, di aipan gihapon?....

Hinógay na intoy, siton pakalipoğ
sin kinarokanhi sinin amon liboğ
opayda kon hiro iton imo bayhon
maamoğ ka daw la sinín bantog namon

SUNDRY

Adto na si adlaw
linmoyó sa bokid,
oli na, indayon,
kay waray pa tóbig.

Hi nonay ãa kawayánon
malobaylobay hañanon
naglilinakat ha kógon
hi hawak royokdoyókon.

Itón imo baba
ãa nagyayabora
ãa nagyiwinákan

sitón lonlun bowa;

kon di ko kahadlok
pághirót sin gaba
pag-oonloton ko
itón imo dila

Akó magtotóon diri ko sasabwan
mangad na maloto, diri ko sosoḡ-an
si akó mátimo di ko poporoton
mangad na mabosóg, diri ko totolnon.

Anó man in akon kon diin ka kadto,
di mo la pag dad-on an tubig, kalayo:
di mo mam binohi ini ḡa lawas ko
tinmobo si inday kosóg san amáy ko.

[127]

An tansman nimo mandiḡ
ginsisinólod san kand ḡ
an taranman nakikil ḡ
kay gin bobowad san baktin.

¿Ano ba, Dyos ko, an nakakasógad,
an isda sa dagat ḡa nagkakalópad?...
¿ano ba, Dyos ko, iní ga nadoróy,
inin katamsihan ḡa nagkakalaḡoy?...

Kanogon pa daw la san imo katindog
maópay si bayhon, maráot an bantog:
igpapanaḡlit ko, bayabas ḡa hinóg,
maópay an pánit, oloron an onód.

Ambot daw ada maorán
si dampog naño odtóhan
bisan la inin paḡánod
doróyog tipailáwod

Busa, bayái, balitaw,
ayáw gad tood kay tíaw
iní ḡa akon pagbolaw
igpapahaoli ḡahaw.

Hilaḡkag kitá, hilaḡkag
sinín palawán ḡa pankag
kay baḡin, idáy, makárag
dó loktan sinín alámag.

Makadí kamí maoli,
maoli ḡa bagá diri,
naghihiawil pa ḡani
san ka maopay sangawi

An di ko iginpinóloḡ
an kabasólan in akon:
si kahoy di mag torópoḡ
may balíko, may matadoḡ

Anó man in akon kon diín ka hanoy
di mo la pagdad-on an tobig, an kahoy
iní ḡa lawas ko ḡa makalolóoy
tinmobo kan tatay, kan nanay ḡa iróy

Diri ko kay yóbit, diri ko kay dayaw
pamahonpáhon mo bagá may paráyaw;
an imo pamálod pagkasadaḡana,

baga nagkokori an akon ginhawa.

Ayáw gad hin tamay, ayáw gad hin yóbit
kay magsáma man la inín aton pánit;
an aton logáriḡ ginkakalainan,
kay diri mag-osá inín aton ḡaran.

Busa, bayái, bayái,
bayái ayáw baliki,
bisan dahon sin kamoti
mabobohi kami dinhi.

Abá Lolay, abá Lolay
ligid ligid sinin baybay
kon igkita ka sin away
dalagan, ayaw papátay

Makadí kami maoli
sa baláy ḡa sinorambi
bisan la mawaráy bóḡboḡ
maoli kay logariḡon

An di ko iginkinanta¹
an kabsolán onína;
si kahoy di magsaráma
may baliko, may balísa

An akon pagkinantáhon¹
báyad san akon kináon;
bisan la akó toḡboyón
ḡa diri oraoráhon.

Nag sisirom na daw inín kakorolpon
ḡatanán ḡa tamsi sa káhoy na hapon

kitá man an tawo ga may isip domdom.
máoli sa balay ġa kalogariġon

[128]

¹ Derived from the Spanish “cantar” (to sing) ↑ [a](#) [b](#)

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NOTES ON FILIPINO DIALECTOLOGY

It is beyond any question that most of the Filipino dialects are derived from a common origin: the Malay tongue.

For this reason many Bisayan words are exactly the same in other Filipino dialects, and many others bear some local dialectal differences, thus always showing a common origin.

The following lists are short collections of such words.

[\[Contents\]](#)

WORDS EXACTLY THE SAME IN BISAYAN AND IN TAGALOG

A

Ako.¹—I

Agaw.—To snatch

Aġlit.—A little pot

Amihan.—North wind

Anák.—son, daughter

Anino.—Shadow

Apo.—Grandson, grand-daughter

Apog.—Lime

Asawa.—Wife

Asín.—Salt

aswañ.—Witch

Atáy.—Liver

Away.—Fight

B

Baboy.—Pig

Baga.—Red-hot

Bagá.—as, like

Baga.—Lung

Bagon.—To raise

Bantay.—Watch

Bantilis.—A kind of rock

Basa.—To read

Bata.—Child

Bató.—Stone

Bawi.—To recover

Bayabas.—Guava

Bayad.—Pay

Bayáw.—Brother-in-law

Boká.—Open, untied

Bokás.—Open

Bokó.—Knot

Bohók.—Hair

Boña.—Fruit

K

Kabig.—Pull

Kahoy.—Tree, timber, wood
Kawayan.—Bamboo
Kilala.—To know
Koha.—Take
Kólağ.—Insufficient
Kota.—Wall

D

Dagat.—Sea
Dahon.—Leave
Dalí.—Quick
Dila.—Tongue
Dogó.—Blood

I

Ibabaw.—Over
Ikaw.—Thou, you
Init.—Heat
Inóm.—Drink

[129]

H

Habagat.—West
Hagdan.—Staircase

Hayop.—Animal
Hiláw.—Unripe
Hínay.—Slow
Hinog.—Ripe
Hógas.—Wash

L

Labis.—Excess
Lakbay.—Go over
Laḡaw.—Fly
Laḡit.—Heaven, sky
Lalaki.—Male
Laway.—Saliva
Likod.—Back
Limá.—Five
Liwanag.—Clearness
Lokso.—Jump
Lohá.—Tear
Lorâ.—Spit
Lotò.—Cooked

M

Manók.—Chicken
Matá.—Eye
Matambók.—Fat
May.—There is, etc.
Maya.—A kind of bird

N

Nipá.—Nipá

Nipis.—Thinness

Nosuos.—To rub

O

Ogát.—Vein, nerve

Olo.—Head

Oo.—Yes

Opa.—Payment

Otag.—Debt

Owák.—Raven

Owáy.—Vine

P

Pakpak.—Applause with palms

Pait.—Bitterness

Palad.—Palm of the hand

Patay.—Kill

Pati.—Also, with

Patoğ.—To place over

Payoğ.—Umbrella

Paypay.—Fan

Pili.—A tree so called

Pili.—To select

Pingan.—Plate

Pitó.—Seven
Pokpok.—To beat
Pola.—Red
Posod.—Navel

S

Sa.—To, at, from, on, etc.
Sabaw.—Broth
Sakay.—To embark
Sakit.—Sickness
Sagiğ.—Banana
Saló.—Receive
Saway.—To correct
Sawsaw.—To wash
Siko.—Elbow
Siğba.—To adore
Sili.—Pepper
Siyá.—He, she
Siyam.—Nine
Soka.—To vomit
Soğay.—Horn
Soloğ.—Forward
Sonod.—Follow
Sonog.—Fire

T

Táas.—Height

Tabas.—To cut
Tadtad.—To prick
Taḡis.—To weep
Tahí.—To sew
Timog.—South
Tiyán.—Belly
Tobâ.—A wine
Tobig.—Water
Tobó.—Sugar cane
Tobò.—Profit, to grow
Tohod.—Knee
Tohog.—To string
Tonóg.—Sound
Twad.—To face downwards

W

Waló.—Eight

[130]

[[Contents](#)]

WORDS WITH SOME DIALECTAL DIFFERENCES

Differences in the vowels *i*, *o*.

BISAYAN TAGALOG ENGLISH

Akon	Akin	my, mine
------	------	----------

BISAYAN TAGALOG ENGLISH

Amon	Amin	our
Aslom	Asim	acidity
Aton	Atin	our
Atóp	Atíp	roof
Bitóon	Bitúin	star
Bokog	Bikig	fish-bone, bone
Bogás	Bigas	rice
Bog-at	Bigat	weight
Bolad	Bilad	to sun
Boğol	Biğí	deaf
Kan-on	Kanin	cooked rice
Kaon	Kain	to eat
Katol	Katí	to itch, itching
Dámò	Dami	amount, much
Datóğ	Datiğ	to arrive
Dokót	Dikit	to adhere, adhered
Dolóm	Dilim	dark
Gorót	Gilit	slice
Hábol	Habi	to weave
Harok	Halik	kiss, to kiss
Hatod	Hatid	to accompany
Horám	Hiram	to borrow
Iuomon	Inumin	potable water
Itom	Itim	black
Liog	Liig	neck
Pawod	Pawid	weaved nipa
Salóg	Sahig	floor

BISAYAN TAGALOG ENGLISH

Sandig	Sandal	to lean
Takóp	Takíp	cover
Tanom	Tanim	plantation
Taróm	Talim	edge of a sword, etc.
Tindok	Tundok	a kind of banana
Tindog	Tindig	to stand
Tonok	Tiník	thorn

[131]

Differences in *k, h, l, r, d, t*.

BISAYAN TAGALOG ENGLISH

Adlaw	Araw	Sun, day
Aram	Alam	Wisdom
Badò	Barò	Chemise
Balay	Bahay	House
Balo	Bao	Widow, widower
Balon	Baon	Provision
Barahibo	Balahibo	Feather, dawn
Bari	Bali	To break
Bolan	Bwan	Moon, month
Kagód	Káyud	To scrath
Kalot	Kámot	To scratch
Kamó	Kayó	You
Koló	Kukú	Nail
Dalan	Daan	Path, road
Daraga	Dalaga	Young girl
Digò	Ligò	To bath

BISAYAN TAGALOG ENGLISH

Dirì	Hindì	Not
Hadì	Harì	King
Halabà	Mahaba	Long
Halarom	Malalim	Deep
Harayò	Malayò	Far
Higdà	Higà	To lay down
Iróg	Iloǵ	Nose
Lakát	Lakad	To walk
Lawod	Láot	Ocean
Mahínis	Malinis	Clean
Namok	Lamok	Mosquito
Napolo	Sampù	Ten
Parabol	Palaboy	Favor, grace
Pirit	Pilit	To force
Poro	Pulò	Island
Roãǵ	Lwaǵ	Broad
Salod	Sahod	To receive
Sarapati	Kalapati	Pigeon
Sarowal	Salawal	Pants
Sira	Sila	They
Siraǵ	Silag	To appear
Siroǵ	Siloǵ	Beneath
Sodlay	Suklay	Comb
Sorat	Sulat	Letter
Sorok	Sulok	Corner ^[132]
Taliǵa	Taiǵa	Ear
Taroǵ	Taloǵ	A plant

BISAYAN TAGALOG ENGLISH

Torò	Tulò	Drop
Torog	Tulog	To sleep
Toktok	Togtog	To sound, to play

Differences in the accent, and in the separation of the syllables.

BISAYAN TAGALOG ENGLISH

Bálik	Balík	to come back
Kohà	Kuha	to take
Gaód	Gáod	oar
Hipág	Hípag	sister-in-law
Laón	Láon	old, ancient
Sábay	Sabáy	simultaneous
Tawá	Táwa	laugh
Kab-it	Kabít	connected
Kam-aw	Kamao	a dish
Kan-on	Kanin	cooked rice
Koan	Kwán	so and so
Gab-i	Gabí	evening, night
Sab-a	Sabá	a kind of banana
Sab-it	Sabit	to hook
Tan-aw	Tanaw	to look
Tig-a	Tigás	hardness
Tul-id	Twid	straight

Transformation from *a* to *o*, and viceversa.

Alapoop Alapaap cloud, fog
Kamót Kamay hand

Doha	Dalawá	two
Habobò	Mababà	low
Sokól	Sukat	measure
Toló	Tatlo	three
Onóm	Anim	six
Opat	Apat	four
Otok	Utak	brain

[133]

¹ A: We use in these lists the orthography proposed in the first page of this book, as an orthography practically the same is now being much used in Tagalog. But we employ only three vowels: a, i, o. [↑]

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ERRATA

The errata have been applied to the text, except in a few cases where the misspelling could not be located.

PAGE LINE

1	7 (note)	city.	for city,
2	1 (note)	this method	the method
			”
8	15	han	han, canán
			”
13	3 (note)	SUPRA	INFRA
			”
15	23	wich	with
			”
18	10	as.	as
			”
18	27	MGA	MAG
			”
19	11	mag-áarot	mag-aárot
			”
19	19	(person bold) in reading	(person bold in reading)
			”
23	11	whe	we
			”
23	31	(liar)	(liar)
			”
24	5	pauá, capauá	pauà, capauà
			”
25	1	simyly	simply
			”
25	21	take	taking
			”
26	29	expresses,	expresses
			”

PAGE LINE

30	1 (note)	names	name
			”
31	6	tastes	tests
			”
32	31	adje-	adjec-
			”
34	last line	excessive	excessive
			”
35	1	before primitive	before the primitive
			”
35	17	paintful	painful
			”
36	29	insted	instead
			”
37	28	that and	and that
			”
38	14	te	the
			”
38	16, 21	cabataán-(reunion	cabatáan-(reunion)
			”
38	19	ty make	to make
			”
39	4	despective	depreciative
			”
39	7	tru	thru
			”
39	23	voriations	variations
			”
39	3 (notes)	parvity	littleness
			”
39	3, 4 (notes)	onomatopic	onomatopoetic
			”
40	4, 12	FEMENINE	FEMININE
			”
40	23	or of	or by
			”
41	11	inflexion	inflection
			”
41	16	samet leters	same letters
			”

PAGE LINE

42	17	zingiber	ginger
			”
42	29	moderstand	understand
			”
42	30	passanger	passenger
			”
44	20	folwed	followed [134]
			”
46	9	cabataán	cabatáan
			”
40	15	guipác, guipác	guipic, guipác
			”
46	29	(saliba)	(saliva)
			”
46	30	(resine)	(resin)
			”
46	30	(unarticulate voice)	(inarticulate voice)
			”
47	10	Quitá, camí (we)	Quita, camí (3) (we)
			”
49	1	further from the speaker than from the listener	far from both the speaker and the listener
			”
50	20	the form hadton	the forms hadto and haton.
			”
52	1	REEALATIVE	RELATIVE
			”
52	11	inflexion	inflection
			”
52	16, 19, 24	litterally	literally
			”
52	16	verted	expressed
			”
52	28	flwer)	flower)
			”
52	3 (Notes)	precedes the adjetive	precedes the adjective
			”
52	4 (Notes)	permissible	permissible
			”

PAGE LINE

58	15	litterally	literally
			”
59	1, 4	litterally	literally
			”
59	21	I have written (I wrote	(I have written, I wrote)
			”
60	16, 17	subjuntive	subjunctive
			”
60	26	hade	had
			”
62	16	Examp	Example
			”
62	18	the said consonant, being	the said consonant being
			”
62	1 (Note)	Potencial	Potential
			”
63	9	FNTURE	FUTURE
			”
63	23, 24	dermined	determined
			”
64	21	the some	the same
			”
64	1 (note)	snbjunctive	subjunctive
			”
65	28	if it an M	if it is an M
			”
67	1	Ehe	The
			”
67	5	excep	except
			”
68	18	ef	of
			”
68	21	an HAND	and HAN
			”
68	23	the combination	combination
			”
68	30	(drinked)	(drunk)
			”
69	21, 23, 26	litt.	lit.
			”

PAGE LINE

70	5	INDICATIVE	INFINITIVE
			”
76	10	INDICATIVE	INFINITIVE
			”
77	17	and interfix	and the interfix
			”
78	1, 2	litterally	literally
			”
78	26	PROGRESSIVE INDIRECT PASSIVE	PASSIVE PROGRESSIVE
			”
			INSTRUMENTAL
80	32	us you	us, you
			”
80	32	than not write	them not write [135]
			”
81	4	in primitive forms	among the primitive forms
			”
81	5	and in	and among the
			”
82	17	and other	and the other
			”
82	23	wher	where
			”
83	13	there are	they are
			”
83	18	came	come
			”
83	29	take	takes
			”
84	24	postponed to them	follow them
			”
84	25	ALVERBIAL FORM	ADVERBIAL FORM
			”
86	2	cach	each
			”
86	3	befere	before
			”
86	26	ordinaryly	ordinaryly
			”

PAGE LINE

87	3	preseut	present
			”
87	14	with present	with the present
			”
87	24	contigent	contingent
			”
88	24	the rains	the rain
			”
88	24	than; litterally	them; literally
			”
89	3	it as <u>follows</u>	as follows
			”
89	18	os the form	of the form
			”
89	23	litterally	literally
			”
90	7	CONJNGATIONAL ROOT	CONJUGATIONAL ROOT
			”
91	27	leave of abandonment	leave or abandonment
			”
91	29	litterally	literally
			”
92	2	the the interfix	the interfix
			”
92	20	proceding	preceding
			”
92	25	recipocrate	reciprocate
			”
93	5	hatter	hotter
			”
96	26	tune	tone
			”
98	19	whith	with
			”
100	13, 27	litterally	literally
			”
100	23	demonstratives	<u>demonstrative</u>
			”
102	29	thould	should
			”

PAGE LINE

102	31	litterally	literally
			”
102	3 (note)	litterally	literally
			”
103	21	he sad	he said
			”
103	27	litterally	literally
			”
103	32	proceeded	preceded
			”
104	6	used	use
			”
104	20	Jonh	John
			”
105	21, 22	corresponding	corresponding word
			”
106	4	adonment	adornment
			”
106	28	meet	meat
			”
107	12	mousefully	unusefully
			”
107	15	Deefcto	Defecto [136]
			”
107	16	unfurtunate	unfortunate
			”
107	20	drowing	drawing
			”
108	21	bulter	butter
			”
109	15	to lost	to lose
			”
109	23	bit	bet
			”
109	27	laste	taste
			”
110	26	maintanence	maintenance
			”
111	15	deer, for fat	dear, fat
			”

PAGE LINE

111	28	chaw-chaw	chow-chow
			”
111	2 (note)	object	objects
			”
118	34	hastned	hastened
			”
122	13	some other	same order
			”
123	23	verses of six verses	verses of six syllables, verses
			”
124	25	BISAYAN SONG	BISAYAN SONGS
			”
124	26	following song	following songs.
			”
125	27	Posed	posed
			”
128	14	aglit ... aswaḡ	Aḡlit, aswaḡ
			”
128	19, 20, 21	Baga, Bága, Bagá	Baga, Bagá, Baga
			”
128	3 (note)	there vowells	three vowels
			”

COLOPHON

Availability

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Waray-waray is one of several languages called Visayan or Bisayan, and is spoken in the eastern part of the Visayas region of the Philippines, that is, the islands of Leyte and Samar, by, currently, about 2 to 3 million speakers. This book is a grammar of the language by the (locally) well-known literator Norberto Romuáldez. This book is quite scarce, and was apparently printed using rather primitive equipment on cheap paper in the Philippines.

The author followed the Spanish-based orthography of Waray-waray (back in 1908, when the Philippines had been American territory for a decade), but was quite aware of spelling-issues, as shown in this work.

Scans for this book are available from the Internet Archive (copy [1](#)).

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The following corrections have been applied to the text:

Page	Source	Correction	Edit distance
IX	CONTRCTIONS	CONTRACTIONS	1
IX	Pronoun	Pronouns	1
IX	Verb	Verbs	1
X	Adverb	Adverbs	1

X	Preposition	Prepositions	1
X	Conjunction	Conjunctions	1
X	Interjection	Interjections	1
X	Syntax	Syntax	1
X	Barbarism	Barbarisms	1
X	innecessarily	unnecessarily	1
1, 28	.	,	1
2	this	the	2
11	bongtóhay	bungtóhay	1
12	"	[Deleted]	1
13	supra	infra	3
15	wich	with	1
<i>Passim.</i>	[Not in source]	,	1
18, 70	.	[Deleted]	1
18	Mga	Mag	2
19	mag-áarot	mag-aárot	2 / 0
19, 53	)	[Deleted]	1
19, 31, 31, 31, 31, 39, 89	[Not in source]	)	1
23	Whe	We	1
23	lier	liar	1
24	pauá	pauà	1 / 0
24	capauá	capauà	1 / 0
25	simyly	simply	1
25	take	taking	3
26, 61, 62, 68, 81, 134	,	[Deleted]	1
27	;	,	1
28	american	American	1
30	names	name	1
31	tastes	tests	2
32	adjetives	adjectives	1
34	very	sorry	3
34	masiromsírom	masiromsiróm	2 / 0

34	excesive	excessive	1
35 , 77 , 82 , 87	[<i>Not in source</i>]	the	4
35	painful	painful	1
35	painful(	painful)	2
36	insted	instead	1
37	that and	and that	7
38	te	the	1
38 , 46	cabataán	cabatáan	2 / 0
38	táwo	táuo	1
38	ty	to	1
39	despective	depreciative	4
39	tru	thru	1
39 , 39	onomatopic	onomatopoetic	3
39	parvity	littleness	10
39 , 59	[<i>Not in source</i>]	(	1
39	voriations	variations	1
40	FEMENINE	FEMININE	1
40	of	by	2
41 , 52	inflexion	inflection	2
41	samet leters	same letters	2
42	zingiber	ginger	3
42	moderstand	understand	2
42	passanger	passenger	1
44	follwed	followed	1
46	guipác	guipic	1
46	saliba	saliva	1
46	resine	resin	1
46	unarticulate	inarticulate	1
47	PRONOUN	PRONOUNS	1
48	Demonstratives	DEMONSTRATIVE	13
49	further from the speaker than from	far from both the speaker and	17
50	form <i>hadtón</i>	forms <i>hadto</i> and <i>haton</i>	11 / 10

51 , 53 ,			
59 , 60 ,			
60 , 60 ,			
64 , 66 ,			
66 , 67 ,			
68 , 87 ,			
87 , 87 ,			
111 , 125	[Not in source]	.	1
51	As	as	1
52	REEALATIVE	RELATIVE	2
52 , 52 ,			
52 , 58 ,			
59 , 59 ,			
89 , 89 ,			
100 ,			
100 ,			
102 ,			
102 ,			
103 ,			
104	litterally	literally	1
52	verted	expressed	6
52	flwer	flower	1
52	preceeds the adjetive	precedes the adjective	2
52	permisible	permissible	1
53	(	[Deleted]	1
54	la	lâ	1 / 0
55	and	an	1
55	[Not in source]	"	1
56	Contractions	CONTRACTIONS	11
57	VERB	VERBS	1
59 , 94	:	.	1
59	(	,	2
60 , 70 ,			
97	,	.	1
60	subjuntive	subjunctive	1
60	hade	had	1
61	—	[Deleted]	1
62	Examp.	Example	2

62	Potencial	Potential	1
63	Fnture	Future	1
63 , 84 , 111	[<i>Not in source</i>]	“	1
63	dermined	determined	2
63	inter fix	interfix	1
64	snbjunctive	subjunctive	1
64	some	same	1
65	ng	nǵ	1 / 0
65	[<i>Not in source</i>]	is	3
66	from	form	2
67	Ehe	The	1
67	excep	except	1
68	ef	of	1
68	<i>hand</i>	han	1
68	the	[<i>Deleted</i>]	4
68	drinked	drunk	3
69 , 69 , 69	litt	lit.	1
70 , 76	Indicative	Infinitive	3
70 , 71	[<i>Not in source</i>]	,	2
74	[<i>Not in source</i>]	a	2
74	litteral	literal	1
77	(1)	[<i>Deleted</i>]	4
78 , 91	litteraly	literally	2
78	being	used in	5
78		Passive	
	Progressive	Progressive	
	indirect passive	Instrumental	21
80	you, us you	you, us	4
80	than	them	2
81 , 81	in	among the	8
82	wher	where	1
82	[<i>Not in source</i>]	¿	1
83	There	They	2
83	came	come	1
83	take	takes	1

84	postponed to	follow	10
84	ALVERBIAL	ADVERBIAL	1
86	cach	each	1
86	befere	before	1
86	ordinaryly	ordinarily	1
87	preseut	present	1
87	contigent	contingent	1
88	tag iya	tag-iya	1
88	rains	rain	1
88	than; litterally	them; literally	3
89	it	[Deleted]	3
89	os	of	1
90	altho	although	3
90	Conjngational	Conjugational	1
91	of	or	1
91	moneys	money	1
92	the the	the	4
92	proceding	preceding	1
92	recipocrate	reciprocate	2
93	hatter	hotter	1
95, 103	;	:	1
96	tune	tone	1
97	ADVERB	ADVERBS	1
97	—	.	1
98	PREPOSITION	PREPOSITIONS	1
98	whith	with	1
98	CONJUNCTION	CONJUNCTIONS	1
98	become	are	5
98	be translated	translate	4
99	'	[Deleted]	1
99	INTERJECTION	INTERJECTIONS	1
100	demonstratives	demonstrative	1
102	thould	should	1
103	then	them	1
103	sad	said	1
103	preceeded	preceded	1

104	used	use	1
104	Jonh	John	2
105	BARBARISM	BARBARISMS	1
105	[<i>Not in source</i>]	word	5
106	adonment	adornment	1
106	meet	meat	1
107	mousefully	unusefully	2
107	Deefcto	Defecto	2
107	unfurtunate	unfortunate	1
107	drowing	drawing	1
108	bulter	butter	1
109	lost	lose	1
109	bit	bet	1
109	prissones	prisoner	2
109	laste	taste	1
110	necssarrily	necessarily	2
110	maintanence	maintenance	2
111 , 111	chinese	Chinese	1
111	object	objects	1
111	deer, for	dear,	5
111	chaw-chaw	chow-chow	2
111	do not they	do they not	8
112	súch	such	1 / 0
112	Begin	Being	2
113	steambot	steamboat	1
118	hastned	hastened	1
120	Hyberbole	Hyperbole	1
122	some other	same order	3
123	verses	syllables, verses	11
124	SONG	SONGS	1
124	song	songs	1
128	there vowells	three vowels	3
128	snatsch	snatch	1
128	Aglit	Aǵlit	1 / 0
128	Aswág	aswaǵ	3 / 1
128	Baga	Bagá	1 / 0

128	Bagá	Baga	1 / 0
129	Wreat	Water	4
133	[<i>Not in source</i>]	(note)	6
135	folllws	follows	1
135	demonstratlve	demonstrative	1
136	''	,	1

Abbreviations

Overview of abbreviations used.

Abbreviation Expansion

B.A.	Bachelor of Arts
P.I.	Philippine Islands

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK BISAYAN
GRAMMAR AND NOTES ON BISAYAN RHETORIC AND POETICS
AND FILIPINO DIALECTOLOGY ***

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